Bulk, big jumps and boundary layers in the occupation law of a lattice Lévy walk

Arjun Pemmasani*

Abstract

A lattice Lévy walk moves in runs of alternating direction whose independent lengths have regularly varying tails of index between 1 and 2. We describe the law of the number of right steps at every point. It has a stable bulk, a big-jump zone on each side, a renewal boundary layer at each end and an atom at each endpoint, which on the ballistic scale give a rigorous lattice version of the infinite density. The bulk local limit theorem is uniform over the whole range under regular variation and aperiodicity alone. One explicit kernel, a complete giant run plus the run in progress, gives the big-jump zone and the boundary layer under local regular variation. When the two run scales differ by an unbounded factor, we locate the start of the big-jump zone up to a factor $1 \pm \delta$ and describe the law before it logarithmically. We give the exact effect of an arbitrary initial run on each piece, with a sharp criterion for each. This answers, for the lattice walk, a question of Wang, Schulz, Deng and Barkai on initial preparation and rare fluctuations. We also locate the global mode, with its golden ratio threshold, and the interior minimum near an end. Near each end the law copies the local extrema of the boundary kernel. For fresh and fair starts with no ties in the kernel, under a smoothness condition, the only other local extrema up to distance $N^{1-\eta}$ are an odd number near the interior minimum.

Keywords: Lévy walk; alternating renewal process; occupation time; local limit theorem; stable law; big-jump principle; infinite density; renewal theorem; global mode; antimode.
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1 Introduction

A lattice Lévy walk moves on $\mathbb{Z}$ in runs of alternating direction. The run lengths are independent, and their tails are regularly varying with an index α between 1 and 2, so a run has a finite mean and an infinite variance. Let A_N be the number of right steps among the first N. The position of the walk after N steps is $2A_N - N$, so the law

*Department of Mathematics, Harvey Mudd College, Claremont, CA 91711, USA.
E-mail: apemmasani@hmc.edu

$P_N(k) = \mathbb{P}(A_N = k)$ on $\{0, \dots, N\}$ is the law of the walk read on its natural lattice. We describe $P_N(k)$ at every point k, with one exception that we state below. In the bulk P_N is a stable density, uniformly over the range of the count (Theorem A). On each side of the bulk and up to the endpoint it is given by one kernel, which adds a complete giant run and the run in progress at time N (Theorem B). Read at $k = vN$ this kernel is a rigorous lattice version of the infinite density of the Lévy walk [36, 37], with its boundary layer and its endpoint atoms. Lévy walks are a standard model of superdiffusion [50], and the same walk describes heat transport in one-dimensional lattices [13, 44] and the occupation time of an alternating renewal process [21, 26]. In continuous time the propagator of a Lévy walk is a stable bulk between two ballistic peaks at the fronts, which are formed by the walkers still in their first flight [50, Section II.A.2 and Fig. 2] (see also [49, 12]). On the lattice these peaks are the endpoint atoms and the boundary layers. The picture is known. What we add is its exact form at a fixed time.

1.1 The picture

Figure 1 shows P_N for $N = 5000$ on a logarithmic scale. Four pieces make up the law. We call a right step a plus step.

- The bulk. Near pN, where p is the long-run fraction of plus steps, the law is a stable density at the scale B_N of the larger of the two run-length fluctuations. Here B_N grows like N^{1/α_*} up to a slowly varying factor, with α_* the smaller index.
- The big-jump zones. A count k with $k - pN$ much larger than B_N needs one plus run of macroscopic length, a giant run, and the law of that run gives $P_N(k)$ its size, which is of order $T_+(N)$ on the ballistic range, with T_+ the tail of a plus run. The giant run is either a complete run in the interior or the run in progress at time N, and $P_N(k)$ is the sum of the two contributions.
- The boundary layers. At $k = N - j$ with j fixed, the giant run is the one in progress at time N, and the only question is where it started. It starts right after the j-th minus step exactly when a minus run ends there, so the layer is $T_+(N)$ times the renewal mass function $u_-(j)$ of the minus runs.
- The atoms. The point $k = N$ is the event that the first run covers all N steps, and its mass is the tail of the first run.

The first run of the walk is its initial run. It may be an ordinary run, a run seen from a typical time, or anything else, and it enters each of the four pieces through its own criterion.

1.2 Results

We state the hypotheses in Section 2.2. They are regular variation of the two tails with indices in $(1, 2)$, written (RV), the local form $f_\sigma(n) \sim \alpha_\sigma T_\sigma(n)/n$ of the mass functions, written (LR), and aperiodicity, written (SPAN). Section 6.4 also uses a bound on the differences of the mass functions, written (LD). The run laws may differ between the two signs, so the two stable scales $b_{+,N}$ and $b_{-,N}$ may differ, and their ratio may oscillate. Every theorem below holds for every relation between the two scales. We write s for the sum of the two mean run lengths and p for the fraction of the plus mean.

The bulk. Theorem A says that for a fresh start, under (RV) and (SPAN),

$$\sup_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \big| B_N P_N(k) - h_N\big((k - pN)/B_N\big) \big| \to 0, \qquad \sup_k P_N(k) \le \frac{C}{B_N},$$

where h_N is the density of $(1-p)\theta_{+,N} Z_+ - p\,\theta_{-,N} Z_-$, with $Z_\pm$ independent totally skewed stable variables. The supremum runs over the whole range of the count. On a window $|k - pN| \le K B_N$ the local limit also follows from a strong renewal theorem of Berger, and what is new is the uniformity over every point under (RV) and (SPAN) alone. Outside

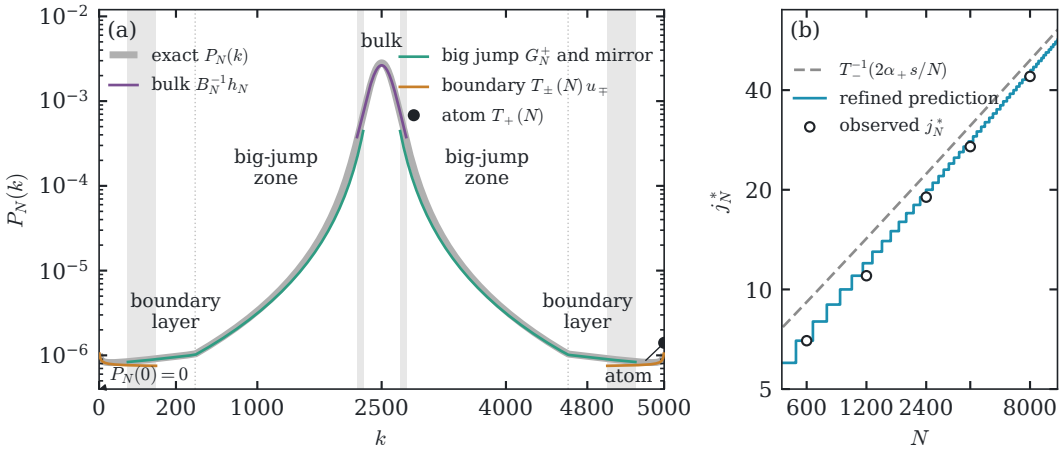


Figure 1: (a) The law $P_N(k)$ for $N = 5000$, run lengths with $f(n) \propto n^{-5/2}$ for both signs and a fresh plus start, on a logarithmic scale, with the four pieces of Theorems A and B. The two ends of the horizontal axis are stretched. (b) The position j_N^* of the interior minimum near the plus end against N, on logarithmic axes, with the law of Theorem E and the refined prediction with $C(j)$ from Theorem 6.1. Section 7 describes the computations.

the bulk the theorem says only that $P_N(k) = o(1/B_N)$, and the next theorem says what $P_N(k)$ is there.

Big jumps and the boundary layer. Put $L_k = (k - pN)/(1 - p)$, the length of the plus run that carries a typical configuration to the count k. Theorem B says that for a fresh plus start, under (RV) and (SPAN) for both signs and (LR) for the plus sign,

$$P_N(k) = \Big[\gamma(N-k)\, f_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor) + T_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)\, u_-(N-k)\Big](1 + o(1))$$

uniformly on $pN + K\lambda_N B_N \le k \le N$, in the sense that the error tends to zero as $N \to \infty$ and then $K \to \infty$. Here $\gamma(j)$ is an explicit finite sum with $\gamma(j) \sim js/\mu_-^2$, and $\lambda_N = 1 + \log(B_N/b_{+,N})$, which equals 1 when the plus scale is the larger one. The first term is a complete giant run and the second the run in progress at time N. At $k = N - j$ with j fixed the theorem reduces to $P_N(N-j)/T_+(N) \to u_-(j)$, which needs only (RV) for the plus sign. As j grows, $u_-(j) \to 1/\mu_-$ and the layer joins the big-jump zone continuously. When the plus scale is the larger one, the bulk profile up to a slowly growing multiple of B_N and the kernel beyond it give the whole plus side in a single limit, while no fixed switching point does (Remark 4.9). When the plus scale is smaller than the minus scale by an unbounded factor, Theorem 4.13 shows that the kernel takes over at $pN + (1+\delta)\xi_N B_N$ and not at $pN + (1-\delta)\xi_N B_N$, where $\xi_N = o(\lambda_N)$ comes from a Cramér transform of the minus runs. So the start of the zone is sharp up to the factor $1 \pm \delta$. Before it the law is a moderate deviation of the minus runs, and the theorem describes it on the logarithmic scale. On $KB_N \le k - pN \le (1+\delta)\xi_N B_N$ we have only this logarithmic description, and this window is the exception announced above. The mirror window appears at the minus end when the minus scale is the smaller one. (LR) suffices for the theorem, and Example 4.11 shows that (RV) alone does not, since the kernel reads f_+ at a single point. This parallels the optimality of the local hypothesis for sums [3, Eq. (2.4)]. Read at $k = vN$ the theorem gives the infinite density

$$\frac{P_N(\lfloor vN \rfloor)}{T_+(N)} \to \frac{1}{\mu_-}\Big[\alpha_+(1-\ell)\ell^{-\alpha_+-1} + \ell^{-\alpha_+}\Big], \qquad \ell = \frac{v-p}{1-p},$$

where the second term is the run in progress at time N (Corollary 4.8).

The initial run. Wang, Schulz, Deng and Barkai [46] left the effect of the initial preparation on the rare fluctuations of the occupation time for future work. Theorem C answers this question for the lattice walk, for every law of the initial run and on every piece of the law. It rests on the first-run decomposition of Proposition 2.4. Write $\nu_\sigma(n)$ for the probability that the first run has sign σ and length n, and $Q_\sigma(n)$ for the probability that it has sign σ and length at least n. On every macroscopic interior of the range of the count the bulk approximation holds with no condition on the initial run. It holds uniformly over $1 \le k < N$ exactly when $B_n(\nu_+(n) + \nu_-(n)) \to 0$, which we call the bulk criterion. The initial run is invisible in the boundary layer at the plus end exactly when $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$. On the big-jump zone up to the end the same condition is sharp, while on its interior only window averages of ν_+ matter. The conditions are nested, and when one fails the theorem gives the exact correction. The stationary initial run satisfies the bulk criterion and fails the other two, and Corollary 5.4 gives its corrections in closed form. Corollary 5.5 shows that no trimming of the range $\{0, \dots, N\}$ by $o(N)$ points removes the dependence on the initial run for every initial run at once.

The shape. Theorem D compares the endpoint atoms with the bulk for an initial run that satisfies the bulk criterion. An endpoint is the global mode when its atom exceeds H_N/B_N by a fixed factor, with H_N the height of the profile, and the bulk wins when both atoms are smaller by a fixed factor. For the stationary initial run with equal indices this is the golden ratio threshold. The endpoints win for $\alpha < \varphi = (1+\sqrt{5})/2$, the bulk wins for $\alpha > \varphi$, and at $\alpha = \varphi$ with pure power tails the bulk wins by the explicit factor $1/\mathcal{C}(\varphi) = 1.288\dots$, with $\mathcal{C}$ as in (6.1).

Theorem E locates the interior minimum between the bulk and the plus end for a fresh plus start. If $u_-(j) > 1/\mu_-$ for every $j \ge 1$, which holds for every strictly log-convex law of the minus runs, the minimum sits at $N - j_N^*$ with $T_-(j_N^*) \sim 2\alpha_+ s/N$, so j_N^* grows like the stable scale of the minus runs. It is asymptotic to the minimizer of $u_-(j) + C(j)/N$, with $C(j)$ the exact second-order coefficient of Theorem 6.1. When u_- dips below its limit the minimum stays at bounded distance from the end.

Section 6.4 compares neighbouring values. A difference form of the renewal theorem, $u_-(j) - u_-(j-1) \sim -T_-(j)/\mu_-^2$, makes every end profile eventually monotone. Each local maximum of the profile at an end is copied by P_N, so P_N has at least one mode more than the two profiles together, and a prepared start of a log-convex law has at least four modes (Theorem 6.8 and Corollary 6.9). Under (LD) we prove a first-difference form of Theorem 6.1. Up to distance $N^{1-\eta}$ from each end the local extrema of P_N are then those of the profile, followed by an odd number of extrema in a window of width $2\eta' a_-(N)$ around the interior minimum, for every $\eta' > 0$, and P_N is strictly monotone in between (Theorem 6.12). We do not prove that the window holds a single minimum, nor that P_N is monotone from there to the bulk, and Conjecture 6.13 states the expected number of modes. Finally, the ends identify both run laws (Remark 5.6).

1.3 Related work

Infinite densities and big jumps. Rebenshtok, Denisov, Hänggi and Barkai [36, 37] derived the infinite density of a Lévy walk from the Montroll and Weiss equation, formally and in continuous time. For the two-state velocity model their density [36, Eqs. (8) and (10)] has the shape $|v|^{-1-\alpha}[\alpha - (\alpha-1)|v|]$. Schulz and Barkai [39, Eqs. (25) and (26)] found the infinite density of the occupation time of a site for an alternating process with two sojourn laws and matched it to the stable bulk, and Wang, Schulz, Deng and Barkai [46, Eq. (83)] found it for one law. A complete giant run alone would give the linear term $-\alpha|v|$, and the run in progress adds $+|v|$, so these formulas already contain the run in progress. Vezzani, Barkai and Burioni [42, Eqs. (12) and (13)] (see also [43])

derived the tail from a single big jump as the sum of exactly these two terms, a jump still in progress at the observation time and a completed jump that starts at the renewal rate. So the shape of the infinite density and its two-term mechanism are known formally. What Theorem B and Corollary 4.8 add is a proof on the lattice at a fixed time, with the exact kernels γ and κ at finite distance from the end, uniformly up to the endpoint, together with the boundary layer and the role of the local hypothesis. In the physics model each flight chooses its direction independently, and consecutive flights in the same direction merge into one run. This gives the alternating walk with run laws thinned geometrically with parameter $\frac{1}{2}$, as in Remark 5.6.

The paper [46] works in continuous time through a double Laplace transform, with one law for both states and a start of fair random sign. It finds a boundary layer of tail times renewal density for the backward recurrence time when $1 < \alpha < 2$ [46, Eq. (52)] and an atom with a boundary layer for the occupation time when $0 < \alpha < 1$ [46, Section VII.A]. Its authors write that "the effect of initial preparation on the rare fluctuations is left for a future work" [46, Section VIII]. Wang, Vezzani, Burioni and Barkai [47] then compared the ordinary and the equilibrated start formally for a biased continuous-time random walk. They found that the rare fluctuations remember the start, through an added term $\xi^{-\alpha}$ in the infinite density and an atom at the origin [47, Eqs. (28), (46) and (47)]. This is the structure of Corollary 5.4(a) and (b), where the stationary initial run adds the complete initial run to the kernel. Theorem C treats an arbitrary initial run at every point, with a sharp criterion in each zone for when the start is invisible and the exact correction when it is not. Wang, Höll and Barkai [45] treat the infinite-mean case. Akimoto [1] computes the moments of the occupation time for the ordinary and the equilibrium start and shows that they differ for $1 < \alpha < 2$. The classical integral limit theorems for the sojourn time of an alternating renewal process are due to Takács [40, 41] and Kesten [25], and they are statements in distribution, while every statement here concerns single points. The golden ratio appears in Wang, Li and Hänggi [44] as the exponent at which the side peaks and the central peak decay at the same rate, with the edge exponent of Cipriani, Denisov and Politi [9], and Lee-Dadswell, Nickel and Gray [27] found the conduction exponent $(3 - \sqrt{5})/2$ by a hydrodynamic argument. The threshold itself is the exponent identity $\alpha - 1 = 1/\alpha$. What Theorem D adds is the comparison of single points as a theorem and the constant $\mathcal{C}(\varphi)$.

Local limit theorems and renewal theory. Doney [14] proved a bivariate local limit theorem in the stable domain, and Berger [2] proved multivariate local large deviations and strong renewal theorems. His Theorem 3.3 applied to the walk of run lengths, together with the fresh-plus identity of Proposition 2.3, gives the window $|k - pN| \le KB_N$ of Theorem A, and Section 3 explains what the rest of the theorem adds and why it needs new work. Melbourne, Pène and Terhesiu [30] prove mixing local limit theorems with multivariate stable limits on Young towers under the invariant measure. For the walk they give one point at the stable scale for the stationary initial run, with the first and the last run restricted to fixed lengths. In the i.i.d. renewal setting Theorems A and C remove these restrictions. We use the local large deviation bound of Caravenna and Doney [6] (see also [31]) for sums of a fixed number of variables. The local one-big-jump theorems for sums of independent variables are due to Denisov, Dieker and Shneer [11] and Berger, Birkner and Yuan [4], and the one under exactly the local condition (LR) is [3, Theorem 2.4]. That theorem gives the probability that a fixed number of plus runs adds up to a given large value. It does not give Theorem B directly. The number of runs before step N is random and tied to the run lengths, the big jump may be made by the run in progress at time N, which no statement about complete sums sees, and the kernel must hold uniformly up to the endpoint, where only boundedly many minus steps remain. The proof of Theorem B does not use these theorems. What is new for the local big jump

is the count at a fixed time, the run in progress at time N, the exact constants $\gamma(j)$ and $\kappa(j)$, and the uniformity up to the endpoint. The second-order coefficient rests on the second-order renewal theorem of Frenk [19], see also Rogozin [38] and Doney [15], and the monotonicity of u_- on de Bruijn and Erdős [10].

The walk. The walk is the directionally reinforced random walk of Mauldin, Monticino and von Weizsäcker [29], with limit laws by Horváth and Shao [22], and the persistent random walk of Cénac, Le Ny, de Loynes and Offret [7, 8]. For geometric run lengths its crossings and a related walk with a Landau profile are treated in [34, 35]. Magdziarz, Scheffler, Straka and Żebrowski [28] prove limit theorems for Lévy walks in continuous space and time. Theorem A is the local form of the marginal of these limits at one time. Godrèche and Luck [21] give the transform of the occupation time, which is the generating function of the fresh-plus identity, and Lamperti [26] proved the arcsine type law for infinite-mean runs.

Organization. Everything rests on the exact identities of Section 2, which write $P_N(k)$ through products of renewal kernels of the two signs and reduce every initial run to the two fresh laws. Sections 3 to 6 prove Theorems A to E in order, Section 7 describes the computations, and Appendix A collects classical inputs.

2 Setting, hypotheses and exact identities

2.1 Runs, initial run and the occupation count

The walk takes N steps and each step has a sign, $+$ or $-$. A plus step moves right and a minus step moves left. The signs come in maximal runs of equal sign, and consecutive runs have opposite signs. All runs after the first are independent. A run of sign $\sigma \in \{+,-\}$ has a length distributed as X_σ, a random variable on $\{1,2,\dots\}$ with mass function $f_\sigma(n) = \mathbb{P}(X_\sigma = n)$ and survival function

$$T_\sigma(x) = \mathbb{P}(X_\sigma \geq x), \qquad x \in \mathbb{R}.$$

We extend f_σ by zero to nonpositive integers, and we write $\bar\sigma$ for the sign opposite to σ.

We call the first run the initial run. It has a sign Σ and a length D, and the pair (Σ, D) is independent of all later runs. We put

$$\nu_\sigma(d) = \mathbb{P}(\Sigma = \sigma,\, D = d), \qquad Q_\sigma(N) = \mathbb{P}(\Sigma = \sigma,\, D \geq N),$$

and we assume that D is finite almost surely. A fresh start of sign σ_0 has $\nu_{\sigma_0} = f_{\sigma_0}$ and $\nu_{\bar\sigma_0} = 0$, so its initial run is an ordinary run. The stationary initial run has $\nu_\sigma = T_\sigma/s$ with s as in (2.1) below. It is the law of the current run seen from a typical time of a two-sided stationary sequence of runs, and it is the equilibrated start of the physics literature.

Let A_N be the number of plus steps among $1,\dots,N$, and

$$P_N(k) = \mathbb{P}(A_N = k), \qquad 0 \leq k \leq N.$$

The walk is at $2A_N - N$ after N steps. For a fresh start of sign σ we write $F_N^\sigma(k)$ for $P_N(k)$, with $F_N^\sigma(k) = 0$ for $k \notin \{0,\dots,N\}$. We also need the law of the count of the starting sign,

$$\Pi_m^+(b) = F_m^+(b), \qquad \Pi_m^-(b) = F_m^-(m-b),$$

so $\Pi_m^\sigma(b)$ is the probability that a fresh walk of sign σ has exactly b steps of its own sign among its first m steps.

2.2 Hypotheses

The hypotheses carry fixed names, and every statement says which it uses.

(RV) For each sign, T_σ is regularly varying at infinity with index $-\alpha_\sigma$, where $1 < \alpha_\sigma < 2$. We write $\alpha_* = \min(\alpha_+, \alpha_-)$.

(LR) For each sign there is $\alpha_\sigma \in (1,2)$ with $f_\sigma(n) \sim \alpha_\sigma T_\sigma(n)/n$ as $n \to \infty$.

(SPAN) For each sign, the support of X_σ is not contained in any arithmetic progression $b + h\mathbb{Z}$ with $h \geq 2$.

(LD) For each sign, $|f_\sigma(n) - f_\sigma(n+1)| = O(f_\sigma(n)/n)$ as $n \to \infty$.

A hypothesis assumed "for the plus sign" is assumed for that sign only. Under (LR) we have $T_\sigma(n+1)/T_\sigma(n) = 1-(\alpha_\sigma+o(1))/n$, so the representation theorem [5, Theorem 1.3.1] shows that (LR) implies (RV) with the same index. (LR) says that the mass function is regularly varying, not only the tail. (SPAN) is the aperiodicity needed for local limit theorems. (LD) is used only in Section 6.4, and it holds for instance when $f_\sigma(n) \propto n^{-\alpha_\sigma - 1}$. Under (RV) the runs have finite means, and we put

$$\mu_\sigma = \mathbb{E}X_\sigma, \qquad s = \mu_+ + \mu_-, \qquad p = \mu_+/s, \tag{2.1}$$

so p is the long-run fraction of plus steps and $A_N/N \to p$ in probability.

Constants. Unindexed C and c are positive constants that depend only on the laws of the runs and may change from one use to the next. A constant with a numerical index, such as C_3 or c_2, or named after a source, such as the constant C_{LD} of the local large deviation bound in Lemma A.1(iii), which is not tied to (LD), keeps the value it receives where it is introduced to the end of the paper, and no index is used twice. A constant indexed by a parameter, such as C_η, also depends on it and is local to its statement or proof.

2.3 Scales and the moving profile

Under (RV) choose for each sign an increasing function $a_\sigma : (0,\infty) \to (0,\infty)$ with $t\,T_\sigma(a_\sigma(t)) \to 1$ as $t \to \infty$. So a_σ is regularly varying with index $1/\alpha_\sigma$, and $a_\sigma(m)$ is the scale of the stable fluctuation of a sum of m runs of sign σ. Put

$$b_{\sigma,N} = a_\sigma(N/s), \qquad B_N = \max(b_{+,N}, b_{-,N}), \qquad \theta_{\sigma,N} = b_{\sigma,N}/B_N \in (0,1], \tag{2.2}$$

and $x_{N,k} = (k - pN)/B_N$. The walk makes about N/s runs of each sign in N steps, so $b_{\sigma,N}$ is the fluctuation scale of the total length of the runs of sign σ, and B_N is the larger of the two. When $\alpha_+ \neq \alpha_-$ one ratio $\theta_{\sigma,N}$ tends to zero, and when the indices are equal the ratios may oscillate, so we keep them in the statements. We collect the facts about regular variation that recur.

Lemma 2.1 (regular variation)**.** *Let f be regularly varying with index ϱ.*

(i) (Uniform convergence.) The supremum of $|f(x)/f(y) - 1|$ over $x, y \geq x_0$ with $|x/y - 1| \leq r$ tends to zero as $x_0 \to \infty$ and $r \to 0$ [5, Theorems 1.2.1 and 1.5.2].

(ii) (Potter's bounds [5, Theorem 1.5.6].) For every $\delta > 0$ there is x_δ with $f(y)/f(x) \leq 2\max\{(y/x)^{\varrho+\delta}, (y/x)^{\varrho-\delta}\}$ for $x, y \geq x_\delta$. Under (RV), for every $c \geq 1$ there is C_c with $T_\sigma(x/c) \leq C_c T_\sigma(x)$ for $x \geq c$.

(iii) [5, Theorem 1.5.3] If $\varrho > 0$ and f is bounded above and away from zero on compact subsets of $[1,\infty)$, then $\sup_{1 \leq y \leq x} f(y) \leq C_f f(x)$ for $x \geq 1$.

(iv) (Karamata [5, Propositions 1.5.8 and 1.5.10].) Under (RV) there is C_{K} such that, for both signs and all $w \geq 1$,

$$\sum_{n<w} n\,T_\sigma(n) \leq C_{\mathrm{K}}\, w^2 T_\sigma(w), \qquad \sum_{n \geq w} T_\sigma(n) \leq C_{\mathrm{K}}\, w T_\sigma(w), \tag{2.3}$$

and $\sum_{n\ge w} T_\sigma(n) \sim w T_\sigma(w)/(\alpha_\sigma - 1)$ *as* $w \to \infty$.

(v) Under (RV), B_N *is nondecreasing and regularly varying with index* $1/\alpha_*$. *Moreover* $B_N T_\sigma(N) \to 0$, $N T_\sigma(b_{\sigma,N}) \to s$ *and* $B_N \log N = o(N)$.

(vi) Under (RV), for both signs, all large N *and all* $L \ge b_{\sigma,N}$,

$$\frac{s}{4}\Big(\frac{L}{b_{\sigma,N}}\Big)^{-\alpha_\sigma - 1} \le N T_\sigma(L) \le 4s\Big(\frac{L}{b_{\sigma,N}}\Big)^{-(\alpha_\sigma+1)/2}. \tag{2.4}$$

The proof is routine and is in Appendix A.1.

Let $K_\alpha = -\Gamma(1-\alpha) > 0$ for $1 < \alpha < 2$, and let Z_+ and Z_- be independent with

$$\mathbb{E}e^{itZ_\sigma} = \exp\big(K_{\alpha_\sigma}(-it)^{\alpha_\sigma}\big),$$

with the principal branch. These are the totally skewed stable laws that arise as limits of centered sums of the runs, and we write g_σ for the density of Z_σ. For $\theta = (\theta_+, \theta_-) \in [0,1]^2$ let h_θ be the density of

$$W_\theta = (1-p)\,\theta_+ Z_+ - p\,\theta_- Z_-, \tag{2.5}$$

let Θ be the compact set of $\theta \in [0,1]^2$ with $\max(\theta_+, \theta_-) = 1$, and put $\theta_N = (\theta_{+,N}, \theta_{-,N}) \in \Theta$. The moving profile is $h_N = h_{\theta_N}$. It is a stable density when $\alpha_+ = \alpha_-$, and otherwise a convolution of two stable densities with different indices. We write $H_N = \sup_x h_N(x)$ for its height. For each N let $\tau = \tau_N$ be a sign with $b_{\tau,N} = B_N$, taking $\tau = +$ if the two scales are equal. We call τ the dominant sign and $\bar\tau$ the other sign, and we put $\varsigma_+ = 1$ and $\varsigma_- = -1$.

Lemma 2.2 (the profile)**.** *Assume (RV).*

(a) There are C_1, C_2 *with* $\sup_N H_N \le C_1$ *and* $|h_N(x) - h_N(y)| \le C_2|x-y|$ *for all* N *and* x, y.

(b) $\varepsilon_h(R) = \sup_N \sup_{|x|\ge R} h_N(x)$ *and* $\varepsilon_h'(R) = \sup_N \int_{|x|>R} h_N(x)\,dx$ *tend to zero as* $R \to \infty$.

(c) The map $\theta \mapsto h_\theta$ *is continuous from* Θ *into the bounded continuous functions with the uniform norm. So* $h_N \to h_\theta$ *uniformly along every subsequence with* $\theta_N \to \theta$, *and* $\|h_{N'} - h_N\|_\infty \to 0$ *whenever* $N'/N \to 1$.

(d) $\inf_N H_N > 0$, *and* $\inf_N \min_{|x|\le K} h_N(x) > 0$ *for every* $K \ge 0$.

(e) For every N *and* $x \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$h_N(x) = \frac{s}{\mu_{\bar\tau}} \int_{\mathbb{R}} g_{\bar\tau}(y)\, g_\tau\Big(\varsigma_\tau \frac{sx}{\mu_{\bar\tau}} + \frac{\mu_\tau}{\mu_{\bar\tau}} \theta_{\bar\tau,N}\, y\Big) dy. \tag{2.6}$$

The proof is in Appendix A.1.

2.4 Renewal kernels

For each sign let u_σ be the renewal mass function of the runs of sign σ,

$$u_\sigma(0) = 1, \qquad u_\sigma(j) = \sum_{m\ge 1} f_\sigma^{*m}(j) \quad (j \ge 1),$$

the probability that some partial sum of independent copies of X_σ equals j. We also need

$$v_\sigma(j) = \sum_{m\ge 1} m\, f_\sigma^{*m}(j),$$

and the iterated kernels $u_m^\sigma = f_\sigma^{*m}$ for $m \ge 0$, with $u_0^\sigma = \delta_0$, and, for $m \ge 1$,

$$q_m^\sigma(k) = \sum_{r<k} u_{m-1}^\sigma(r)\, T_\sigma(k-r) \quad (k \ge 1), \qquad q_m^\sigma(k) = 0 \quad (k \le 0).$$

This is the convolution of u_{m-1}^σ with T_σ restricted to positive arguments of T_σ. The restriction matters, since $T_\sigma = 1$ at nonpositive arguments. Let $X_1^\sigma, X_2^\sigma, \dots$ be independent copies of X_σ and $S_m^\sigma = X_1^\sigma + \cdots + X_m^\sigma$, with $S_0^\sigma = 0$. Then S_m^σ has the law u_m^σ, and since X_m^σ is independent of S_{m-1}^σ, for $m, k \ge 1$

$$\mathbb{P}\big(S_{m-1}^\sigma < k \le S_m^\sigma\big) = \sum_{r<k} u_{m-1}^\sigma(r)\, T_\sigma(k-r) = q_m^\sigma(k). \tag{2.7}$$

So $q_m^\sigma(k)$ is the probability that the m-th run covers level k in the time of its sign. Every run has length at least 1, so S_m^σ is strictly increasing in m, and for each $k \ge 1$ exactly one $m \ge 1$ has $S_{m-1}^\sigma < k \le S_m^\sigma$. Hence, for $k \ge 1$,

$$\sum_{m\ge1} u_m^\sigma(k) = u_\sigma(k), \qquad \sum_{m\ge1} q_m^\sigma(k) = 1, \qquad \sum_{m\ge1} q_{m+1}^\sigma(k) = 1 - T_\sigma(k), \tag{2.8}$$

where the third sum is the second minus its term $q_1^\sigma = T_\sigma$. Summing the middle expression of (2.7) over m gives the covering identity

$$\sum_{m=1}^{k} T_\sigma(m)\, u_\sigma(k-m) = 1 \qquad (k \ge 1). \tag{2.9}$$

Under (RV) and (SPAN) for the sign σ the renewal theorem holds,

$$u_\sigma(j) \to 1/\mu_\sigma \qquad (j \to \infty), \tag{2.10}$$

and we prove it in local form in Lemma 3.1 (see also [17, Section XIII.3]).

The boundary kernel at the plus end records where a plus run can begin. For a start of sign σ_0 let

$$\kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j) = \mathbb{P}\big(\text{a plus run starts immediately after the } j\text{-th minus step}\big),$$

where for $j = 0$ the event is that a plus run starts at step 1. Count time in minus steps only. In both cases the ends of the minus runs form a renewal process with interarrival law X_-, started at 0. A plus run starts right after the j-th minus step exactly when j is a renewal epoch, with one exception. For a minus start the epoch $j = 0$ is followed by the first minus run. Hence

$$\kappa_+^{(+)}(j) = u_-(j) \quad (j \ge 0), \qquad \kappa_+^{(-)}(j) = u_-(j)\mathbf{1}_{\{j\ge1\}}. \tag{2.11}$$

The kernel at the minus end is defined in the same way with the signs exchanged. Every statement below is made at the plus end and holds at the minus end with the signs exchanged.

We refine $\kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(i)$ by the number of plus steps before the run. For $i \ge 0$ and $x \ge 0$ let $\rho_i^{(\sigma_0)}(x)$ be the probability that a plus run starts immediately after the i-th minus step (at step 1 if $i = 0$) and that exactly x plus steps precede it. At most one x is possible for each realization, so

$$\sum_{x\ge0} \rho_i^{(\sigma_0)}(x) = \kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(i). \tag{2.12}$$

A plus run that starts after the i-th minus step is preceded by m complete minus runs with $S_m^- = i$, and by m plus runs for a plus start and $m-1$ plus runs for a minus start. The two families of runs are independent, so

$$\rho_i^{(+)}(x) = \sum_{m\ge0} u_m^-(i)\, u_m^+(x), \qquad \rho_i^{(-)}(x) = \sum_{m\ge1} u_m^-(i)\, u_{m-1}^+(x). \tag{2.13}$$

2.5 Exact identities

The following identities hold for every N and need no hypothesis.

Proposition 2.3 (the fresh-plus identity)**.** *For $k, j \geq 1$ with $k + j = N$,*

$$F_N^+(k) = \sum_{m\geq 1} \big[u_m^-(j)\, q_{m+1}^+(k) + u_m^+(k)\, q_m^-(j)\big],$$

and $F_N^+(N) = T_+(N)$, $F_N^+(0) = 0$. Exchanging the signs gives the fresh-minus identity $F_N^-(k) = \sum_m [u_m^+(k) q_{m+1}^-(j) + u_m^-(j) q_m^+(k)]$ for $k, j \geq 1$, with $F_N^-(0) = T_-(N)$ and $F_N^-(N) = 0$.

Proof. We split according to the run that contains step N. For a fresh plus start the run lengths $X_1^+, X_2^+, \dots$ and $X_1^-, X_2^-, \dots$ are independent, and the runs alternate starting with a plus run. So the i-th plus run fills the steps in $(S_{i-1}^+ + S_{i-1}^-,\, S_i^+ + S_{i-1}^-]$, the i-th minus run fills those in $(S_i^+ + S_{i-1}^-,\, S_i^+ + S_i^-]$, and these intervals partition $\{1, 2, \dots\}$. Let $k + j = N$ with $0 \leq k \leq N$.

If step N lies in the i-th plus run, the first N steps contain exactly the S_{i-1}^- minus steps of the first $i-1$ minus runs, so $A_N = k$ means $S_{i-1}^- = j$, and then step $N = k+j$ lies in that run exactly when $S_{i-1}^+ < k \leq S_i^+$. The two events concern independent sequences, so by (2.7) this case has probability $u_{i-1}^-(j)\, q_i^+(k)$. If step N lies in the i-th minus run, then $A_N = S_i^+$, so $A_N = k$ means $S_i^+ = k$, and step N lies in that run exactly when $S_{i-1}^- < j \leq S_i^-$. This case has probability $u_i^+(k)\, q_i^-(j)$.

The cases are disjoint. For $k, j \geq 1$ the plus case with $i = 1$ vanishes because $u_0^-(j) = 0$, and $m = i - 1$ in the plus case and $m = i$ in the minus case give the formula. For $k = N$ only the plus case with $i = 1$ survives, with probability $q_1^+(N) = T_+(N)$. For $k = 0$ the plus case is impossible because step N is a plus step, and the minus case is impossible because $S_i^+ \geq 1$. The fresh minus start is the same with the signs exchanged. □

Proposition 2.4 (the first-run decomposition)**.** *For every initial run and every $0 \leq k \leq N$,*

$$P_N(k) = Q_+(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{k=N\}} + Q_-(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{k=0\}} + \sum_{d<N} \nu_+(d)\, F_{N-d}^-(k-d) + \sum_{d<N} \nu_-(d)\, F_{N-d}^+(k).$$

In particular $P_N(N) = Q_+(N)$ and $P_N(0) = Q_-(N)$.

Proof. We condition on the first run. If $\Sigma = +$ and $D \geq N$, then $A_N = N$, and this has probability $Q_+(N)$. If $\Sigma = +$ and $D = d < N$, the first d steps are plus steps and steps $d+1, \dots, N$ are the first $N - d$ steps of a fresh walk of sign $-$, independent of (Σ, D). So $A_N = d + A'$, where A' has the law F_{N-d}^-. The case $\Sigma = -$ is the same with $A_N = 0$ when $D \geq N$ and A_N of law F_{N-d}^+ when $D = d < N$. This gives the formula. For $d < N$, Proposition 2.3 gives $F_{N-d}^-(N-d) = 0$ and $F_{N-d}^+(0) = 0$, and $F_{N-d}^+(N) = F_{N-d}^-(-d) = 0$ trivially, so only the atoms survive at $k = N$ and $k = 0$. □

Lemma 2.5 (the Green identity)**.** *For each sign and every $b \geq 1$,*

$$\sum_{m\geq 1} \Pi_m^\sigma(b) = 1 + \mu_{\bar\sigma}\, u_\sigma(b).$$

Proof. Take a fresh walk of sign σ continued forever, with runs of sign σ of lengths $X_1^\sigma, X_2^\sigma, \dots$ and runs of sign $\bar\sigma$ of lengths $X_1^{\bar\sigma}, X_2^{\bar\sigma}, \dots$, all independent, the i-th run of sign $\bar\sigma$ coming right after the i-th run of sign σ. Let C_m be the number of steps of sign σ among the first m. By Tonelli's theorem $\sum_m \Pi_m^\sigma(b) = \mathbb{E}\,\#\{m \geq 1 : C_m = b\}$. Let $t_b < t_{b+1}$ be the b-th and $(b+1)$-th steps of sign σ. Then $C_m = b$ exactly for $t_b \leq m < t_{b+1}$. If step t_b is not

the last step of its run, then $t_{b+1} = t_b+1$. If it is, it ends the i-th run of sign σ for the unique i with $S_i^\sigma = b$, and then $t_{b+1} - t_b = 1 + X_i^{\bar\sigma}$. Hence $\#\{m : C_m = b\} = 1 + \sum_{i\ge1} \mathbf{1}_{\{S_i^\sigma = b\}} X_i^{\bar\sigma}$. Since $X_i^{\bar\sigma}$ is independent of S_i^σ, taking expectations and using (2.8) gives $1 + \mu_{\bar\sigma} u_\sigma(b)$. □

The next identity isolates the final run, which is the run that contains step N.

Proposition 2.6 (the final-run identity)**.** *For a fresh plus start, $N \ge 1$ and $0 \le j < N$,*

$$\begin{aligned} P_N(N-j) = &\sum_{r\ge0} u_r^-(j)\, \mathbb{E}\big[T_+(N-j-S_r^+);\, S_r^+ \le N-j-1\big] \\ &+ \sum_{m=1}^{j} T_-(m) \sum_{r\ge0} u_r^-(j-m)\, u_{r+1}^+(N-j). \end{aligned} \tag{2.14}$$

The first sum is the event that the final run is a plus run, and the second the event that it is a minus run of length at least m that starts at step $N-m+1$. Only $r \le j$ contributes, and for $j = 0$ the identity reads $P_N(N) = T_+(N)$.

Proof. We use the notation of the proof of Proposition 2.3. The $(r+1)$-th plus run starts at step $S_r^+ + S_r^- + 1$ with S_r^+ plus steps before it. It is the final run and $A_N = N - j$ exactly when the steps before it contain j minus steps, that is $S_r^- = j$, and its length satisfies $X_{r+1}^+ \ge N - j - S_r^+ \ge 1$. These conditions involve independent variables, which gives the term r of the first sum. The $(r+1)$-th minus run starts at step $S_{r+1}^+ + S_r^- + 1$ with S_{r+1}^+ plus steps before it. If it is the final run and starts at step $N-m+1$, then $A_N = N - j$ means $S_{r+1}^+ = N - j$, hence $S_r^- = N - m - (N-j) = j - m$, which needs $1 \le m \le j$, and its length satisfies $X_{r+1}^- \ge m$. This gives the second sum. Exactly one run is final, so the cases are disjoint. Finally $u_r^-(i) = 0$ for $r > i$ and $u_r^-(0) = \mathbf{1}_{\{r=0\}}$. □

By (2.13) the first sum of (2.14) equals $\sum_{x\le N-j-1} \rho_j^{(+)}(x) T_+(N-j-x)$. Section 7 describes how these identities compute the exact law.

Lemma 2.7 (the counting lemma)**.** *Fix $j \ge 0$ and $N > j$. On the event $\{A_N = N-j\}$ at most $j+1$ plus runs meet the first N steps (at most j if the first run is a minus run), and at least one of them has at least $(N-j)/(j+1)$ steps among the first N. For a fresh start of either sign and every $L \ge 1$, the probability that $A_N = N-j$ and two plus runs that meet the first N steps have length at least L is at most $(j+1)^2 T_+(L)^2$.*

Proof. On $\{A_N = N-j\}$ the first N steps contain j minus steps. Let r be the number of plus runs that meet them. Between two consecutive such runs lies a minus run inside the first N steps, so $r - 1 \le j$, and if the first run is a minus run it adds one more minus step, so $r \le j$. The $N-j$ plus steps are shared among $r \le j+1$ runs, so one of them has at least $(N-j)/(j+1)$ steps. For a fresh start the plus runs have independent lengths $X_1^+, X_2^+, \dots$, and on the event of the lemma there are $1 \le a < b \le j+1$ with $X_a^+ \ge L$ and $X_b^+ \ge L$. The union bound gives at most $\binom{j+1}{2} T_+(L)^2 \le (j+1)^2 T_+(L)^2$, and counting only the steps among the first N makes the event smaller. □

3 The bulk

The bulk is the window $|k - pN| = O(B_N)$, where the law of A_N is stable. The theorem of this section is a statement about every point of the range $\{0, \dots, N\}$ for a fresh start, with one error term and one bound that are uniform in k.

Theorem A (the bulk, fresh start)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN). For each starting sign σ_0,*

(a) $\sup_{k\in\mathbb{Z}} \big| B_N F_N^{\sigma_0}(k) - h_N(x_{N,k}) \big| \to 0.$

(b) $\sup_{N\ge 1}\sup_k B_N F_N^{\sigma_0}(k) < \infty$.

(c) for every $K>0$, $\displaystyle\sup_{|k-pN|\le KB_N}\Big|\frac{B_N F_N^{\sigma_0}(k)}{h_N(x_{N,k})}-1\Big|\to 0$.

The convergence covers every relation between the two scales $b_{+,N}$ *and* $b_{-,N}$*, including ratios that oscillate.*

What is new. Part (c) on a fixed window $|k-pN|\le KB_N$ also follows from Berger's strong renewal theorem [2, Theorem 3.3] for the walk of run lengths and the fresh-plus identity. The content is in (a) and (b). They control every point, including the remote points with $|k-pN|\gg B_N$, by one error term and one bound C/B_N, under (RV) and (SPAN) alone.

The fresh identity writes $F_N^{\sigma_0}(k)$ as a sum over the run index m of products of a kernel of each sign, and away from the bulk most of the sum comes from indices at which one factor is a local large deviation. Local bounds for the walk of run lengths away from its mean direction [2, Theorems 4.1 to 4.3] assume a local condition on the run law, which (RV) does not give. We bound only the factor of the dominant sign, by C/B_N, and sum the other factor, whose total mass is at most one. The two scales may differ and their ratio may oscillate, and Lemma 3.1 resolves the index of the covering run on the scale of its own sign. The classical facts on sums of runs (Lemma A.1) and the kernel bounds ((K1) to (K4), Lemmas A.2 and A.3) are in Appendix A.

3.1 The index of the covering run

The next lemma is the renewal theorem in local form, with the index of the run that covers a level resolved on its natural scale. For $j\ge 1$ and $K>0$ let

$$I_j^\sigma(K)=\big\{m\ge 1:\ |j-m\mu_\sigma|\le K\,a_\sigma(j/\mu_\sigma)\big\},\qquad y_m^\sigma(j)=\frac{j-m\mu_\sigma}{a_\sigma(j/\mu_\sigma)}.$$

We call $I_j^\sigma(K)$ the index window. For a modulus ω (a function with $\omega(r)\to 0$ as $r\to 0$) let $\mathcal{F}(\omega)$ be the set of functions ψ on $\mathbb{R}$ with $|\psi|\le 1$ and $|\psi(y)-\psi(y')|\le\omega(|y-y'|)$.

Lemma 3.1 (the index of the covering run)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN), and let* k *be a kernel of sign* σ*.*

(a) For every $K\ge 2$*,*

$$\limsup_{j\to\infty}\sum_{m\notin I_j^\sigma(K)}\mathsf{k}_m(j)\le\eta_\sigma(K)=\mathbb{P}(Z_\sigma\ge K-1)+e^{C_-(\sigma)+1-K/2}.$$

(b) For every modulus ω*,*

$$\sup_{\psi\in\mathcal{F}(\omega)}\Big|\sum_{m\ge 1}\mathsf{k}_m(j)\,\psi\big(y_m^\sigma(j)\big)-\frac{c_{\mathsf{k}}}{\mu_\sigma}\int_{\mathbb{R}}g_\sigma(y)\psi(y)\,dy\Big|\to 0\qquad(j\to\infty).$$

In particular $\sum_m u_m^\sigma(j)\to 1/\mu_\sigma$*, which is* (2.10)*.*

Proof. Write $\mu=\mu_\sigma$, $a=a_\sigma$, $J=J_\sigma(j)$ and $m_\pm=(j\pm Ka(j/\mu))/\mu$. Note that $a(x)/x\to 0$.

(a) Write $I=I_j^\sigma(K)$. By (K3), $\sum_{m\notin I}u_m(j)$ and $\sum_{m\notin I}q_m(j)$ are at most $\mathbb{P}(J\notin I)$, and $\sum_{m\notin I}q_{m+1}(j)\le\mathbb{P}(J-1\notin I)$. All three are at most $\mathbb{P}(J\le m_-+1)+\mathbb{P}(J>m_+)$. A count of runs below its typical value forces the sum of the runs above its mean, a right deviation, and a count above its typical value forces the sum below its mean, a left deviation.

Too few runs. Let $m' = \lfloor m_- + 1 \rfloor$. If $J \le m'$, then $S_{m'} \ge j$. Now $j - m'\mu \ge Ka(j/\mu) - \mu$, and $a(m') \le a(j/\mu)$ for large j. So

$$\mathbb{P}(J \le m_- + 1) \le \mathbb{P}\Big(\frac{S_{m'} - m'\mu}{a(m')} \ge K - \frac{\mu}{a(j/\mu)}\Big) \le \mathbb{P}(Z_{m'} \ge K - 1)$$

for large j. Since $m' \to \infty$, Lemma A.1(i) gives $\limsup_j \mathbb{P}(Z_{m'} \ge K-1) \le \mathbb{P}(Z_\sigma \ge K-1)$.

Too many runs. Let $m'' = \lfloor m_+ \rfloor$. If $J > m_+$, then $S_{m''} < j$, and $m''\mu - j \ge Ka(j/\mu) - \mu$. The local bound Lemma A.1(iii) does not apply to this left deviation, and Lemma A.1(iv) gives

$$\mathbb{P}(J > m_+) \le \exp\Big(C_- - \frac{Ka(j/\mu) - \mu}{a(m'')}\Big) \le e^{C_- + 1 - K/2}$$

for large j, since $m'' \le 2j/\mu$, $a(2j/\mu) \le 2a(j/\mu)$ and $\mu/a(j/\mu) \le 1$ eventually.

(b) Fix $K \ge 2$. The terms with $m \notin I_j^\sigma(K)$ contribute at most $\eta_\sigma(K) + o(1)$ by (a), and $\int_{|y|>K} g_\sigma \le \mathbb{P}(|Z_\sigma| > K)$. For $m \in I_j^\sigma(K)$ we have $m\mu/j \to 1$ uniformly, so $a(m)/a(j/\mu) \to 1$ uniformly. With $y_m = y_m^\sigma(j) \in [-K, K]$ the argument $(j - m\mu)/a(m) = y_m\, a(j/\mu)/a(m)$ differs from y_m by at most $K|a(j/\mu)/a(m) - 1|$. Lemma A.2 and the uniform continuity of g_σ give, uniformly in $m \in I_j^\sigma(K)$,

$$\mathsf{k}_m(j) = \frac{c_\mathsf{k}\, g_\sigma(y_m) + o(1)}{a(j/\mu)}.$$

The points y_m form an arithmetic progression with step $\Delta_j = \mu/a(j/\mu) \to 0$ in $[-K, K]$, with at most $2K/\Delta_j + 1$ points, so the $o(1)$ terms add up to $o(1)$. What remains is c_k/μ times a Riemann sum of $g_\sigma\psi$ over $[-K, K]$ with mesh Δ_j, whose distance from $\int_{-K}^{K} g_\sigma\psi$ is at most $2K(\omega_{g_\sigma}(\Delta_j) + \|g_\sigma\|_\infty \omega(\Delta_j)) + 2\Delta_j\|g_\sigma\|_\infty$, uniformly in $\psi \in \mathcal{F}(\omega)$. Hence the $\limsup$ of the supremum in (b) is at most $\eta_\sigma(K) + (c_\mathsf{k}/\mu)\mathbb{P}(|Z_\sigma| > K)$, and we let $K \to \infty$. With $\psi \equiv 1$ and $\mathsf{k} = u^\sigma$ we get (2.10). □

3.2 Proof of Theorem A

We write $F_N^{\sigma_0}(k)$ through the fresh identity as a sum over the index m of products of a kernel of sign $+$ and a kernel of sign $-$. In each product we resolve the factor of the dominant sign τ by its local limit and sum the factor of the other sign through Lemma 3.1. The points near the ends, the indices far from the index window of the other sign, the remote points and the central points are treated in turn, and no assumption on the ratio of the two scales enters.

Proof of Theorem A(a). Throughout we fix

$$\varepsilon = \min\Big\{\frac{p}{2},\ \frac{1-p}{2},\ \frac{1}{16\mu_+},\ \frac{1}{16\mu_-}\Big\},$$

and we write $\mu_{\max} = \max_\sigma \mu_\sigma$, $\mu_{\min} = \min_\sigma \mu_\sigma$, $\eta(K) = \max_\sigma \eta_\sigma(K)$ and $\delta(n) = \sup_{m \ge n} \max_{\sigma,\mathsf{k}} \delta_\mathsf{k}(m)$, the maximum over the six kernels. Then $\eta(K) \to 0$ as $K \to \infty$ and $\delta(n) \to 0$ as $n \to \infty$. A constant called C_i or c_i depends only on the laws of the runs and on ε, never on N, k, K or R.

Step 1. The fresh identity as a sum of products. We write $\mathcal{E}_N(k) = |B_N F_N^{\sigma_0}(k) - h_N(x_{N,k})|$ for $k \in \mathbb{Z}$. Let $1 \le k \le N-1$ and write $k_+ = k$ and $k_- = N - k$. By Proposition 2.3,

$$F_N^{\sigma_0}(k) = \sum_{i=1}^{2} \sum_{m \ge 1} \mathsf{k}_m^{+,i}(k_+)\, \mathsf{k}_m^{-,i}(k_-), \tag{3.1}$$

where $(\mathsf{k}^{+,1},\mathsf{k}^{-,1},\mathsf{k}^{+,2},\mathsf{k}^{-,2})$ is $(q^+_{m+1},u^-_m,u^+_m,q^-_m)$ for $\sigma_0=+$ and $(u^+_m,q^-_{m+1},q^+_m,u^-_m)$ for $\sigma_0=-$. Each is a kernel of the sign it carries, and in both cases

$$c_{\mathsf{k}^{+,1}}c_{\mathsf{k}^{-,1}}+c_{\mathsf{k}^{+,2}}c_{\mathsf{k}^{-,2}}=\mu_++\mu_-=s. \tag{3.2}$$

The endpoint atoms are $T_\sigma(N)$ or 0, and $B_NT_\sigma(N)\to 0$ by Lemma 2.1(v). The profile at $x_{N,k}$ for $k\le 0$ or $k\ge N$ is at most $\varepsilon_h(\min(p,1-p)N/B_N)$, which tends to zero by Lemma 2.2(b). So it remains to treat $1\le k\le N-1$.

We also need a uniform bound for one factor. Let N_1 be so large that for $N\ge N_1$ and both signs $C_5(\sigma,\varepsilon)b_{\sigma,N}e_{\sigma,N}\le 1$ and $a_\sigma(N/s)\le(8/\varepsilon)a_\sigma(\varepsilon N/(8\mu_\sigma))$. The second inequality holds eventually because the ratio tends to $(8\mu_\sigma/(\varepsilon s))^{1/\alpha_\sigma}<8/\varepsilon$. Then for $N\ge N_1$, $\varepsilon N\le j\le N$, all $m\ge 1$ and every kernel k of sign σ,

$$\mathsf{k}_m(j)\le\frac{C_6}{b_{\sigma,N}},\qquad C_6=1+8C_3/\varepsilon. \tag{3.3}$$

Indeed, for $8m\mu_\sigma\le\varepsilon N$ this is (A.1) with $\beta=\varepsilon$, and for larger m Lemma A.2 gives $\mathsf{k}_m(j)\le C_3/a_\sigma(\varepsilon N/(8\mu_\sigma))\le 8C_3/(\varepsilon b_{\sigma,N})$. For the dominant sign the bound is C_6/B_N. For the other sign it may be much larger, and we never use it there. In every product of (3.1) we bound the factor of the dominant sign and sum the factor of the other sign.

Step 2. Small counts and the ends of the range. Let $k_-<\varepsilon N$. By (K2) every nonzero product in (3.1) has $m\le k_-<\varepsilon N$. The plus factor sits at $k_+>(1-\varepsilon)N\ge N/2$, and $8m\mu_+\le N/2$, so Lemma A.3 with $\beta=1/2$ bounds it by $C_5(+,\frac12)e_{+,N}$. The minus factors add up to at most 1 by (K1). Hence $B_NF_N^{\sigma_0}(k)\le 2C_5(+,\frac12)B_Ne_{+,N}\to 0$ uniformly in these k, and the case $k_+<\varepsilon N$ is the same with the signs exchanged. In both cases $|k-pN|\ge\varepsilon N$, so the profile is at most $\varepsilon_h(\varepsilon N/B_N)\to 0$. So

$$\sup_{\min(k,N-k)<\varepsilon N}\mathcal{E}_N(k)\to 0. \tag{3.4}$$

From now on $\varepsilon N\le k_+,k_-\le N$, and (3.3) applies to both factors.

Step 3. Indices far from the index window of the other sign. Fix $K\ge 2$ and write $I=I^{\bar\tau}_{k_{\bar\tau}}(K)$. By (3.3) for the dominant factor and Lemma 3.1(a) for the other factor at the level $k_{\bar\tau}\ge\varepsilon N$,

$$\limsup_{N\to\infty}\sup_{\varepsilon N\le k\le(1-\varepsilon)N}B_N\sum_{i=1}^{2}\sum_{m\notin I}\mathsf{k}^{+,i}_m(k_+)\mathsf{k}^{-,i}_m(k_-)\le 2C_6\,\eta(K). \tag{3.5}$$

For $m\in I$ we record three facts. Let $N\ge N_2(K)$, where $N_2(K)\ge N_1$ is so large that $Ka_\sigma(N/\mu_\sigma)\le\varepsilon N/2$ for both signs. Then every $m\in I$ satisfies

$$\frac{\varepsilon N}{2\mu_{\bar\tau}}\le m\le\frac{2N}{\mu_{\bar\tau}}, \tag{3.6}$$

so Lemma A.2 applies to the dominant factor with the error $\delta(\lceil\varepsilon N/(2\mu_{\max})\rceil)\to 0$. Next, the definitions of p and s give the exact identity

$$k_\tau-m\mu_\tau=\varsigma_\tau\frac{s(k-pN)}{\mu_{\bar\tau}}+\frac{\mu_\tau}{\mu_{\bar\tau}}\big(k_{\bar\tau}-m\mu_{\bar\tau}\big). \tag{3.7}$$

For $\tau=+$ the right side is $(sk-\mu_+N+\mu_+k_-)/\mu_--m\mu_+=k-m\mu_+$, and $\tau=-$ is the same computation. Finally, by Lemma 2.1(ii) there is $N_3\ge N_2(K)$ such that for $N\ge N_3$

$$a_\sigma(N/\mu_\sigma)\le c_1\,b_{\sigma,N},\qquad a_\sigma(2N/\mu_{\min})\le c_2b_{\sigma,N},\qquad B_N\le c_3\,a_\tau(\varepsilon N/(2\mu_{\max})), \tag{3.8}$$

with $c_1=s/\mu_{\min}$, $c_2=2s/\mu_{\min}$ and $c_3=2/\varepsilon$, because the ratios tend to $(s/\mu_\sigma)^{1/\alpha_\sigma}$, $(2s/\mu_{\min})^{1/\alpha_\sigma}$ and $(2\mu_{\max}/(\varepsilon s))^{1/\alpha_\tau}$.

Step 4. Remote points. Let $R \ge 4\mu_{\max}/\mu_{\min}$ and put $K = K(R) = sR/(2c_1\mu_{\max}) = \mu_{\min}R/(2\mu_{\max}) \ge 2$. Let $N \ge N_3$ with N_3 taken for this K, and let $\varepsilon N \le k \le (1-\varepsilon)N$ and $|k - pN| > RB_N$. For $m \in I$ we have $|k_{\bar\tau} - m\mu_{\bar\tau}| \le Ka_{\bar\tau}(N/\mu_{\bar\tau}) \le c_1KB_N$ by (3.8), so (3.7) gives

$$|k_\tau - m\mu_\tau| \ge \frac{sRB_N}{\mu_{\bar\tau}} - \frac{\mu_\tau}{\mu_{\bar\tau}}c_1KB_N \ge \frac{sRB_N}{2\mu_{\bar\tau}}.$$

By (3.6) and (3.8), $a_\tau(m) \le c_2B_N$, so the scaled argument $z = (k_\tau - m\mu_\tau)/a_\tau(m)$ of the dominant factor has modulus at least c_4R with $c_4 = s/(2c_2\mu_{\max})$. Lemma A.2 and (3.8) give

$$B_N\mathsf{k}_m^{\tau,i}(k_\tau) \le \frac{B_N}{a_\tau(m)}\big(\mu_{\max}\bar g_\tau(c_4R) + \delta(m)\big) \le c_3\big(\mu_{\max}\bar g_\tau(c_4R) + \delta(\lceil \varepsilon N/(2\mu_{\max})\rceil)\big).$$

The factors of sign $\bar\tau$ add up to at most 1 for each i by (K1). Together with (3.5) and Lemma 2.2(b),

$$\limsup_{N\to\infty} \sup_{\substack{\varepsilon N\le k\le(1-\varepsilon)N\\ |k-pN|>RB_N}} \mathcal{E}_N(k) \le e(R) = 2c_3\mu_{\max}\max_\sigma \bar g_\sigma(c_4R) + 2C_6\eta(K(R)) + \varepsilon_h(R), \quad (3.9)$$

and $e(R) \to 0$ as $R \to \infty$.

Step 5. The central sum. Fix $R \ge 1$ and $K \ge 2$, and let $|k - pN| \le RB_N$, so $x = x_{N,k} \in [-R, R]$. For large N these points satisfy $\varepsilon N \le k \le (1-\varepsilon)N$, since $B_N = o(N)$. Let $m \in I$ and $y_m = y_m^{\bar\tau}(k_{\bar\tau}) \in [-K, K]$. Since $k_+/\mu_+ = N/s + xB_N/\mu_+$ and $k_-/\mu_- = N/s - xB_N/\mu_-$, we have $k_{\bar\tau}/\mu_{\bar\tau} = (N/s)(1+o(1))$ and $m = (N/s)(1+o(1))$, uniformly in $|x| \le R$ and $m \in I$. Lemma 2.1(i), applied to a_+ and to a_- separately, gives

$$a_{\bar\tau}(k_{\bar\tau}/\mu_{\bar\tau}) = b_{\bar\tau,N}(1+o(1)), \qquad a_\tau(m) = B_N(1+o(1)),$$

uniformly in $|x| \le R$ and $m \in I$, whichever sign is dominant. Since $b_{\bar\tau,N} = \theta_{\bar\tau,N}B_N$, the identity (3.7) gives for the argument of the dominant factor

$$z_m = \frac{k_\tau - m\mu_\tau}{a_\tau(m)} = \varsigma_\tau\frac{sx}{\mu_{\bar\tau}}\,r_1 + \frac{\mu_\tau}{\mu_{\bar\tau}}\theta_{\bar\tau,N}\,y_m\,r_2, \qquad r_1 = \frac{B_N}{a_\tau(m)}, \quad r_2 = \frac{a_{\bar\tau}(k_{\bar\tau}/\mu_{\bar\tau})}{b_{\bar\tau,N}}\,\frac{B_N}{a_\tau(m)},$$

where $r_1, r_2 \to 1$ uniformly. Since $|x| \le R$, $|y_m| \le K$ and $\theta_{\bar\tau,N} \le 1$,

$$\sup_{|x|\le R}\sup_{m\in I}\big|z_m - \zeta_{N,x}(y_m)\big| \to 0, \qquad \zeta_{N,x}(y) = \varsigma_\tau\frac{sx}{\mu_{\bar\tau}} + \frac{\mu_\tau}{\mu_{\bar\tau}}\theta_{\bar\tau,N}\,y.$$

Lemma A.2, $B_N/a_\tau(m) \to 1$ and the uniform continuity of g_τ give, uniformly in $|x| \le R$ and $m \in I$,

$$B_N\mathsf{k}_m^{\tau,i}(k_\tau) = c_{\mathsf{k}^{\tau,i}}\,g_\tau\big(\zeta_{N,x}(y_m)\big) + o(1). \quad (3.10)$$

Let $\psi_{N,x} = g_\tau \circ \zeta_{N,x}/\|g_\tau\|_\infty$. The slope of $\zeta_{N,x}$ is at most $\mu_{\max}/\mu_{\min}$, so $\psi_{N,x} \in \mathcal{F}(\omega)$ for all N and x, with $\omega(r) = \max_\sigma \omega_{g_\sigma}(\mu_{\max}r/\mu_{\min})/\|g_\sigma\|_\infty$. We multiply (3.10) by $\mathsf{k}_m^{\bar\tau,i}(k_{\bar\tau})$ and sum over $m \in I$. The $o(1)$ terms add up to $o(1)$ by (K1). Then we add back the indices $m \notin I$ in the sum of $\mathsf{k}_m^{\bar\tau,i}\psi_{N,x}(y_m)$, at a cost of at most $\eta(K) + o(1)$ by Lemma 3.1(a), and apply Lemma 3.1(b) at the level $k_{\bar\tau} \ge \varepsilon N$. This gives, uniformly in $|x| \le R$,

$$B_N\sum_{m\in I}\mathsf{k}_m^{+,i}(k_+)\mathsf{k}_m^{-,i}(k_-) = \frac{c_{\mathsf{k}^{\tau,i}}c_{\mathsf{k}^{\bar\tau,i}}}{\mu_{\bar\tau}}\int_{\mathbb{R}} g_{\bar\tau}(y)\,g_\tau\big(\zeta_{N,x}(y)\big)dy + O\big(\eta(K)\big) + o(1),$$

with the constant $\mu_{\max}\max_\sigma\|g_\sigma\|_\infty$ in $O(\eta(K))$. We sum over i and use (3.2). By Lemma 2.2(e) the integral with the weight $s/\mu_{\bar\tau}$ is exactly $h_N(x)$. Adding (3.5) for the indices outside I,

$$\limsup_{N\to\infty}\sup_{|k-pN|\le RB_N}\mathcal{E}_N(k) \le C_7\,\eta(K), \quad (3.11)$$

with $C_7 = 2C_6 + 2\mu_{\max}\max_\sigma\|g_\sigma\|_\infty$. Since K is arbitrary, the left side is zero.

Combination. Let $R \geq 4\mu_{\max}/\mu_{\min}$. Every $k \in \mathbb{Z}$ is an endpoint or lies outside $\{0, \dots, N\}$ (Step 1), or within εN of an end (Step 2), or is a remote point with $|k - pN| > RB_N$ (Step 4), or a central point with $|k - pN| \leq RB_N$ (Step 5). By (3.4), (3.9) and (3.11), $\limsup_N \sup_{k\in\mathbb{Z}} \mathcal{E}_N(k) \leq e(R)$, and we let $R \to \infty$. No step assumed that θ_N converges, since every error term is a maximum over the two signs of quantities that do not involve θ_N, and θ_N enters only through the slope of $\zeta_{N,x}$, which is at most $\mu_{\max}/\mu_{\min}$. □

Proof of Theorem A(b) and (c). For (b), part (a) and Lemma 2.2(a) give an N_4 with $B_N F_N^{\sigma_0}(k) \leq C_1 + 1$ for all $N \geq N_4$ and all k, and $B_N F_N^{\sigma_0}(k) \leq B_N \leq B_{N_4}$ for $N < N_4$, since B_N is nondecreasing. For (c), Lemma 2.2(d) gives $c_K > 0$ with $h_N \geq c_K$ on $[-K, K]$ for all N, and dividing the uniform error of (a) by c_K gives (c). □

The proof used (SPAN) only through Lemma A.1(ii), and it did not use (LR).

4 Big jumps and the boundary layer

Outside the bulk $P_N(k) = o(1/B_N)$ at each point by Theorem A. How much smaller it is depends on the distance of k from pN. On the ballistic range $k - pN \asymp N$ the values are of order $T_+(N)$, smaller than $1/B_N$ by a power of N. Near $k - pN = KB_N$ with K fixed they are still of order $1/B_N$, with a factor of order $K^{-\alpha_+-1}$ when the plus scale is the larger one (Remark 4.9). This section describes these values and the boundary layer with one kernel.

Throughout we write $j = N - k$ for the number of minus steps. For $k > pN$ put

$$L_k = \frac{k - pN}{1 - p}, \qquad \text{so that} \qquad N - L_k = \frac{j}{1-p} = \frac{js}{\mu_-}. \tag{4.1}$$

This is the length of the plus run that moves a typical configuration to the plus count k. For a start of sign σ_0 and $j \geq 1$ put

$$\gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j) = \sum_{i=0}^{j-1} \kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(i)\big(1 + \mu_+ u_-(j-i)\big), \qquad \gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(0) = 0, \tag{4.2}$$

and define the big-jump kernel by

$$G_N^{(\sigma_0)}(k) = \gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(N-k)\, f_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor) + T_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)\, \kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(N-k), \qquad pN < k \leq N. \tag{4.3}$$

The first term is a complete plus run of length about L_k. The coefficient $\gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j)$ counts its admissible positions. The run starts right after the i-th minus step, which has probability $\kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(i)$, and the fresh minus walk that follows it must hold the other $j - i$ minus steps. By the Green identity, Lemma 2.5, the expected number of lengths of that walk that do so is $1 + \mu_+ u_-(j-i)$. The second term is a plus run in progress at time N, of length at least L_k. By (2.10) and (2.11), $\kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(i) \to 1/\mu_-$ and $u_-(i) \to 1/\mu_-$, so a Cesàro average gives

$$\gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j) \sim \frac{js}{\mu_-^2} = \frac{N - L_k}{\mu_-} \qquad (j \to \infty). \tag{4.4}$$

At $k = N - j$ with j fixed the first term is of order $T_+(N)/N$ and the second is $T_+(N)\kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j)$ up to a factor $1 + o(1)$, so the kernel reduces to the boundary layer. As $j \to \infty$ the coefficient of the second term tends to $1/\mu_-$, its value in the interior. So one kernel covers the big-jump zone and the boundary layer.

The zone starts at a multiple of B_N when the plus scale is the larger one. Otherwise it starts a little later, and we put

$$\lambda_N = 1 + \log \frac{B_N}{b_{+,N}} = 1 + \log \frac{1}{\theta_{+,N}} \ \geq 1. \tag{4.5}$$

So $\lambda_N = 1$ when $b_{+,N} = B_N$, for instance for all large N when $\alpha_+ < \alpha_-$, and $\lambda_N = O(\log N)$ in all cases.

Theorem B (big jumps and the boundary layer)**.** *Let the start be fresh with sign σ_0, and write $\kappa = \kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}$ and $G_N = G_N^{(\sigma_0)}$.*

(a) (The boundary layer.) Assume (RV) for the plus sign. For every fixed $j \geq 0$,

$$\frac{P_N(N-j)}{T_+(N)} \to \kappa(j).$$

(b) (The big-jump zone.) Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for both signs and (LR) for the plus sign. Then

$$\lim_{K\to\infty} \limsup_{N\to\infty} \sup_{pN+K\lambda_N B_N \leq k \leq N} \Big| \frac{P_N(k)}{G_N(k)} - 1 \Big| = 0,$$

where $G_N(k) = 0$ only if $P_N(k) = 0$, and then the ratio is read as 1. In particular, with the size function

$$\widehat{G}_N(k) = \frac{N}{L_k}\, T_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor), \tag{4.6}$$

we have

$$\lim_{K\to\infty} \limsup_{N\to\infty} \sup_{pN+K\lambda_N B_N \leq k \leq N} \frac{|P_N(k) - G_N(k)|}{\widehat{G}_N(k)} = 0,$$

and this additive form also holds for the kernel $\overline{G}_N = \overline{G}_N^{(\sigma_0)}$ obtained from (4.3) *by replacing $\gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(N-k)$ with $(N - L_k)/\mu_-$.*

(c) (Uniform boundary layer.) Under the hypotheses of (b), for every $\delta_N \to 0$,

$$\sup_{0 \leq j \leq \delta_N N} \Big| \frac{P_N(N-j)}{T_+(N)} - \kappa(j) \Big| \to 0$$

and

$$\sup\Big\{ \Big| \frac{P_N(N-j)}{T_+(N)\kappa(j)} - 1 \Big| \;\Big|\; 0 \leq j \leq \delta_N N,\ \kappa(j) > 0 \Big\} \to 0.$$

The same holds at the minus end with the signs exchanged.

The exact coefficient $\gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j)$ matters for the ratio form at bounded j with $\kappa(j) = 0$. If $f_-(1) = 0$, then for a plus start $P_N(N-1) = f_+(N-1)$ and $G_N(N-1) = f_+(\lfloor N - s/\mu_- \rfloor)$, whose ratio tends to one by (LR), while the limit coefficient s/μ_-^2 would not. In the additive form the two coefficients agree. In (c) the condition $\kappa(j) > 0$ excludes nothing but $j = 0$ for a minus start when $f_-(1) > 0$.

The double limit in (b) is equivalent to the single limit $\sup |P_N(k)/G_N(k) - 1| \to 0$ over $pN + K_N\lambda_N B_N \leq k \leq N$ for every sequence $K_N \to \infty$. It cannot be replaced by a fixed K. Fix K and let $k = pN + KB_N$. Theorem A(c) gives $B_N P_N(k) = h_N(x_{N,k}) + o(1)$. By Remark 4.9 the ratio of $h_N(K)$ to $B_N G_N(k)$ tends to one only as $K \to \infty$. When $\theta_{+,N} \to 0$ a factor in front of B_N that tends to infinity is also needed (Remark 4.10). Theorem 4.13 in Section 4.5 finds the right factor. It is a quantity $\xi_N = o(\lambda_N)$ given by a Cramér transform of the minus runs, and the zone starts at $(1+\delta)\xi_N B_N$ and not at $(1-\delta)\xi_N B_N$. So the window $KB_N \leq k - pN \leq K\lambda_N B_N$ left by (b) shrinks to $K \leq x_{N,k} \leq (1+\delta)\xi_N$. On it Theorem 4.13 describes P_N on the logarithmic scale, and the strip $(1 \pm \delta)\xi_N$ around the start remains open. This window lies on the side of the sign with the smaller scale. When the minus scale is the smaller one it is the window at the minus end given by the same statements with the signs exchanged.

4.1 Giant runs

Every point mass in this section is decomposed according to the plus runs that occupy many steps. We use the weights $\rho_i^{(\sigma_0)}(x)$ of Section 2.4, with the representation (2.13), and for $i \ge 1$ and $x \ge 0$ we put

$$\beta_i(x) = \Pi^-_{i+x}(i),$$

the probability that a fresh minus walk on $i+x$ steps has exactly i minus steps. Then

$$\sum_{x\ge 0} \rho_i^{(\sigma_0)}(x) = \kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(i), \qquad \sum_{x\ge 0} \beta_i(x) = 1 + \mu_+ u_-(i), \tag{4.7}$$

by (2.12) and by the Green identity, Lemma 2.5.

We need β_i in terms of sums of runs. Take a fresh minus walk with minus runs $X_1^-, X_2^-, \dots$ and plus runs $X_1^+, X_2^+, \dots$ in the order $X_1^- X_1^+ X_2^- X_2^+ \cdots$. Let $J = J_-(i)$ be the index of the minus run that contains the i-th minus step, in the notation of (K3) in Appendix A.3, and put $\xi_i = X_J^+ \mathbf{1}_{\{S_J^- = i\}}$. The i-th minus step is step $i + S_{J-1}^+$. The next minus step follows it at once unless the run X_J^- ends there, and then it follows after X_J^+ plus steps. Hence

$$\beta_i(x) = \mathbb{P}\big(S_{J-1}^+ \le x \le S_{J-1}^+ + \xi_i\big). \tag{4.8}$$

Here J depends only on the minus runs, and X_J^+ is independent of $(J, S_{J-1}^+, X_1^-, \dots, X_J^-)$.

For an integer $g \ge 1$ let $\mathcal{G}_g$ be the number of plus runs that have at least g steps among the first N steps. We call these runs giant. A complete run counts with its length, and the final run counts with the number of its steps up to step N. Let M_N be the largest number of steps that a plus run has among the first N steps, so $\{M_N < g\} = \{\mathcal{G}_g = 0\}$.

Lemma 4.1 (the giant identity)**.** *For every start of sign σ_0, every N, every $0 \le j < N$ with $k = N - j$, and every integer $g \ge 1$,*

$$\mathbb{E}\big[\mathcal{G}_g \mathbf{1}_{\{A_N = k\}}\big] = \mathrm{Cen}_g(k) + \mathrm{Int}_g(k), \tag{4.9}$$

where, with $\rho_i = \rho_i^{(\sigma_0)}$,

$$\mathrm{Cen}_g(k) = \sum_{x\ge 0,\ N-j-x\ge g} \rho_j(x)\, T_+(N-j-x),$$

$$\mathrm{Int}_g(k) = \sum_{i=0}^{j-1} \sum_{x,x'\ge 0,\ N-j-x-x'\ge g} \rho_i(x)\, \beta_{j-i}(x')\, f_+(N-j-x-x').$$

Consequently

$$P_N(k) = \mathbb{P}(A_N = k,\ M_N < g) + \mathrm{Cen}_g(k) + \mathrm{Int}_g(k) - \mathbb{E}\big[(\mathcal{G}_g - 1)^+ \mathbf{1}_{\{A_N = k\}}\big], \tag{4.10}$$

and, with $f_+^*(n) = \sup_{m\ge n} f_+(m)$,

$$\mathrm{Cen}_g(k) \le \kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j)\, T_+(g), \qquad \mathrm{Int}_g(k) \le \gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j)\, f_+^*(g). \tag{4.11}$$

Proof. By linearity, the left side of (4.9) is the sum over all plus runs of the probability that the run is giant and $A_N = k$. We split the runs into the final run and the complete runs.

Let the final run be a plus run that starts at step $t+1$. All j minus steps precede it, so $t = j + x$, where x is the number of plus steps before it. The run has $N - j - x$ steps up to step N, and its length is at least $N - j - x$. The length is independent of the runs before it. So this case contributes $\rho_j(x) T_+(N-j-x)$ for each x with $N - j - x \ge g$, which is $\mathrm{Cen}_g(k)$.

Let a complete plus run start right after the i-th minus step, with x plus steps before it, and let its length be y. It occupies steps $i+x+1$ to $i+x+y$, and $i+x+y \le N-1$. The runs after it form a fresh minus walk, independent of everything before. On $\{A_N = k\}$ this walk holds the remaining $j-i$ minus steps among its $N-i-x-y \ge 1$ steps. Since its first step is a minus step, $j-i \ge 1$. Write $N-i-x-y = (j-i)+x'$. Then $y = N-j-x-x'$, and this case contributes $\rho_i(x) f_+(y) \beta_{j-i}(x')$. A fresh plus start has $\rho_0 = \delta_0$, and then the first run has law f_+, as every other plus run. Summing over $i<j$, x and x' with $y \ge g$ gives $\mathrm{Int}_g(k)$.

For (4.10) note that $\mathbf{1}_{\{\mathcal{G}_g \ge 1\}} = \mathcal{G}_g - (\mathcal{G}_g - 1)^+$. For (4.11) bound T_+ by $T_+(g)$ and f_+ by $f_+^*(g)$ on the ranges of summation, and use (4.7). □

4.2 The boundary layer

We use two consequences of (RV) for the plus sign. First, $T_+(n+1)/T_+(n) \to 1$, so $f_+(n)/T_+(n) \to 0$ and

$$f_+^*(n) \le \sup_{m \ge n} \frac{f_+(m)}{T_+(m)}\, T_+(n) = o\big(T_+(n)\big). \tag{4.12}$$

Second, a sum of $m' \ge 1$ plus runs equal to x has a summand of size at least x/m'. Conditioning on the other summands gives

$$\mathbb{P}(S_{m'}^+ = x) \le m'\, f_+^*(x/m'). \tag{4.13}$$

Proof of Theorem B(a). Fix $j \ge 0$. If $j=0$ then $P_N(N)$ is $T_+(N)$ for a plus start and 0 for a minus start, which is $\kappa(0)T_+(N)$. Let $j \ge 1$ and take $g = g'_N = \lceil (N-j)/(j+1) \rceil$ in Lemma 4.1. By Lemma 2.7, on $\{A_N = N-j\}$ some plus run has at least g'_N steps, so the first term of (4.10) vanishes. Since $g'_N \ge N/(2j+2)$ for large N, Lemma 2.1(ii) gives $T_+(g'_N) \le C_j T_+(N)$.

The last term of (4.10). There are at most $j+1$ plus runs, so $(\mathcal{G}_g - 1)^+ \le (j+1)\mathbf{1}_{\{\mathcal{G}_g \ge 2\}}$. The second part of Lemma 2.7 gives

$$\mathbb{E}\big[(\mathcal{G}_g - 1)^+ \mathbf{1}_{\{A_N = N-j\}}\big] \le (j+1)^3\, T_+(g'_N)^2 = O\big(T_+(N)^2\big) = o\big(T_+(N)\big).$$

The term Int_g. It contains the configurations of the second sum of (2.14), a complete giant plus run followed by a final minus run of length $m \le j$, which are the leading term of $P_N(N-j)$ when $\kappa(j) = 0$. By (4.11) and (4.12), $\mathrm{Int}_g(N-j) \le \gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j) f_+^*(g'_N) = o(T_+(g'_N)) = o(T_+(N))$.

The term Cen_g. Split the sum at $x = N/4$. For $x \le N/4$ and large N we have $N-j-x \ge N/2 \ge g'_N$, and $T_+(N-j-x)/T_+(N)$ is at most $T_+(\lfloor N/2 \rfloor)/T_+(N)$, which is bounded by Lemma 2.1(ii). For each fixed x the ratio tends to one. Since ρ_j is a finite measure that does not depend on N, dominated convergence and (4.7) give

$$\frac{1}{T_+(N)} \sum_{x \le N/4} \rho_j(x)\, T_+(N-j-x) \to \sum_{x \ge 0} \rho_j(x) = \kappa(j).$$

For $x > N/4$ we use (2.13). The plus sums there have at most j terms, and $\sum_m u_m^-(j) \le 1$. So (4.13) gives $\rho_j(x) \le j\, f_+^*(N/(4j))$. Since $\sum_x T_+(N-j-x) \le \sum_{n \ge 1} T_+(n) = \mu_+$,

$$\sum_{x > N/4} \rho_j(x)\, T_+(N-j-x) \le j\mu_+ f_+^*\big(N/(4j)\big) = o\big(T_+(N)\big),$$

by (4.12) and Lemma 2.1(ii). Adding the four terms gives $P_N(N-j) = \kappa(j) T_+(N) + o(T_+(N))$. □

At fixed j the giant run is the run in progress at time N, and its law enters only through T_+, which is why (a) needs no local hypothesis.

4.3 The big-jump zone

In the zone we take $g = \lceil \eta L_k \rceil$ in Lemma 4.1 with a small fixed η. Then (4.10) has four terms, and we treat them in three lemmas. Lemma 4.3 bounds the contribution with no giant run, Lemma 4.4 the contribution with two, and Lemma 4.6 evaluates Cen_g and Int_g. Note that $k \ge L_k$ for $pN < k \le N$, since $k - L_k = p(N-k)/(1-p)$.

We also need a bound for right deviations without big summands. It is the elementary exponential estimate behind the inequalities of Fuk and Nagaev [20] and [32, Theorems 1.1 and 1.2], and we include the short proof.

Lemma 4.2 (truncated right deviations)**.** *Assume (RV) for the plus sign. For all $m \ge 1$, $w \ge 1$ and $z > 0$,*

$$\mathbb{P}\Big(S_m^+ - m\mu_+ \ge z,\ \max_{i \le m} X_i^+ < w\Big) \le e^{C_{\mathrm{K}}} \big(m\, T_+(w)\big)^{z/(2w)}.$$

Proof. If $mT_+(w) \ge 1$ there is nothing to prove. Otherwise let $\vartheta = \frac{1}{2}\log(1/(mT_+(w))) > 0$. For $0 \le v \le \vartheta$ we have $e^v \le 1 + v + \frac{1}{2}v^2 e^{\vartheta}$. We use this with $v = \vartheta X/w$ on $\{X < w\}$, where $X = X_+$. By summation by parts and (2.3), $\mathbb{E}[X^2 \mathbf{1}_{\{X<w\}}] \le 2\sum_{n<w} nT_+(n) \le 2C_{\mathrm{K}} w^2 T_+(w)$. With $1 + v \le e^v$ this gives $\mathbb{E}[e^{\vartheta X/w}\mathbf{1}_{\{X<w\}}] \le \exp(\vartheta\mu_+/w + C_{\mathrm{K}}\vartheta^2 e^{\vartheta} T_+(w))$. Markov's inequality and independence give the bound $\exp(-\vartheta z/w + C_{\mathrm{K}} m\vartheta^2 e^{\vartheta} T_+(w))$. Here $m\vartheta^2 e^{\vartheta} T_+(w) = \vartheta^2 e^{-\vartheta} \le 1$, and $e^{-\vartheta z/w} = (mT_+(w))^{z/(2w)}$. □

Lemma 4.3 (no giant run)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN). Let $0 < \eta \le 1/16$ and $r = 1/(16\eta)$, so $r \ge 1 > 1/\alpha_+$. There are constants $C, c, C_8 > 0$ such that, for every fresh start, all large N and all $pN < k \le N$ with $L_k \ge C_8 B_N$,*

$$\mathbb{P}\big(A_N = k,\ M_N < \eta L_k\big) \le C\,\frac{(NT_+(L_k))^r}{b_{+,N}} + \frac{C}{b_{-,N}}\, e^{-cL_k/b_{-,N}} + C\, e^{-N^c}.$$

Proof. Write $L = L_k$, $j = N - k$ and P_0 for the probability on the left. If $j = 0$ then the whole walk is one plus run and $P_0 = 0$. Let $j \ge 1$, and take first a plus start. On $\{A_N = k\}$ step N lies either in the $(m+1)$-th plus run, and then the first m minus runs sum to j and $S_m^+ < k \le S_{m+1}^+$, or in the m-th minus run, and then $S_m^+ = k$ and $S_{m-1}^- < j \le S_m^-$, as in the proof of Proposition 2.3. On $\{M_N < \eta L\}$ the plus runs that lie inside the first N steps are shorter than ηL, and in the first case the final run has $k - S_m^+ < \eta L$ steps. The plus and minus runs are independent. Hence $P_0 \le E_1 + E_2$ with

$$E_1 = \sum_{m \ge 0} u_m^-(j)\, q_{m+1}^{\eta}, \qquad q_{m+1}^{\eta} = \sum_{1 \le v < \eta L} \mathbb{P}\Big(S_m^+ = k - v,\ \max_{i \le m} X_i^+ < \eta L\Big) T_+(v),$$
$$E_2 = \sum_{m \ge 1} \mathbb{P}\Big(S_m^+ = k,\ \max_{i \le m} X_i^+ < \eta L\Big)\, q_m^-(j).$$

For a minus start the plus run that contains step N is the m-th one, preceded by m minus runs and $m-1$ plus runs, and the minus run that contains step N is the $(m+1)$-th one, preceded by m plus runs. So E_1 becomes $\sum_{m \ge 1} u_m^-(j) q_m^{\eta}$, where q_m^{η} is built on $\mathbb{P}(S_{m-1}^+ = k - v, \dots)$, and E_2 becomes $\sum_{m \ge 1} \mathbb{P}(S_m^+ = k, \dots)\, q_{m+1}^-(j)$. We note below the two places where this changes the argument.

We split the indices. Put $d_1 = k - m\mu_+$ and $d_2 = m\mu_- - j$. Then $\mu_- d_1 + \mu_+ d_2 = \mu_- k - \mu_+ j = s(k - pN) = \mu_- L$. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be the set of m with $d_1 \ge L/2$ and $\mathcal{B}$ its complement. For $m \in \mathcal{B}$ we get $d_2 \ge y_2 = \mu_- L/(2\mu_+)$. The kernel sums $\sum_m u_m^-(j)$, $\sum_m q_m^-(j)$, $\sum_m q_{m+1}^-(j)$, $\sum_m q_m^+(k)$ and $\sum_m u_m^+(k)$ are at most 1 by (2.8). So $E_1 + E_2$ is at most the sum of the suprema over $m \in \mathcal{A}$ of the plus factors and the suprema over $m \in \mathcal{B}$ of the minus factors.

The indices in $\mathcal{A}$. Let $m \in \mathcal{A}$ and let v' be an integer with $v' - m\mu_+ \geq L/4$. Every $k - v$ in q^{η}_{m+1} is such a v', since $k - v - m\mu_+ \geq L/2 - \eta L$, and so is k. For a minus start the relevant sum S^+_{m-1} has one term fewer, so its deviation $k - v - (m-1)\mu_+$ is larger by μ_+, and the bound below applies with $m-1$ in place of m. For $m \leq 1$ the probability $\mathbb{P}(S^+_m = v', \max_i X^+_i < \eta L)$ vanishes, because $v' \geq L/4 > \eta L$. For $m \geq 2$ split the indices into two halves of sizes $\lfloor m/2 \rfloor$ and $\lceil m/2 \rceil$. On $\{S^+_m = v'\}$ one half exceeds its mean by at least $L/8$, and then the other half takes one exact value. By Lemma 4.2 with $w = \eta L$ and $z = L/8$, and by Lemma A.1(ii),

$$\mathbb{P}\Big(S^+_m = v',\ \max_{i \leq m} X^+_i < \eta L\Big) \leq 2e^{C_{\mathrm{K}}} \big(mT_+(\eta L)\big)^r \min\Big(1, \frac{\bar{u}_+}{a_+(\lfloor m/2 \rfloor)}\Big).$$

The indices in $\mathcal{A}$ satisfy $m \leq m_+ = k/\mu_+ \leq N/\mu_+$, and $m_+ \geq N/s$ since $k > pN$. Since $r > 1/\alpha_+$, Lemma 2.1(ii) for a_+ shows that the right side is largest up to a constant at $m = m_+$. Also $a_+(m_+) \geq a_+(N/s) = b_{+,N}$ and $T_+(\eta L) \leq C_\eta T_+(L)$. With $\sum_v T_+(v) \leq 1 + \mu_+$ in q^{η}_{m+1} the plus factors are at most $C(NT_+(L))^r / b_{+,N}$.

The indices in $\mathcal{B}$. Let $m \in \mathcal{B}$, so $x_m = m\mu_- - j \geq y_2$ and in particular $m \geq y_2/\mu_-$, which is large. On $\{S^-_m = j\}$ one half of the minus runs falls below its mean by at least $x_m/2$, and the other half takes one exact value. Lemma A.1(iv) for the half, with $a_-(\lceil m/2 \rceil) \leq a_-(m)$, and Lemma A.1(ii) give

$$u^-_m(j) \leq 2e^{C_-} e^{-x_m/(2a_-(m))} \min\Big(1, \frac{\bar{u}_-}{a_-(\lfloor m/2 \rfloor)}\Big).$$

Next, $q^-_m(j) = \sum_{v \geq 1} T_-(v) u^-_{m-1}(j-v) \leq \mu_- \sup_{v \geq 1} u^-_{m-1}(j-v)$, and $(m-1)\mu_- - (j-v) \geq x_m - \mu_- \geq x_m/2$. So $q^-_m(j)$ obeys the same bound with μ_- in front, $x_m/4$ in the exponent and $\lfloor (m-1)/2 \rfloor$ in place of $\lfloor m/2 \rfloor$. For a minus start, $q^-_{m+1}(j) = \sum_{v \geq 1} T_-(v) u^-_m(j-v) \leq \mu_- \sup_{v \geq 1} u^-_m(j-v)$ and $m\mu_- - (j-v) \geq x_m$, so it obeys the bound for $u^-_m(j)$ with μ_- in front. Let $m \leq 2N/\mu_-$. Then $t = a_-(m) \leq c_5 b_{-,N}$, and Lemma 2.1(ii) gives $a_-(m) \leq c_6 a_-(\lfloor (m-1)/2 \rfloor)$. So all these bounds are at most $Ct^{-1}e^{-y_2/(4t)}$. The function $t \mapsto t^{-1}e^{-y_2/(4t)}$ increases on $(0, y_2/4]$. Choose $C_8 = 8c_5\mu_+/\mu_-$. Then $L \geq C_8 B_N$ gives $c_5 b_{-,N} \leq y_2/4$, and the bounds are at most $Cb^{-1}_{-,N} e^{-cL/b_{-,N}}$. Let $m > 2N/\mu_-$. Then $x_m \geq m\mu_- - N \geq m\mu_-/2$, and Lemma 2.1(ii) gives $a_-(m) \leq m^{1-2c}$ for large m with $c = (1 - 1/\alpha_-)/4$. So the bounds are at most $Ce^{-cm^{2c}} \leq Ce^{-N^c}$.

Adding the bounds for $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ proves the lemma. □

The second term of Lemma 4.3, from minus runs falling short of their mean, is the reason for λ_N.

Lemma 4.4 (two giant runs)**.** *Assume (RV) and (LR) for the plus sign, and let $0 < \eta < 1$. There is a constant C such that, for every fresh start, all N and all $pN < k \leq N$ with $\eta L_k \geq 1$ and $g = \lceil \eta L_k \rceil$,*

$$\mathbb{E}\big[(\mathcal{G}_g - 1)^+ \mathbf{1}_{\{A_N = k\}}\big] \leq C\Big[(j+1)^2 \frac{T_+(L_k)^2}{L_k} + (j+1)\, T_+(L_k)^2\Big].$$

Proof. Since $(n-1)^+ \leq n(n-1)/2$ for integers $n \geq 0$, it suffices to bound the expected number of pairs of giant runs on $\{A_N = k\}$. The second run of a pair is complete or final. As in the proof of Lemma 4.1, the walk between the two runs is a fresh minus walk until a plus run starts after $i_2 \geq 1$ of its minus steps, with x_2 plus steps before it, which has probability $\rho^{(-)}_{i_2}(x_2)$. For two complete runs of lengths y_1, y_2 the expected number of pairs is

$$\sum_{i_1+i_2+i_3=j} \sum_{x_1,x_2,x_3} \rho^{(\sigma_0)}_{i_1}(x_1)\, \rho^{(-)}_{i_2}(x_2)\, \beta_{i_3}(x_3) \sum_{y_1+y_2=N-j-x_1-x_2-x_3,\ y_1,y_2 \geq g} f_+(y_1) f_+(y_2),$$

with $i_2, i_3 \geq 1$. For a complete run followed by the final run the expected number is the same with $\beta_{i_3}(x_3)$ removed, $i_1 + i_2 = j$, and $T_+(y_2)$ in place of $f_+(y_2)$. By (LR), $f_+(n) \leq C_{\mathrm{LR}} T_+(n)/n$ for all $n \geq 1$, so $f_+^*(g) \leq C_{\mathrm{LR}} T_+(g)/g$. Let $y_1 + y_2 = y$ with both at least g, so $y/2 \geq g$. The larger of y_1, y_2 is at least $y/2$. So

$$\sum f_+(y_1) f_+(y_2) \leq 2 f_+^*(g) T_+(g), \qquad \sum f_+(y_1) T_+(y_2) \leq f_+^*(g) \sum_{n \geq g} T_+(n) + T_+(g)^2,$$

and the second sum is at most $(C_{\mathrm{K}} C_{\mathrm{LR}} + 1) T_+(g)^2$ by (2.3). The weights have total mass at most $(1+\mu_+)(j+1)^2$ in the first case and $j+1$ in the second, by (4.7). Finally $T_+(g) \leq C_\eta T_+(L_k)$ and $g \geq \eta L_k$. □

The terms Cen_g and Int_g need the spread of the weights. A plus run that starts after the i-th minus step is preceded by about $\bar{x}_i = i\mu_+/\mu_-$ plus steps, and the fluctuation is of order B_N. For $z > 0$ put

$$\mathrm{sp}_i^\rho(z) = \sum_{x \,:\, |x - \bar{x}_i| > z} \rho_i^{(\sigma_0)}(x), \qquad \mathrm{sp}_i^\beta(z) = \sum_{x \,:\, |x - \bar{x}_i| > z} \beta_i(x).$$

Lemma 4.5 (spread of the weights)**.** *Assume (RV). For every $\varepsilon > 0$ there are Z and N_0 such that $\mathrm{sp}_i^\rho(ZB_N) \leq \varepsilon$ and $\mathrm{sp}_i^\beta(ZB_N) \leq \varepsilon$ for all $N \geq N_0$ and all $0 \leq i \leq N$.*

Proof. Let $\varpi_\sigma(z) = \sup_{m \geq 1} \mathbb{P}(|S_m^\sigma - m\mu_\sigma| > z\, a_\sigma(m))$. By Lemma A.1(i) the laws of $(S_m^\sigma - m\mu_\sigma)/a_\sigma(m)$ converge, so they are tight, and $\varpi_\sigma(z) \to 0$ as $z \to \infty$. By Lemma 2.1(ii) there is c_7 with $a_\sigma(m) \leq c_7 B_N$ for $m \leq 4N/\mu_-$ and large N.

The number of minus runs. By (K3), $\{S_m^- = i\} \subset \{J_-(i) = m\}$, so for $w > 0$

$$\sum_{m \,:\, |m\mu_- - i| > w} u_m^-(i) \leq \mathbb{P}\big(|J_-(i)\mu_- - i| > w\big) \leq \mathbb{P}\big(S_{m_1}^- \geq i\big) + \mathbb{P}\big(S_{m_2}^- < i\big),$$

with $m_1 = \lfloor (i-w)/\mu_- \rfloor$ (the first term is absent if $i \leq w$) and $m_2 = \lfloor (i+w)/\mu_- \rfloor$. Indeed $J_-(i) > (i+w)/\mu_-$ gives $J_-(i) > m_2$, and then $S_{m_2}^- \leq S_{J_-(i)-1}^- < i$. The first event is a deviation of at least w above the mean, and the second a deviation of at least $w - \mu_-$ below it. For $w \leq N$ both indices are at most $3N/\mu_-$. So for $w = zB_N$ the right side is at most $2\varpi_-(z/(2c_7))$ for large N.

The bound for sp_i^ρ. Take a plus start. On $\{S_m^- = i\}$ we have $m \leq i \leq N$ and $|S_m^+ - \bar{x}_i| \leq |S_m^+ - m\mu_+| + (\mu_+/\mu_-)|m\mu_- - i|$. By (2.13),

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{sp}_i^\rho(ZB_N) &\leq \sup_{m \leq N} \mathbb{P}\big(|S_m^+ - m\mu_+| > ZB_N/2\big) + \sum_{m \,:\, |m\mu_- - i| > \mu_- ZB_N/(2\mu_+)} u_m^-(i) \\ &\leq \varpi_+\Big(\frac{Z}{2c_7}\Big) + 2\varpi_-\Big(\frac{\mu_- Z}{4\mu_+ c_7}\Big). \end{aligned}$$

For a minus start (2.13) has S_{m-1}^+ in place of S_m^+, and $|S_{m-1}^+ - (m-1)\mu_+| > ZB_N/2 - \mu_+$ is needed for the first event. For large N this is at least $ZB_N/4$, so the same bound holds with $Z/(4c_7)$ in place of $Z/(2c_7)$ in the first term.

The bound for sp_i^β. Write $S = S_{J-1}^+$ in (4.8). Then $\mathrm{sp}_i^\beta(z)$ is the expected number of integers $x \in [S, S+\xi_i]$ with $|x - \bar{x}_i| > z$, which is at most $(1+\xi_i)\mathbf{1}_{\{|S - \bar{x}_i| > z/2\}} + \xi_i \mathbf{1}_{\{\xi_i > z/2\}}$. Since X_J^+ is independent of (J, S) and $\xi_i \leq X_J^+$,

$$\mathrm{sp}_i^\beta(z) \leq (1+\mu_+)\mathbb{P}(|S - \bar{x}_i| > z/2) + \mathbb{E}\big[X_+ \mathbf{1}_{\{X_+ > z/2\}}\big].$$

The last term tends to zero as $z \to \infty$. For the first, J is independent of the plus runs, and $\mathbb{P}(J > 3N/\mu_-) \leq \mathbb{P}(S_{\lfloor 3N/\mu_- \rfloor}^- < N) \to 0$ uniformly in $i \leq N$ by Lemma A.1(iv). On

$\{J \le 3N/\mu_-\}$ we bound $|S - \bar{x}_i|$ as for sp_i^ρ, with $J-1$ in place of m. The plus part is controlled by ϖ_+ at the index $J-1$, and the number of minus runs by ϖ_- through the display above, since $J = J_-(i)$ and $|(J-1)\mu_- - i| \le |J\mu_- - i| + \mu_-$. Taking $z = ZB_N$ with Z large and then N large proves the lemma. □

Lemma 4.6 (one giant run)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN), let the start be fresh with sign σ_0, let $0 < \eta \le 1/2$, and put $g = \lceil \eta L_k \rceil$. Write $\kappa = \kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}$ and $\gamma = \gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}$. Then $\mathrm{Cen}_g(k) = 0$ when $\kappa(N-k) = 0$, $\mathrm{Int}_g(k) = 0$ when $\gamma(N-k) = 0$, and*

$$\lim_{K\to\infty} \limsup_{N\to\infty} \sup_{k\,:\,L_k \ge K B_N,\ \kappa(N-k)>0} \Big| \frac{\mathrm{Cen}_g(k)}{\kappa(N-k)\, T_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)} - 1 \Big| = 0.$$

If in addition (LR) holds for the plus sign, then also

$$\lim_{K\to\infty} \limsup_{N\to\infty} \sup_{k\,:\,L_k \ge K B_N,\ \gamma(N-k)>0} \Big| \frac{\mathrm{Int}_g(k)}{\gamma(N-k)\, f_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)} - 1 \Big| = 0.$$

Proof. The two vanishing statements follow from (4.11). By (2.10) and (2.11), $\kappa(i) \to 1/\mu_-$, and by (4.4), $\gamma(i)/i \to s/\mu_-^2$. Hence

$$\kappa_* = \inf\{\kappa(i) \mid \kappa(i) > 0\} > 0, \qquad \gamma_* = \inf\{\gamma(i)/(i+1) \mid \gamma(i) > 0\} > 0.$$

Write $L = L_k$, $\hat{L} = \lfloor L \rfloor$ and $j = N - k$. Note that $N - j - x = L - (x - \bar{x}_j)$ by (4.1). Fix $\varepsilon > 0$ and take Z, N_0 such that Lemma 4.5 holds with $Z/2$ in place of Z. Since $\mathrm{sp}_i^\rho(z)$ and $\mathrm{sp}_i^\beta(z)$ decrease in z, the same bounds hold at ZB_N.

The term Cen_g. Let $\kappa(j) > 0$ and write $\mathrm{Cen}_g(k) - \kappa(j)T_+(\hat{L}) = \sum_x \rho_j(x)[T_+(N-j-x)\mathbf{1}_{\{N-j-x\ge g\}} - T_+(\hat{L})]$. If $|x - \bar{x}_j| \le ZB_N$, then $|N-j-x-\hat{L}| \le ZB_N + 1 \le (Z/K + 1/L)L$. Since $Z/K \le \eta/2$ for large K, the indicator is 1, and by Lemma 2.1(i) the bracket is at most $\omega_T(Z/K)T_+(\hat{L})$, where $\omega_T(\delta) \to 0$ as $\delta \to 0$ once N is large. For the other x the bracket is at most $T_+(g) + T_+(\hat{L}) \le C_\eta T_+(\hat{L})$, and their total weight is $\mathrm{sp}_j^\rho(ZB_N) \le \varepsilon \le (\varepsilon/\kappa_*)\kappa(j)$. Hence

$$\big|\mathrm{Cen}_g(k) - \kappa(j)T_+(\hat{L})\big| \le \big(\omega_T(Z/K) + C_\eta \varepsilon/\kappa_*\big)\kappa(j)T_+(\hat{L}).$$

The term Int_g. Let $\gamma(j) > 0$ and define the measure χ_j by

$$\chi_j(z) = \sum_{i<j} \sum_{x+x'=z} \rho_i(x)\beta_{j-i}(x').$$

It has total mass $\gamma(j)$ by (4.7), and

$$\mathrm{Int}_g(k) = \sum_z \chi_j(z) f_+(N-j-z)\mathbf{1}_{\{N-j-z\ge g\}}.$$

If $|z - \bar{x}_j| > ZB_N$, then the split (x, x') has $|x - \bar{x}_i| > ZB_N/2$ or $|x' - \bar{x}_{j-i}| > ZB_N/2$. So Lemma 4.5 and (4.7) bound the mass of these z by

$$\sum_{i<j} \Big[(1+\mu_+)\mathrm{sp}_i^\rho(ZB_N/2) + \kappa(i)\mathrm{sp}_{j-i}^\beta(ZB_N/2)\Big] \le (2+\mu_+)\, j\, \varepsilon \le \frac{(2+\mu_+)\varepsilon}{\gamma_*}\, \gamma(j).$$

Under (LR), $x \mapsto T_+(x)/x$ is regularly varying and $f_+(n) \sim \alpha_+ T_+(n)/n$. So Lemma 2.1(i) gives $|f_+(n)/f_+(\hat{L}) - 1| \le \omega_f(Z/K)$ for $|n - \hat{L}| \le ZB_N + 1$ and large N, and Lemma 2.1(ii) gives $f_+^*(g) \le C_\eta f_+(\hat{L})$. As for Cen_g,

$$\big|\mathrm{Int}_g(k) - \gamma(j)f_+(\hat{L})\big| \le \Big(\omega_f(Z/K) + \frac{(C_\eta+1)(2+\mu_+)\varepsilon}{\gamma_*}\Big)\gamma(j)f_+(\hat{L}).$$

Let $N \to \infty$, then $K \to \infty$, then $\varepsilon \to 0$. □

Proof of Theorem B(b) and (c). Write κ, γ as in Lemma 4.6, $L = L_k$, $\hat{L} = \lfloor L \rfloor$ and $j = N - k$. Note that $T_+(\hat{L}) \ge T_+(L)$. By (2.10) and (4.4) there is $J_0 \ge 1$ with $\kappa(j) \ge 1/(2\mu_-)$ and $\gamma(j) \ge js/(2\mu_-^2)$ for $j \ge J_0$. Fix

$$\eta = \min\Big\{\frac{1}{32},\ \frac{1}{2J_0+2}\Big\}, \qquad g = \lceil \eta L \rceil,$$

so that $r = 1/(16\eta) \ge 2$. Fix $\varepsilon > 0$. By (4.10),

$$\begin{aligned}\big|P_N(k) - G_N(k)\big| &\le \mathbb{P}(A_N = k,\ M_N < \eta L) + |\mathrm{Cen}_g(k) - \kappa(j)T_+(\hat{L})| \\ &\quad + |\mathrm{Int}_g(k) - \gamma(j) f_+(\hat{L})| + \mathbb{E}\big[(\mathcal{G}_g - 1)^+ \mathbf{1}_{\{A_N = k\}}\big].\end{aligned}$$

In the zone $k \ge pN + K\lambda_N B_N$ we have $L \ge k - pN \ge K\lambda_N B_N \ge K B_N$. By Lemma 4.6 the second and third terms are at most $\varepsilon[\kappa(j)T_+(\hat{L}) + \gamma(j) f_+(\hat{L})] = \varepsilon G_N(k)$ for $K \ge K_1(\varepsilon)$ and $N \ge N_1(K)$. It remains to compare the first and last terms with $G_N(k)$. We use (2.4) for the plus sign.

Small j. Let $j < J_0$. For large N we have $\eta L \le \eta N \le (N-j)/(j+1)$, so Lemma 2.7 gives $\mathbb{P}(A_N = k, M_N < \eta L) = 0$. If $G_N(k) = 0$, then $\kappa(j) = \gamma(j) = 0$, so $\mathrm{Cen}_g = \mathrm{Int}_g = 0$ and $\mathcal{G}_g = 0$ almost surely on $\{A_N = k\}$, and by (4.10) $P_N(k) = 0$. If $G_N(k) > 0$, then $G_N(k) \ge \min(\kappa_* T_+(\hat{L}), \gamma_* f_+(\hat{L})) \ge c T_+(L)/L$ by (LR). Also $L \ge N/2$ for large N. By Lemma 4.4 the last term is at most $C J_0^2 T_+(L)^2$, and its ratio to $G_N(k)$ is at most $C J_0^2 L T_+(L)$, which tends to zero since $\alpha_+ > 1$.

Large j. Let $j \ge J_0$. By (LR), $f_+(\hat{L}) \ge \alpha_+ T_+(\hat{L})/(2L)$ for large L. Since $js/\mu_-^2 = (N-L)/\mu_-$ by (4.1),

$$G_N(k) \ge \frac{T_+(L)}{2\mu_-}\Big(\frac{\alpha_+(N-L)}{2L} + 1\Big) \ge c_8 \frac{N}{L} T_+(L).$$

By Lemma 4.4, with $j+1 \le N$, the last term divided by $G_N(k)$ is at most $C(j+1)T_+(L) \le CNT_+(L) \le CK^{-(\alpha_++1)/2}$ by (2.4), since $L/b_{+,N} \ge L/B_N \ge K$. By Lemma 4.3, for $K \ge C_8$, the first term divided by $G_N(k)$ is at most C times

$$\big(NT_+(L)\big)^{r-1}\frac{L}{b_{+,N}} + \frac{L}{b_{-,N}}\, e^{-cL/b_{-,N}}\, \frac{1}{NT_+(L)} + \frac{e^{-N^c}}{T_+(N)}.$$

The last part tends to zero. The first part is at most $C(L/b_{+,N})^{(1-\alpha_+)/2}$ by (2.4) and $r \ge 2$, and this is at most $CK^{(1-\alpha_+)/2}$. For the middle part put $x = L/b_{-,N}$ and $\varrho = b_{-,N}/b_{+,N}$, so $L/b_{+,N} = x\varrho$. By (2.4) the middle part is at most $Cx^{\alpha_++2}\varrho^{\alpha_++1}e^{-cx}$. If $\varrho \le 1$, then $x \ge L/B_N \ge K$ and the bound is at most $C\sup_{x \ge K} x^{\alpha_++2}e^{-cx}$. If $\varrho > 1$, then $B_N = b_{-,N}$, $\lambda_N = 1 + \log\varrho$ and $x \ge K(1+\log\varrho)$. For $cK \ge 2(\alpha_+ + 1)$ this gives $\varrho^{\alpha_++1}e^{-cx/2} \le e^{(\alpha_++1)\log\varrho - cK(1+\log\varrho)/2} \le e^{-cK/2}$, and the bound is at most $Ce^{-cK/2}\sup_x x^{\alpha_++2}e^{-cx/2}$. In every case the first term is at most $\varepsilon G_N(k)$ for K large and then N large. This proves the ratio form of (b).

For the additive form note that $\gamma(j) \le (1+\mu_+)j \le (1+\mu_+)N$ by (4.2), $(N-L)/\mu_- \le N/\mu_-$, $f_+(\hat{L}) \le 2C_{\mathrm{LR}}T_+(\hat{L})/L$ by (LR), and $\kappa \le 1 \le N/L$. Hence

$$G_N(k) \le C_{\mathrm{G}}\widehat{G}_N(k), \qquad \overline{G}_N(k) \le C_{\mathrm{G}}\widehat{G}_N(k), \tag{4.14}$$

with C_{G} depending only on the laws, and the same holds at every horizon n and for both starting signs whenever $L_k^{(n)} \ge 1$. The ratio form gives the additive form. Replacing $\gamma(j)$ by $js/\mu_-^2 = (N-L)/\mu_-$ changes $G_N(k)$ by $|\gamma(j) - js/\mu_-^2| f_+(\hat{L}) \le 2C_{\mathrm{LR}}|\gamma(j) - js/\mu_-^2|\, T_+(\hat{L})/L$. By (4.4) the factor $|\gamma(j) - js/\mu_-^2|$ is at most εN for $j \ge J_\varepsilon$ and at most a constant C_ε for $j < J_\varepsilon$, and in the second case $L \ge N/2$. In both cases the change is at most $(2C_{\mathrm{LR}}\varepsilon + 4C_{\mathrm{LR}}C_\varepsilon/N)\widehat{G}_N(k)$. This proves (b).

For (c), let $\delta_N \to 0$ and $0 \le j \le \delta_N N$. Then $k - pN \ge (1-p)N/2$ for large N, and $\lambda_N B_N = o(N)$ by Lemma 2.1(v). So for every K these points lie in the zone of (b) once N is large, and (b) gives $\sup_{j \le \delta_N N} |P_N(N-j)/G_N(N-j) - 1| \to 0$. Here $L = N - js/\mu_- \ge N(1 - \delta_N s/\mu_-)$, so $T_+(\hat{L})/T_+(N) \to 1$ uniformly by Lemma 2.1(i). By (LR) and $\gamma(j) \le (1+\mu_+)j$,

$$\frac{\gamma(j) f_+(\hat{L})}{\kappa(j) T_+(N)} \le \frac{C(j+1)}{\kappa_* N} \le \frac{C(\delta_N + 1/N)}{\kappa_*} \to 0$$

for $\kappa(j) > 0$. Hence $G_N(N-j)/(\kappa(j)T_+(N)) \to 1$ uniformly over these j, which proves the second statement of (c). For the first, the same bound gives $\gamma(j) f_+(\hat{L}) \le C(\delta_N + 1/N)T_+(N)$ for all $j \le \delta_N N$, so $|G_N(N-j) - \kappa(j)T_+(N)| = o(T_+(N))$ uniformly. Also $G_N(N-j) \le 2T_+(\hat{L}) \le 4T_+(N)$ there, and the additive form of (b) gives $|P_N(N-j) - G_N(N-j)| = o(T_+(N))$ uniformly. This proves (c). □

Corollary 4.7 (the lower bound)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Theorem B(b),*

$$\lim_{K\to\infty} \liminf_{N\to\infty} \inf_{pN + KB_N \le k \le N,\ G_N(k) > 0} \frac{P_N(k)}{G_N(k)} \ge 1.$$

That is, for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there is K such that $P_N(k) \ge (1-\varepsilon)G_N(k)$ for all $pN + KB_N \le k \le N$ and all large N.

Proof. The first term of (4.10) is nonnegative, and it is the only term whose bound in the proof of (b) used λ_N. So $P_N(k) \ge \mathrm{Cen}_g(k) + \mathrm{Int}_g(k) - \mathbb{E}[(\mathcal{G}_g - 1)^+ \mathbf{1}_{\{A_N = k\}}]$, with J_0, η and g as in that proof. For $pN + KB_N \le k \le N$ we have $L_k \ge KB_N$. Lemma 4.6 needs only this, and it gives $\mathrm{Cen}_g(k) + \mathrm{Int}_g(k) \ge (1-\varepsilon)G_N(k)$ for K large and then N large. The bounds for the last term in the proof of (b) also use only $L_k \ge KB_N$, and they make it at most $\varepsilon G_N(k)$. □

4.4 Consequences and an example

Corollary 4.8 (the infinite density)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for both signs and (LR) for the plus sign. Fix $v \in (p, 1)$ and put $\ell = (v-p)/(1-p)$. For a fresh start of either sign,*

$$\frac{P_N(\lfloor vN \rfloor)}{T_+(N)} \longrightarrow I_+(v) = \frac{1}{\mu_-}\Big[\alpha_+(1-\ell)\ell^{-\alpha_+ - 1} + \ell^{-\alpha_+}\Big].$$

The function I_+ is not integrable at $v \downarrow p$.

Proof. Let $k = \lfloor vN \rfloor$. Then $k - pN \sim (v-p)N$, which exceeds $K\lambda_N B_N$ for every K once N is large, by Lemma 2.1(v). So Theorem B(b) gives $P_N(k) \sim G_N(k)$. Here $j = N - k \sim (1-v)N = (1-p)(1-\ell)N$ and $L_k \sim \ell N$. By (4.4), $\gamma_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j) \sim (1-\ell)N/\mu_-$. By (LR) and (RV), $f_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor) \sim \alpha_+ \ell^{-\alpha_+ - 1} T_+(N)/N$ and $T_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor) \sim \ell^{-\alpha_+} T_+(N)$. By (2.10), $\kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j) \to 1/\mu_-$. Adding the two terms of (4.3) gives $I_+(v)$. Near $v = p$ the first term is of order $(v-p)^{-\alpha_+ - 1}$, which is not integrable. □

Rebenshtok, Denisov, Hänggi and Barkai [36, Eqs. (8) and (10)] (see also [37, Eqs. (38) and (52)]) obtained for the two-state velocity model an infinite density proportional to $|v|^{-1-\alpha}[\alpha - (\alpha-1)|v|]$, formally and in continuous time. Since $\alpha(1-\ell)\ell^{-\alpha-1} + \ell^{-\alpha} = \ell^{-\alpha-1}[\alpha - (\alpha-1)\ell]$, the function I_+ has this shape. The complete giant run alone gives $\ell^{-\alpha-1}[\alpha - \alpha\ell]$. The run in progress at time N supplies the term $\ell^{-\alpha}$, which changes the coefficient of the linear term from $-\alpha$ to $-(\alpha-1)$. So their formula already contains the run in progress. The same shape appears for occupation times in [39, Eq. (25)] and [46, Eq. (83)].

Suppose that $b_{+,N} = B_N$ for all large N, so $\lambda_N = 1$. Then there is a sequence $K_N \to \infty$ with

$$\sup_{|k-pN|\le K_N B_N} \Big| \frac{B_N P_N(k)}{h_N(x_{N,k})} - 1 \Big| \to 0 \qquad \text{and} \qquad \sup_{pN+K_N B_N \le k \le N} \Big| \frac{P_N(k)}{G_N(k)} - 1 \Big| \to 0.$$

Indeed, let $\epsilon_N(K)$ be the first supremum with K in place of K_N. By Theorem A(c), $\epsilon_N(m) \to 0$ for each integer m, so there are $N_1 < N_2 < \cdots$ with $\epsilon_N(m) \le 1/m$ for $N \ge N_m$, and $K_N = m$ for $N_m \le N < N_{m+1}$ gives the first limit. The second holds for every $K_N \to \infty$, by the single-limit form of Theorem B(b). So the bulk profile up to a slowly growing multiple of B_N and the big-jump kernel beyond it give $P_N(k)$ at every point on the plus side with relative error $o(1)$ in a single limit. Schulz and Barkai matched the stable bulk and the infinite density by patching them along the common power law [39, Eq. (26)], formally. This statement is a rigorous form of that matching. The switching point is not explicit, because no statement here has a rate.

Remark 4.9 (the double limit)**.** The bulk profile and the big-jump kernel are different expressions on their common ground. With a fixed switching point K, neither the bulk profile nor the big-jump kernel nor their sum has relative error $o(1)$ uniformly over the plus side. Assume $b_{+,N} = B_N$ and (LR) for the plus sign, and let $k = \lceil pN + KB_N \rceil$ with K fixed. By Theorem A(c), $B_N P_N(k)/h_N(K) \to 1$, and $h_N(K)$ is bounded below by Lemma 2.2(d). On the other hand, $j = N - k \sim (1-p)N$ and $L_k \sim KB_N/(1-p)$, so by (4.4) and (LR)

$$B_N G_N(k) = \frac{\alpha_+}{s} \frac{N T_+(L_k)}{K} (1 + o(1)) = \alpha_+ (1-p)^{\alpha_+} K^{-\alpha_+ - 1} (1 + o(1)),$$

where the second step uses $N T_+(b_{+,N}) \to s$ and Lemma 2.1(i), and the second term of (4.3) is negligible because $B_N T_+(L_k) \to 0$. The right side is the leading term of the tail of h_N, but it is not $h_N(K)$. Put $r_N(K) = h_N(K)/(\alpha_+(1-p)^{\alpha_+} K^{-\alpha_+ - 1})$. Then

$$\frac{P_N(k)}{G_N(k)} = r_N(K) + o(1), \qquad \frac{P_N(k)}{B_N^{-1} h_N(K) + G_N(k)} = \frac{r_N(K)}{1 + r_N(K)} + o(1).$$

Since $h_N \le C_1$ by Lemma 2.2(a), $r_N(K)$ is bounded in N for each K, so the second ratio stays below a constant smaller than one for large N. The first ratio need not converge when $\theta_{-,N}$ oscillates, and it may equal one at isolated values of K. In the example of Section 7, where $\theta_N = (1, 1)$, $r_N(K)$ does not depend on N and moves from 0.31 at $K = 1$ to 1.68 at $K = 4$, so it equals one at some K in between. So no fixed K makes the kernel accurate in general. Section 7 reports the check. By Theorem B(b) and Theorem A(c), $\lim_{K\to\infty} \limsup_{N\to\infty} |r_N(K) - 1| = 0$, and the ratio P_N/G_N tends to one in this double limit, which is the form of Theorem B(b).

Remark 4.10 (the start of the zone)**.** The zone of Theorem B(b) cannot start at $pN + KB_N$ with K fixed when $\theta_{+,N} \to 0$. Some factor in front of B_N that tends to infinity is needed. Assume (LR) for the plus sign and let $\theta_{+,N} \to 0$ along a subsequence. Fix K and let $k = \lceil pN + KB_N \rceil$. By Theorem A(c) and Lemma 2.2(d), $B_N P_N(k)$ is bounded below. By (LR) and the bounds $\gamma(j) \le (1 + \mu_+)N$ and $\kappa \le 1$,

$$B_N G_N(k) \le C\, N T_+(L_k) \frac{B_N}{L_k} + B_N T_+(L_k) \le \frac{C}{K} N T_+(L_k) + B_N T_+(B_N).$$

Since $L_k \ge KB_N = K b_{+,N}/\theta_{+,N}$, the bound (2.4) gives $N T_+(L_k) \le 4s\,(K/\theta_{+,N})^{-(\alpha_+ + 1)/2}$, which tends to zero, and $B_N T_+(B_N) \to 0$. So $P_N(k)/G_N(k) \to \infty$ along the subsequence. The values there are carried by short minus runs, the second term of Lemma 4.3, and not by a giant plus run. The factor need not be as large as λ_N, which comes from the

exponential left-tail bound of Lemma A.1(iv). Theorem 4.13(c) shows that the zone starts at $(1+\delta)\xi_N B_N$ for every $\delta > 0$, that it cannot start at $(1-\delta)\xi_N B_N$, and that $\xi_N = (\log 1/\theta_{+,N})^{(\alpha_- -1)/\alpha_- + o(1)} = o(\lambda_N)$. So the threshold is sharp up to the factor $1 \pm \delta$. The lower bound needs no factor at all (Corollary 4.7).

Example 4.11 ((RV) without (LR))**.** Fix $1 < \alpha < 2$ and let $n_i = 2^{2^i}$ for $i \geq 1$ and $n_0 = 0$. Put $h(n) = 1/\log n_i$ for $n_{i-1} < n \leq n_i$, and

$$T(n) = \frac{n^{-\alpha}\big(1+h(n)\big)}{1+h(1)}, \qquad f(n) = T(n) - T(n+1) \qquad (n \geq 1).$$

Let both run laws be this law, so $p = 1/2$ and $L_k = 2k - N$. Then (RV) and (SPAN) hold and (LR) fails. Let $N_i = 2n_i$ and $k_i = 3n_i/2$. Then $k_i - pN_i = n_i/2$, so k_i lies in the zone of Theorem B(b) for every K once i is large, and

$$\frac{P_{N_i}(k_i)}{G_{N_i}(k_i)} \to 0.$$

So the conclusion of Theorem B(b), whose kernel reads f_+ at a single point, fails under (RV) and (SPAN) alone, while (a) holds. For sums of a fixed number of variables the analogous optimality is due to Berger [3, Eq. (2.4)]. Under regular variation of the tail alone the local large deviation bound of his Theorem 2.3 cannot be improved, while his Theorem 2.4 gives the local asymptotics under the local condition.

Verification. Write $h_i = 1/\log n_i = 1/(2^i \log 2)$, so $h_{i+1} = h_i/2$ and h is nonincreasing and tends to zero. Put $c = 1/(1+h(1))$. Then $T(1) = 1$, and T is decreasing and tends to zero, so f is a probability mass function with $f(n) > 0$ for all n. This gives (SPAN), and $T(n) \sim cn^{-\alpha}$ gives (RV). For $n_{i-1} < n < n_i$ the points $n, n+1$ lie in the same block, so $f(n) = c(1+h_i)(n^{-\alpha} - (n+1)^{-\alpha}) \leq 2c\alpha n^{-\alpha-1}$. At the block ends,

$$f(n_i) = c\Big[\big(n_i^{-\alpha} - (n_i+1)^{-\alpha}\big)(1+h_{i+1}) + n_i^{-\alpha}\,\frac{h_i}{2}\Big],$$

so $\frac{c}{2} h_i n_i^{-\alpha} \leq f(n_i) \leq C h_i n_i^{-\alpha}$. Since $n_i h_i \to \infty$, $n_i f(n_i)/T(n_i) \to \infty$ and (LR) fails.

Let $N = N_i$, $k = k_i$, $j = n_i/2$, so $L_k = n_i$. By (4.4), $\gamma(j) \geq n_i/(2\mu)$ for large i, where μ is the common mean. Hence

$$G_N(k) \geq \gamma(j) f(n_i) \geq \frac{c}{4\mu}\, h_i n_i^{1-\alpha}.$$

For the upper bound take $\eta = 1/32$ and $g = \lceil n_i/32 \rceil$ in Lemma 4.1, and drop the last term of (4.10). Lemma 4.3 uses only (RV) and (SPAN). With $L_k = n_i$, $N = 2n_i$ and $r = 2$ it bounds the first term by $Cn_i^{2-2\alpha}$ plus terms that decay faster than every power of n_i, and $n_i^{2-2\alpha} = o(h_i n_i^{1-\alpha})$. By (4.11), $\mathrm{Cen}_g(k) \leq T(g) \leq Cn_i^{-\alpha}$. For Int_g note that $n_{i-1} = \sqrt{n_i} < n_i/32$ and $n_{i+1} = n_i^2 > 2n_i$ for large i. So n_i is the only block end in $[g, N]$, and $f(n) \leq Cn_i^{-\alpha-1}$ for the other n there. With the measure χ_j of the proof of Lemma 4.6,

$$\mathrm{Int}_g(k) \leq Cn_i^{-\alpha-1}\gamma(j) + f(n_i) \sup_z \chi_j(z) \leq Cn_i^{-\alpha} + Ch_i n_i^{-\alpha} \sup_z \chi_j(z).$$

It remains to show $\sup_z \chi_j(z) = o(j)$. Since $\chi_j = \sum_{i'<j} \rho_{i'} * \beta_{j-i'}$ and the two factors have masses at most 1 and $1+\mu$, $\sup_z(\rho_{i'} * \beta_{j-i'})(z) \leq \min\{(1+\mu)\sup_x \rho_{i'}(x),\ \sup_x \beta_{j-i'}(x)\}$. One of i' and $j - i'$ is at least $j/2$. So it suffices that $\sup_x \rho_n(x) \to 0$ and $\sup_x \beta_n(x) \to 0$ as $n \to \infty$. Let $m_1 = \lfloor n/(2\mu) \rfloor$. By (2.13) and Lemma A.1(ii), $\rho_n(x) \leq \mathbb{P}(S_{m_1} \geq n) + \bar{u}/a(m_1 - 1)$, because a renewal at n with at most m_1 runs forces $S_{m_1} \geq n$. Both terms tend to zero, by the law of large numbers and since $a(m) \to \infty$. By (4.8) and the

independence of X_J^+, $\beta_n(x) \le \sum_{r\ge 0} T(r)\mathbb{P}(S_{J-1} = x - r)$ with $T(0) = 1$, so $\beta_n(x) \le (1+\mu)[\mathbb{P}(J \le m_1) + \bar{u}/a(m_1 - 1)]$, and $\mathbb{P}(J \le m_1) \le \mathbb{P}(S_{m_1} \ge n)$, which tends to zero. Hence $P_N(k) = o(h_i n_i^{1-\alpha})$, and the ratio tends to zero. □

Remark 4.12 (the hypothesis (LR))**.** The spike at n_i enters $G_N(k_i)$ at full weight but enters $P_N(k_i)$ only through a window of width of order B_N around L_k. The proof of Theorem B(b) uses (LR) to replace $f_+(n)$ by $f_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)$ for $|n - L_k| \le ZB_N$, to bound $f_+^*(\eta L_k)$ by $CT_+(L_k)/L_k$, and to bound G_N below. The first use is the insensitivity of the step law to shifts on the scale of the fluctuations, which Denisov, Dieker and Shneer identify as the condition for local big-jump asymptotics of sums [11, Section 1 and condition (6) of Corollary 2.1]. Their local theorem for infinite variance [11, Theorem 9.1] assumes it in the form of intermediate regular variation of $x \mapsto \mathbb{P}(x < \xi \le x + T)$, which for an integer step ξ and $T = 1$ is the mass function. In our zone the windows have relative width at most Z/K, and under (RV) insensitivity at relative width $o(1)$ is equivalent to (LR), since $T_+(n) - T_+((1+\delta)n)$ is then both $\delta n f_+(n)(1 + o_\delta(1))$ and $T_+(n)(\alpha_+\delta + O(\delta^2))$. We do not prove that (LR) is necessary for Theorem B(b).

4.5 The start of the zone

When $\theta_{+,N} \to 0$ the zone of Theorem B(b) starts at $K\lambda_N B_N$, and by Remark 4.10 it cannot start at KB_N. Here we locate its start up to a factor $1 \pm \delta$ and describe P_N before it on the logarithmic scale. Below the start the values are carried by minus runs that fall short of their mean, and the cost of the shortfall is a Cramér transform of the minus runs.

Throughout this subsection $b_{+,N} \le b_{-,N}$ for all large N, so $B_N = b_{-,N}$. We write $X = X_-$, $\alpha = \alpha_-$, $\mu = \mu_-$, $a = a_-$, $T = T_-$, $S_m = S_m^-$, $n_N = N/s$ and $x_{\min} = \min\{n : f_-(n) > 0\}$. For $\vartheta, v, d \ge 0$ and $m > 0$ put

$$\psi(\vartheta) = \log \mathbb{E}e^{-\vartheta(X-\mu)}, \qquad \psi^*(v) = \sup_{\vartheta \ge 0}\big(\vartheta v - \psi(\vartheta)\big), \qquad \mathcal{I}(m,d) = m\,\psi^*(d/m).$$

So $\mathcal{I}(m,d)$ is the Cramér cost of a shortfall d below the mean for a sum of m minus runs. We put

$$\mathcal{I}_N(x) = \mathcal{I}\big(n_N,\, xB_N/p\big), \qquad \beta_- = \frac{\alpha_-}{\alpha_- - 1}, \qquad \varkappa_- = (\alpha_- - 1)\,\alpha_-^{-\beta_-} K_{\alpha_-}^{-1/(\alpha_- - 1)}. \quad (4.15)$$

If $A_N = pN + xB_N$ and the plus runs keep their typical length, then about n_N minus runs hold the $N - A_N$ minus steps, and they fall short of their mean by xB_N/p. When $\theta_{+,N} \to 0$ let ξ_N be the root of $\mathcal{I}_N(\xi_N) = \alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N})$. It exists for large N by the proof of Theorem 4.13(c), and it is unique since $\mathcal{I}_N$ is strictly increasing. A function ϕ on $(0, v_0)$ is regularly varying at $0+$ with index ϱ when $x \mapsto \phi(1/x)$ is regularly varying with index $-\varrho$, and Lemma 2.1(i) to (iii) then hold at $0+$.

Theorem 4.13 (the start of the zone)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for both signs and (LR) for the plus sign, let the start be fresh with either sign, let G_N be its kernel* (4.3)*, and assume $b_{+,N} \le b_{-,N}$ for all large N. Write $x = x_{N,k}$.*

(a) (Two-sided bound.) For every $\varepsilon > 0$ there is K such that, for every sequence X_N with $X_N B_N = o(N)$, for all large N and all k with $K \le x \le X_N$,

$$\max\Big\{(1-\varepsilon)G_N(k),\ \frac{e^{-(1+\varepsilon)\mathcal{I}_N(x)}}{B_N}\Big\} \le P_N(k) \le (1+\varepsilon)G_N(k) + \frac{e^{-(1-\varepsilon)\mathcal{I}_N(x)}}{B_N}.$$

(b) (The exponent.) For fixed $x > 0$, $\mathcal{I}_N(x) \to \varkappa_-(x/p)^{\beta_-}$. Let $X_N B_N = o(N)$. For every $\delta > 0$ there are $c, C > 0$ with $cx^{\beta_- - \delta} \le \mathcal{I}_N(x) \le Cx^{\beta_- + \delta}$ for $1 \le x \le X_N$ and large N, and $\mathcal{I}_N(cx)/\mathcal{I}_N(x) \to c^{\beta_-}$ uniformly in $1 \le x \le X_N$ for every fixed $c > 0$. If $T_-(n) \sim c_- n^{-\alpha_-}$, then $\mathcal{I}_N(x) = \varkappa_-(x/p)^{\beta_-}(1 + o(1))$ uniformly in $1 \le x \le X_N$.

(c) (The start.) Assume in addition $\theta_{+,N} \to 0$. *Then* $\xi_N \to \infty$, $\xi_N/\lambda_N \to 0$ *and* $\xi_N = (\log 1/\theta_{+,N})^{(\alpha_- -1)/\alpha_- + o(1)}$. *For every* $\delta \in (0,1)$ *and every* $K_0 > 0$, *with the ratio read as in Theorem B(b),*

$$\sup_{pN+(1+\delta)\xi_N B_N \le k \le N} \Big| \frac{P_N(k)}{G_N(k)} - 1 \Big| \to 0,$$

$$\inf_{pN+K_0 B_N \le k \le pN+(1-\delta)\xi_N B_N} \frac{P_N(k)}{G_N(k)} \to \infty.$$

If $T_-(n) \sim c_- n^{-\alpha_-}$, *then* $\xi_N \sim p\big(\alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N})/\varkappa_-\big)^{(\alpha_- -1)/\alpha_-}$.

The same holds at the minus end with the signs exchanged.

So the conclusion of Theorem B(b) holds from $(1+\delta)\xi_N B_N$ on, in a single limit. Below the start, on $K \le x \le (1-\delta)\xi_N$, the proof of (c) shows that the light term of (a) dominates, so $\log(B_N P_N(k)) = -(1+O(\varepsilon))\mathcal{I}_N(x)$ there for $K \ge K(\varepsilon)$. The values are those of a moderate deviation of the minus runs. The strip $(1-\delta)\xi_N \le x \le (1+\delta)\xi_N$, where both terms of (a) matter, is not described with a relative error.

Remark 4.14 (a conjecture)**.** Below the start the factors $e^{\pm\varepsilon\mathcal{I}_N(x)}$ in (a) are unbounded, so (a) gives no relative error there. Assume the hypotheses of (c) and $T_\sigma(n) = c_\sigma n^{-\alpha_\sigma}(1 + O(n^{-\varrho}))$ for both signs and some $\varrho > 0$, and let $\tau_N(x) = \alpha_+((1-p)\theta_{+,N})^{\alpha_+} x^{-\alpha_+ -1}$ be the leading term of the right tail of h_N. We conjecture that

$$\lim_{K\to\infty} \limsup_{N\to\infty} \sup_{pN+KB_N \le k \le pN+N/K} \Big| \frac{B_N P_N(k)}{h_N(x) + B_N G_N(k) - \tau_N(x)} - 1 \Big| = 0.$$

The first missing step is a local estimate of $\mathbb{P}(S_m^- = m\mu_- - d)$ with relative error $o(1)$ for d up to $C(\log N)^{1/\beta_-} a_-(m)$, where $\mathcal{I}$ is of order $\log N$ and a second-order condition is needed.

We need three facts on the minus runs.

Lemma 4.15 (the Laplace exponent)**.** *Assume (RV) for the minus sign.*

(i) ψ *is finite on* $[0,\infty)$, *smooth and strictly convex on* $(0,\infty)$, *with* $\psi(0) = 0$ *and* $\psi \ge 0$, *and* ψ' *increases from* $\psi'(0+) = 0$ *to* $\mu - x_{\min}$.

(ii) $\psi(\vartheta) \sim K_\alpha T(1/\vartheta)$ *and* $\vartheta\psi'(\vartheta) \sim \alpha\psi(\vartheta)$ *as* $\vartheta \downarrow 0$.

(iii) For $0 < \vartheta \le 1$ *the tilted law* $f_\vartheta(n) = f_-(n)e^{-\vartheta(n-\mu)-\psi(\vartheta)}$ *has variance* $\sigma_\vartheta^2 \le C\vartheta^{-2}T(1/\vartheta)$.

(iv) For $0 < v < \mu - x_{\min}$ *the supremum that defines* $\psi^*(v)$ *is attained at the unique* ϑ_v *with* $\psi'(\vartheta_v) = v$. *As* $v \downarrow 0$, ϑ_v *is regularly varying with index* $1/(\alpha-1)$, ψ^* *is regularly varying with index* β_-, *and* $\psi^*(v) = (\alpha - 1 + o(1))\psi(\vartheta_v)$. *For every* $u > 0$, $a(m)\,\vartheta_{ua(m)/m} \to (u/(\alpha K_\alpha))^{1/(\alpha-1)}$ *as* $m \to \infty$.

Proof. (i) Since $X \ge 1$, $\mathbb{E}e^{-\vartheta X} \le 1$, and all moments of X under $e^{-\vartheta X}$ are finite for $\vartheta > 0$. Here $\psi'(\vartheta) = \mu - \mathbb{E}_\vartheta X$, where $\mathbb{E}_\vartheta$ is the mean under f_ϑ, and $\psi''(\vartheta) = \sigma_\vartheta^2 > 0$. As $\vartheta \downarrow 0$, $\mathbb{E}_\vartheta X \to \mu$ by monotone convergence, and as $\vartheta \to \infty$, $\mathbb{E}_\vartheta X \to x_{\min}$. Jensen's inequality gives $\psi \ge 0$.

(ii) The proof of Lemma A.1(i) at $\xi = \vartheta > 0$ gives $\phi_1(\vartheta) = \mathbb{E}[e^{-\vartheta X} - 1 + \vartheta X] \sim K_\alpha T(1/\vartheta)$. Then $\psi(\vartheta) = \vartheta\mu + \log(1 - \vartheta\mu + \phi_1(\vartheta)) = \phi_1(\vartheta) + O(\vartheta^2)$, and $\vartheta^2 = o(T(1/\vartheta))$ since $\alpha < 2$. For $c > 1$ convexity gives $(c-1)\vartheta\psi'(\vartheta) \le \psi(c\vartheta) - \psi(\vartheta)$. Divide by $\psi(\vartheta)$, let $\vartheta \to 0$ and then $c \downarrow 1$. This gives the upper bound α for $\vartheta\psi'/\psi$, and $c < 1$ gives the lower bound.

(iii) Since $\psi \ge 0$, $\sigma_\vartheta^2 \le e^{\vartheta\mu}\mathbb{E}[X^2 e^{-\vartheta X}]$. The values $n \le 1/\vartheta$ contribute at most $\sum_{n \le 1/\vartheta}(2n-1)T(n)$, and the others at most $\sup_{y>0}(y^2 e^{-y})\,\vartheta^{-2}T(1/\vartheta)$. Then use (2.3).

(iv) The first claim follows from (i). By (ii), ψ is regularly varying at $0+$ with index α and ψ' with index $\alpha-1$. So its inverse $v \mapsto \vartheta_v$ is regularly varying with index $1/(\alpha-1)$ [5, Theorem 1.5.12]. Next $\psi^*(v) = \vartheta_v\psi'(\vartheta_v) - \psi(\vartheta_v) = (\alpha - 1 + o(1))\psi(\vartheta_v)$ by (ii), which is regularly varying with index $\alpha/(\alpha-1)$. For the last claim let $y > 0$. By (ii) and $mT(a(m)) \to 1$,

$$\frac{m}{a(m)}\,\psi'\Big(\frac{y}{a(m)}\Big) \sim \frac{\alpha m}{y}\,\psi\Big(\frac{y}{a(m)}\Big) \sim \frac{\alpha K_\alpha}{y}\,mT\Big(\frac{a(m)}{y}\Big) \to \alpha K_\alpha y^{\alpha-1}.$$

The left side increases in y and the limit is continuous and strictly increasing. So the root $y_m = a(m)\vartheta_{ua(m)/m}$ of the equation where the left side equals u converges to the root of $\alpha K_\alpha y^{\alpha-1} = u$. □

Since $\psi \ge 0$ and ψ^* is nondecreasing, $\mathcal{I}(m,d)$ is nonincreasing in m and nondecreasing in d. By Lemma 4.15(iv) and Lemma 2.1(i) at $0+$, along sequences with $d/m \to 0$,

$$\frac{\mathcal{I}(m',d')}{\mathcal{I}(m,d)} \to 1 \text{ if } \frac{m'}{m} \to 1,\ \frac{d'}{d} \to 1, \qquad \frac{\mathcal{I}(cm,d)}{\mathcal{I}(m,d)} \to c^{1-\beta_-}, \qquad \frac{\mathcal{I}(m,cd)}{\mathcal{I}(m,d)} \to c^{\beta_-}, \tag{4.16}$$

for every fixed $c > 0$.

Lemma 4.16 (tilted bounds)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for the minus sign.*

(a) There are $\vartheta_0 \in (0,1]$ and C such that, for all $m \ge 1$, all $0 \le \vartheta \le \vartheta_0$ and all integers y,

$$\mathbb{P}(S_m = y) \le C\Big(\vartheta + \frac{1}{a(m)}\Big)e^{\vartheta(y-m\mu)+m\psi(\vartheta)}.$$

(b) For every $\delta \in (0, \frac12)$ there are $D, \varepsilon_0, c_\delta > 0$ and m_0 such that, for $m \ge m_0$ and every integer j with $d = m\mu - j \in [Da(m), \varepsilon_0 m]$, with $n = \lfloor \delta m \rfloor$,

$$\mathbb{P}(S_m = j) \ge \frac{c_\delta}{a(m)} \exp\Big(-\mathcal{I}(m-n,d) - C\,\mathcal{I}(m-n,d)^{1/2}\Big).$$

Proof. Let ϕ_ϑ be the characteristic function of f_ϑ and $\mathbb{P}_\vartheta$ the law under which the runs have the law f_ϑ. Then $\mathbb{P}(S_m = y) = e^{\vartheta(y-m\mu)+m\psi(\vartheta)}\mathbb{P}_\vartheta(S_m = y)$ and $\mathbb{P}_\vartheta(S_m = y) \le \frac{1}{2\pi}\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} |\phi_\vartheta(t)|^m\,dt$.

(a) Let $\vartheta \le \vartheta_0 \le 1/R_0$, where R_0 is fixed below. For $n \le 1/\vartheta$ we have $f_\vartheta(n) \ge e^{-1-\psi(1)}f_-(n)$. Let X' be an independent copy of X under $\mathbb{P}_\vartheta$. With $1 - \cos y \ge 2y^2/\pi^2$ for $|y| \le \pi$ and $R = \min(1/\vartheta, \pi/|t|)$,

$$1 - |\phi_\vartheta(t)|^2 = \mathbb{E}_\vartheta\big[1 - \cos t(X - X')\big] \ge c\,t^2 \sum_{n,n' \le R} f_-(n)f_-(n')(n-n')^2 \ge c\,t^2R^2T(R)$$

for $R \ge R_0$, using the pairs with $n \in [R/2, R]$, which carry mass at least $cT(R)$, and $n' \le R/4$. Take $\delta_0 = \pi/R_0$. For $\pi\vartheta \le |t| \le \delta_0$ we have $R = \pi/|t|$, so $|\phi_\vartheta(t)|^m \le \exp(-cmT(1/|t|))$. The substitution $t = s/a(m)$ and Lemma 2.1(ii), with R_0 large, bound the integral over this range by $C/a(m)$. The range $|t| < \pi\vartheta$ contributes at most ϑ. On $\delta_0 \le |t| \le \pi$, (SPAN) gives $|\phi_0| \le 1 - 2c_0$, and $\sum_n |f_\vartheta(n) - f_-(n)| \to 0$ as $\vartheta \to 0$. So for ϑ_0 small $|\phi_\vartheta| \le 1 - c_0$ there, and this range contributes at most $(1-c_0)^m \le C/a(m)$.

(b) Put $m' = m - n$ and $\vartheta = \vartheta_{d/m'}$, defined since $d/m' \le 2\varepsilon_0 < \mu - x_{\min}$ for ε_0 small. Under $\mathbb{P}_\vartheta$ the sum S' of m' runs has mean $m'\mu - d$ and variance $\sigma^2 = m'\sigma^2_\vartheta$. By Chebyshev's inequality the window $I = \{y : |y - (m'\mu - d)| \le 2\sigma\}$ has $\mathbb{P}_\vartheta(S' \in I) \ge 3/4$. On I the density $e^{\vartheta(y-m'\mu)+m'\psi(\vartheta)}$ is at least $e^{-\mathcal{I}(m',d)-2\vartheta\sigma}$, since $\mathcal{I}(m',d) = \vartheta d - m'\psi(\vartheta)$. So $\mathbb{P}(S' \in I) \ge \frac34 e^{-\mathcal{I}(m',d)-2\vartheta\sigma}$. By Lemma 4.15 we may take ε_0 so small that $\vartheta \le 1$, $\psi(\vartheta) \ge cT(1/\vartheta)$ and $\psi^*(d/m') \ge c\,\psi(\vartheta)$. Then (iii) gives $\vartheta^2\sigma^2 \le Cm'T(1/\vartheta) \le C\mathcal{I}(m',d)$.

By the last claim of Lemma 4.15(iv) there is D with $a(m)\vartheta_{Da(m)/m} \ge 2$ for large m. Since $d/m' \ge Da(m)/m$, ϑ_v increases in v and $a(m') \ge a(m)/2$, we get $y = \vartheta a(m') \ge 1$. With $0 < \delta' < 2-\alpha$, (iii) and Lemma 2.1(ii) give $\sigma^2 \le Ca(m')^2 y^{-2} m' T(a(m')/y) \le Ca(m')^2 y^{\alpha+\delta'-2} \le Ca(m)^2$.

Write $S_m = S' + S''$ with S'' an independent sum of n runs. Then $\mathbb{P}(S_m = j) \ge \mathbb{P}(S' \in I) \min_{y\in I} \mathbb{P}(S'' = j-y)$, and $|j - y - n\mu| = |y - (m'\mu - d)| \le 2\sigma \le Ca(m) \le R_\delta a(n)$, since $n \ge \delta m/2$. The density g_- is positive on $\mathbb{R}$ (see the proof of Lemma 2.2(d)), so Lemma A.1(ii) gives $\mathbb{P}(S'' = z) \ge c/a(n) \ge c/a(m)$ for these z and large m. □

Proof of Theorem 4.13. We take a plus start. For a minus start the same proof runs with the index shifts noted in the proof of Lemma 4.3. Put $v_N = B_N/(pn_N) \to 0$, so $\mathcal{I}_N(x) = n_N\psi^*(xv_N)$, and recall $a(n_N) = b_{-,N} = B_N$.

(b) Fix $x > 0$. Substituting $\vartheta = u/B_N$, $\mathcal{I}_N(x) = \sup_{u\ge 0}(ux/p - n_N\psi(u/B_N))$. By Lemma 4.15(ii) and $n_N T(B_N) \to 1$, $n_N\psi(u/B_N) \to K_\alpha u^\alpha$, locally uniformly since these functions increase and the limit is continuous. The maximizer $u_N = B_N\vartheta_{xv_N}$ tends to $u_* = (x/(p\alpha K_\alpha))^{1/(\alpha-1)}$ by the last claim of Lemma 4.15(iv) with $m = n_N$. Hence $\mathcal{I}_N(x) \to u_*x/p - K_\alpha u_*^\alpha = \varkappa_-(x/p)^{\beta_-}$. For $1 \le x \le X_N$ we have $xv_N \le X_N v_N \to 0$, and $\mathcal{I}_N(x)/\mathcal{I}_N(1) = \psi^*(xv_N)/\psi^*(v_N)$. So Lemma 2.1(ii) and (i) at $0+$ for ψ^* give the bounds and the scaling. If $T(n) \sim c_-n^{-\alpha}$, then $\psi(\vartheta) \sim c_-K_\alpha\vartheta^\alpha$, and the proof of Lemma 4.15(iv) gives $\psi^*(v) \sim A_*v^{\beta_-}$ with $A_* = (\alpha-1)\alpha^{-\beta_-}(c_-K_\alpha)^{-1/(\alpha-1)}$. Since $B_N \sim (c_-n_N)^{1/\alpha}$, $n_N v_N^{\beta_-} \to p^{-\beta_-}c_-^{1/(\alpha-1)}$, and $A_*c_-^{1/(\alpha-1)} = \varkappa_-$.

(a), lower bound. The bound $P_N(k) \ge (1-\varepsilon)G_N(k)$ for $x \ge K$ is Corollary 4.7. For the other bound let $j = N-k$ and keep in Proposition 2.3 only the terms $u_m^-(j)q_{m+1}^+(k)$ with m in $W = \{m \ge 1 : |k-1-m\mu_+| \le b_{+,N}\}$. By (2.7), $q_{m+1}^+(k) \ge u_m^+(k-1)$. On W we have $m/n_N \to 1$ uniformly, since $xB_N = o(N)$, so $a_+(m)/b_{+,N} \to 1$, and Lemma A.1(ii) gives $u_m^+(k-1) \ge c/b_{+,N}$. Since W has at least $b_{+,N}/\mu_+$ points, $P_N(k) \ge c\min_{m\in W} u_m^-(j)$. By the identity $\mu_-k - \mu_+j = s(k-pN)$ of the proof of Lemma 4.3, the shortfall $d = m\mu_- - j$ for $m \in W$ is $xB_N/p + O(b_{+,N})$, which lies in $[1-C/K, 1+C/K]\cdot xB_N/p$, since $b_{+,N} \le B_N$ and $x \ge K$. Fix $\delta \in (0, \frac12)$. For $K \ge 4pD$ Lemma 4.16(b) applies, since $a(m) \sim B_N$ and $d = o(m)$. By (4.16) and monotonicity, $\mathcal{I}(m - \lfloor\delta m\rfloor, d) \le (1-\delta)^{1-\beta_-}(1+C/K)^{\beta_-}(1+o(1))\mathcal{I}_N(x)$ uniformly in $m \in W$ and $K \le x \le X_N$. By (b), $\mathcal{I}_N(x) \ge cK$ on $x \ge K$, so the constants and the term $C\mathcal{I}^{1/2}$ cost at most a factor $e^{\varepsilon\mathcal{I}_N(x)/2}$ for K large. Taking δ small and then K large gives $P_N(k) \ge B_N^{-1}e^{-(1+\varepsilon)\mathcal{I}_N(x)}$.

(a), upper bound. Take $\eta = \varepsilon/32$ and $g = \lceil \eta L_k\rceil$ in (4.10) and drop the subtracted term. Lemma 4.6 holds for this η once $L_k \ge KB_N$ with K large, so $\mathrm{Cen}_g(k) + \mathrm{Int}_g(k) \le (1+\varepsilon)G_N(k)$. It remains to bound $\mathbb{P}(A_N = k, M_N < \eta L_k)$. We follow the proof of Lemma 4.3, with $L/2$ replaced by εL in the definition of $\mathcal{A}$, so $\mathcal{A} = \{m : d_1 \ge \varepsilon L\}$.

The indices in $\mathcal{A}$. The argument there applies with $v' - m\mu_+ \ge \varepsilon L/2$, a half that exceeds its mean by $\varepsilon L/4$, and Lemma 4.2 with $w = \eta L$ and $z = \varepsilon L/4$, whose exponent is $\varepsilon/(8\eta) = 4$. It gives $C(NT_+(L))^4/b_{+,N}$. Since $G_N(k) \ge c_8(N/L)T_+(L)$ by the proof of Theorem B(b), the ratio is at most $C(NT_+(L))^3 L/b_{+,N} \le C(L/b_{+,N})^{1-3(\alpha_++1)/2}$ by (2.4), which is small since $L/b_{+,N} \ge K$.

The indices in $\mathcal{B}$. Here $d_2 = (\mu_-/\mu_+)(L-d_1) > (1-\varepsilon)xB_N/p$. As in the proof of Lemma 4.3, every minus factor of E_1 and E_2 is at most μ_- times the largest $u_{m'}^-(j')$ with $m' \in \{m-1, m\}$ and $m'\mu_- - j' \ge d_2 - \mu_-$, and the kernel sums are at most 1. Also $m > j/\mu_- \ge n_N - xB_N/\mu_-$, so $a(m') \ge B_N/2$. Let first $m \le m'' = (1+\varepsilon)n_N$ and put $d'' = (1-\varepsilon)xB_N/p - 2\mu_-$ and $\vartheta_* = \vartheta_{d''/m''}$. For the pairs (m', j') above, $m' \le m''$ and $m'\mu_- - j' \ge d''$. Since $\psi \ge 0$, Lemma 4.16(a) with $\vartheta = \vartheta_*$ gives $u_{m'}^-(j') \le C(\vartheta_* + 2/B_N)e^{-\mathcal{I}(m'',d'')}$. By Lemma 4.15(iv) and Lemma 2.1(ii), $\vartheta_* \le Cx^C/B_N$, and (4.16) gives $\mathcal{I}(m'', d'') \ge (1-C\varepsilon)\mathcal{I}_N(x)$. Let next $m > m''$. Since $j \le n_N\mu_-$, $m'\mu_- - j' \ge \varepsilon\mu_- m/2 - \mu_-$. Take a fixed $\vartheta_1 > 0$ with $\psi(\vartheta_1) \le \vartheta_1\mu_-\varepsilon/4$. Markov's inequality for $e^{-\vartheta_1 S_{m'}}$ bounds

$u^-_{m'}(j')$ by $Ce^{-\vartheta_1\mu_-\varepsilon m/4} \le Ce^{-cN}$. Altogether

$$\mathbb{P}(A_N = k, M_N < \eta L) \le \varepsilon G_N(k) + \frac{Cx^C}{B_N} e^{-(1-C\varepsilon)\mathcal{I}_N(x)} + Ce^{-cN}.$$

By (b), $C\log x \le \varepsilon \mathcal{I}_N(x)$ for $x \ge K$ and K large, and $e^{-cN} = o(T_+(N)) = o(G_N(k))$. Renaming ε gives the upper bound.

(c) The function $\mathcal{I}_N$ is continuous and increasing with $\mathcal{I}_N(0) = 0$. We use (b) with $X_N = K_1\lambda_N$ for a constant K_1, which is allowed since $\lambda_N B_N = o(N)$ by Lemma 2.1(v). For fixed x, $\mathcal{I}_N(x)$ stays bounded while $\log(1/\theta_{+,N}) \to \infty$. Since $\mathcal{I}_N(\lambda_N) \ge c\lambda_N^{\beta_- - \delta}$ and $\beta_- > 2$, $\mathcal{I}_N(\lambda_N) > \alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N})$ for large N. So ξ_N exists, $\xi_N \to \infty$, and $c\xi_N^{\beta_- - \delta} \le \alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N}) \le C\xi_N^{\beta_- + \delta}$ for every $\delta > 0$. This gives the order of ξ_N, and $\xi_N/\lambda_N \to 0$ since $1/\beta_- < 1$. Under a pure power tail the order becomes the stated equivalence by the last part of (b).

Next we show that, uniformly in $K_0 \le x \le K_1\lambda_N$,

$$-\log\bigl(B_N G_N(k)\bigr) = \alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N})\,(1 + o(1)). \tag{4.17}$$

Here $j \ge J_0$, so $c_8 \le G_N(k)L/(NT_+(L)) \le C_{\mathrm{G}}$ by the proof of Theorem B(b) and (4.14), and $B_N/L = (1-p)/x$. Also $NT_+(b_{+,N}) \to s$ and $L/b_{+,N} = x/((1-p)\theta_{+,N}) \to \infty$. Potter's bounds for $T_+(L)/T_+(b_{+,N})$ give $-\log(B_N G_N(k)) = \alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N})(1+O(\delta)) + O(\log x) + O(1)$ for every $\delta > 0$, and $\log x = O(\log \lambda_N) = o(\log 1/\theta_{+,N})$ on this range.

For the first limit take $\varepsilon > 0$. By Theorem B(b) there is $K_1 = K_1(\varepsilon)$ with $|P_N/G_N - 1| \le \varepsilon$ on $x \ge K_1\lambda_N$ for large N. On $(1+\delta)\xi_N \le x \le K_1\lambda_N$ we use (a) with $X_N = K_1\lambda_N$. By monotonicity and the scaling in (b), $\mathcal{I}_N(x) \ge \mathcal{I}_N((1+\delta)\xi_N) = (1+\delta)^{\beta_-}(1 + o(1))\alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N})$. With (4.17), the light term of (a) divided by $G_N(k)$ is at most $\exp(-[(1-\varepsilon)(1+\delta)^{\beta_-} - 1 - o(1)]\alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N}))$, which tends to zero once $(1-\varepsilon)(1+\delta)^{\beta_-} > 1$. So $|P_N/G_N - 1| \le 2\varepsilon$ there for large N.

For the second limit, on $K \le x \le (1-\delta)\xi_N$ the lower bound of (a) and the same scaling give $B_N P_N(k) \ge \exp(-(1+\varepsilon)(1-\delta)^{\beta_-}(1+o(1))\alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N}))$, and (4.17) bounds $B_N G_N(k)$ by $\exp(-(1-o(1))\alpha_+ \log(1/\theta_{+,N}))$. The ratio tends to infinity once $(1+\varepsilon)(1-\delta)^{\beta_-} < 1$. On $K_0 \le x \le K$, Theorem A(c) and Lemma 2.2(d) give $B_N P_N(k) \ge c$, while $B_N G_N(k) \to 0$ by (4.17). □

5 The initial run

The first run is the only part of the walk that the two fresh laws do not describe, and Proposition 2.4 says exactly how it enters. This section turns that identity into a criterion for each zone of the range of the count.

5.1 Statements

For a sign σ and $b \in \mathbb{Z}$ define the directional defect

$$\mathcal{D}^\sigma_N(b) = B_N \sum_{1 \le m < N/2} \nu_\sigma(N-m)\,\Pi^{\bar\sigma}_m(b), \qquad \Delta_{\sigma,N} = \sup_{b \ge 1} \mathcal{D}^\sigma_N(b), \tag{5.1}$$

with $\Pi^{\bar\sigma}_m(b) = 0$ for $b \notin \{0, \dots, m\}$. Note that $\Pi^{\bar\sigma}_m(0) = 0$ for $m \ge 1$, since a fresh walk has at least one step of its own sign. So $\mathcal{D}^\sigma_N(b) = 0$ for $b \le 0$ and for $b \ge N/2$. Take a first run of sign σ that ends within the last $N/2$ steps. Times B_N, its contribution at the point k is $\mathcal{D}^+_N(N-k)$ for $\sigma = +$ and $\mathcal{D}^-_N(k)$ for $\sigma = -$. So the argument b is the number of steps of the opposite sign. We say that the initial run satisfies the *bulk criterion* if $B_n \mathbb{P}(D = n) \to 0$.

For the big-jump zone put $\pi_\sigma = \mathbb{P}(\Sigma = \sigma)$, let L_k be as in (4.1) and $\widehat{G}_N$ as in (4.6), and define for $pN < k \le N$ and $j \ge 0$

$$\kappa_+(j) = \pi_+ u_-(j)\mathbf{1}_{\{j\ge 1\}} + \sum_{d=1}^{j} \nu_-(d)\, u_-(j-d), \tag{5.2}$$

$$G_N^{\nu}(k) = \frac{N - L_k}{\mu_-}\, f_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor) + T_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)\, \kappa_+(N-k), \tag{5.3}$$

$$\Psi_N(k) = \sum_{L_k/2 \le d < N} \nu_+(d)\, F^-_{N-d}(k-d). \tag{5.4}$$

The kernel $\kappa_+(j)$ is the probability that a plus run other than the first run starts immediately after the j-th minus step. For a fresh start of sign σ_0 it equals $\kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(j)$ for $j \ge 1$, by (2.11). The kernel G_N^{ν} uses the limit coefficient $(N - L_k)/\mu_-$. The term $\Psi_N(k)$ is the exact contribution of a first plus run that supplies at least half of the big jump. We also use two conditions on ν_+. The first is the regularity condition

$$\begin{gathered} \nu_+(n) > 0 \ \text{ and } \ \sup_{d \ge n/2} \nu_+(d) \le C_\nu\, \nu_+(n) \ \text{ for all large } n, \\ \lim_{\delta \downarrow 0} \limsup_{n\to\infty} \sup_{|d-n|\le \delta n} \Big| \frac{\nu_+(d)}{\nu_+(n)} - 1 \Big| = 0. \end{gathered} \tag{Rν}$$

Every regularly varying ν_+ with a negative index satisfies (Rν), by Lemma 2.1(i) and (ii). The second is a condition on the window averages

$$W_n = \frac{1}{B_n} \sum_{|d-n| \le B_n} \nu_+(d).$$

Theorem C (the initial run)**.** *Fix the law of the initial run* (Σ, D)*.*

(a) (The exact defect.) Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for both signs. Uniformly over $0 \le k \le N$*,*

$$\begin{aligned} B_N P_N(k) = h_N(x_{N,k}) &+ B_N Q_+(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{k=N\}} + B_N Q_-(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{k=0\}} \\ &+ \mathcal{D}_N^+(N-k) + \mathcal{D}_N^-(k) + o(1). \end{aligned}$$

(b) (The bulk criterion.) Under the hypotheses of (a),

$$\sup_{1\le k<N} \big| B_N P_N(k) - h_N(x_{N,k}) \big| = \max\big(\Delta_{+,N}, \Delta_{-,N}\big) + o(1),$$

$$\sup_{0\le k\le N} \big| B_N P_N(k) - h_N(x_{N,k}) \big| = \max\big(\Delta_{+,N}, \Delta_{-,N}, B_N Q_+(N), B_N Q_-(N)\big) + o(1).$$

The first error tends to zero if and only if $B_n \mathbb{P}(D = n) \to 0$*, and the second if and only if* $B_n \mathbb{P}(D \ge n) \to 0$*. For every fixed* $\varepsilon > 0$ *the approximation holds on* $\varepsilon N \le k \le (1-\varepsilon)N$ *with no condition on the initial run.*

(c) (The big-jump zone.) Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for both signs and (LR) for the plus sign, and let λ_N *be as in* (4.5)*. Then*

$$\lim_{K\to\infty} \limsup_{N\to\infty} \sup_{pN + K\lambda_N B_N \le k \le N} \frac{\big| P_N(k) - Q_+(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{k=N\}} - G_N^{\nu}(k) - \Psi_N(k) \big|}{\widehat{G}_N(k)} = 0.$$

The same holds with Ψ_N *removed if and only if* $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$*. If* ν_+ *satisfies (R*ν*), it holds with* $\Psi_N(k)$ *replaced by* $\nu_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)(1 + \mu_+ u_-(N-k))\mathbf{1}_{\{k<N\}}$ *and* $\widehat{G}_N(k)$ *replaced by* $\widehat{G}_N(k) + \nu_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)$*.*

(d) (The boundary layer.) Assume (RV) for the plus sign. For every fixed $j \geq 0$,

$$P_N(N-j) = Q_+(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{j=0\}} + T_+(N)\,\kappa_+(j) + B_N^{-1}\mathcal{D}_N^+(j) + o(T_+(N)),$$

where $B_N^{-1}\mathcal{D}_N^+(j) = \sum_{1\leq m<N/2} \nu_+(N-m)\Pi_m^-(j)$ does not involve the scales. Hence $P_N(N-j)/T_+(N) \to \kappa_+(j)$ for one $j \geq 1$, equivalently for every $j \geq 1$, if and only if $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$. If ν_+ satisfies (Rν), then $B_N^{-1}\mathcal{D}_N^+(j) = \nu_+(N)\big(1+\mu_+u_-(j)\big)(1+o(1))$ for every $j \geq 1$.

(e) (Interior of the big-jump zone.) Assume the hypotheses of (c). For $0 < \varepsilon < \frac{1}{2}$ let $Z_N^\varepsilon = \{k : \varepsilon N \leq L_k \leq (1-\varepsilon)N\}$, and consider the property

$$\sup_{k\in Z_N^\varepsilon} \frac{|P_N(k) - G_N^\nu(k)|}{\widehat{G}_N(k)} \to 0 \quad (N\to\infty) \qquad \text{for every } \varepsilon \in (0,\tfrac{1}{2}). \tag{5.5}$$

The condition $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$ implies (5.5)*. Conversely* (5.5) *implies the window condition $W_n = o(T_+(n))$. If (LR) holds for the minus sign as well, then $W_n = o(T_+(n))$ implies* (5.5)*.*

At the plus end the criteria are nested. Since $\nu_+ \leq Q_+$, the atom condition $Q_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$ implies the big-jump condition $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$. Since $B_nT_+(n) \to 0$, the big-jump condition implies $B_n\nu_+(n) \to 0$, which is the plus half of the bulk criterion.

The zone in (c) starts where the zone of Theorem B(b) starts, and by Remark 4.10 its factor λ_N cannot be replaced by a constant, already for a fresh start. For fresh starts Theorem 4.13 gives the sharp factor. At $k = N$ we have $\Psi_N(N) = 0$, $G_N^\nu(N) = 0$ and $\mathcal{D}_N^+(0) = 0$, so (c) and (d) both reduce to the identity $P_N(N) = Q_+(N)$ of Proposition 2.4. Part (e) refines (c) on the interior of the zone, where (5.5) is the statement of (c) without Ψ_N.

Remark 5.1 (the prepared boundary kernel)**.** By (2.10) and dominated convergence, $\kappa_+(j) \to 1/\mu_-$, the fresh value. With generating functions F, $U = 1/(1-F)$ and $\widehat{\nu}_-$ of f_-, u_- and ν_-, the identity $\kappa_+ = u_-$ on $j \geq 1$ reads $\widehat{\nu}_-U = \pi_-(U-1)$, that is, $\nu_- = \pi_- f_-$. So the prepared kernel is the fresh one exactly when the first run, given that it is a minus run, has the law of X_-.

5.2 Tools

For a horizon n and a point $k > pn$ we write $L_k^{(n)} = (k-pn)/(1-p)$ for the quantity (4.1) at the horizon n, and $\widehat{G}_n(k)$, $G_n^{(\sigma_0)}(k)$ and λ_n for (4.6), (4.3) and (4.5) at the horizon n. Recall from Lemma 2.1(v) that B_n is nondecreasing and regularly varying with index $1/\alpha_*$.

Fix $c \in (0,1)$. We have $\lambda_n = 1 + \log\max(1, r(n))$ with $r(n) = b_{-,n}/b_{+,n}$, which is regularly varying with index $\varrho = 1/\alpha_- - 1/\alpha_+$. By the uniform convergence theorem [5, Theorem 1.5.2], $r(n)/r(N) = (n/N)^\varrho(1+o(1))$ uniformly in $n \in [cN, N]$. If $\varrho \geq 0$, then $(n/N)^\varrho \leq 1$, so $r(n) \leq r(N)(1+o(1))$. If $\varrho < 0$, then $r(N) \to 0$, so $r(n) \leq c^\varrho r(N)(1+o(1)) < 1$ for large N and $\lambda_n = \lambda_N = 1$. Since $x \mapsto \log\max(1,x)$ is nondecreasing and changes by at most $\log(1+\delta)$ when x is multiplied by $1+\delta$, in both cases $\lambda_n \leq \lambda_N + o(1)$ uniformly in $n \in [cN, N]$. Since $\lambda_N \geq 1$,

$$\lambda_n \leq 2\lambda_N \qquad (cN \leq n \leq N) \tag{5.6}$$

once N is large. By Lemma 2.1(v), $\lambda_N B_N = o(N)$. So for each $c > 0$ the points with $k - pN \geq cN$ lie in the zone of Theorem C(c) for every K once N is large.

Lemma 5.2 (tightness of the count)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN). For a fresh start of either sign, $\sup_{n\geq 1} \mathbb{P}(|A_n - pn| > RB_n) \to 0$ as $R \to \infty$.*

Proof. Fix the starting sign and put $\varepsilon_n = \sup_k |B_n F_n(k) - h_n(x_{n,k})|$, which tends to zero by Theorem A(a). Let $R \geq 1$ and let k run over the integers with $|k - pn| \leq RB_n$. The points $x_{n,k}$ are spaced $1/B_n$ apart, and the intervals $[x_{n,k}, x_{n,k} + 1/B_n)$ cover $[-R + 1/B_n, R]$. On each of them h_n exceeds $h_n(x_{n,k})$ by at most C_2/B_n, by Lemma 2.2(a). There are at most $2RB_n + 1$ such k. Hence, for $B_n \geq 1$,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}(|A_n - pn| \leq RB_n) &\geq \sum_k \frac{h_n(x_{n,k}) - \varepsilon_n}{B_n} \geq \int_{-R+1/B_n}^{R} h_n - 3R\Big(\varepsilon_n + \frac{C_2}{B_n}\Big) \\ &\geq 1 - \varepsilon_h'(R-1) - 3R\Big(\varepsilon_n + \frac{C_2}{B_n}\Big).\end{aligned}$$

So $\limsup_n \mathbb{P}(|A_n - pn| > RB_n) \leq \varepsilon_h'(R-1)$, which tends to zero by Lemma 2.2(b). For each of the finitely many remaining n the probability is zero once $RB_n > n$. □

The measure $m \mapsto \Pi_m^-(j)$ of the Green identity sits within $O(B_N)$ of $j/(1-p)$, the time at which a typical walk collects j minus steps.

Lemma 5.3 (the Green measure is concentrated)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN). For every $\varepsilon > 0$ there are R and N_0 such that for all $N \geq N_0$ and all $1 \leq j \leq N$,*

$$\sum_{m \geq 1:\ |m - j/(1-p)| > RB_N} \Pi_m^-(j) \leq \varepsilon.$$

Proof. Take a fresh minus walk continued forever, as in the proof of Lemma 2.5. Its minus runs $X_1^-, X_2^-, \dots$ and its plus runs $X_1^+, X_2^+, \dots$ are independent, and the i-th plus run comes right after the i-th minus run. Let C_m be the number of minus steps among the first m, let t_j be the step of the j-th minus step, and let r be the index of the minus run that contains it. Put $\xi_j = X_r^+$ if $S_r^- = j$ and $\xi_j = 0$ otherwise. As in the proof of Lemma 2.5, $C_m = j$ exactly for $t_j \leq m \leq t_j + \xi_j$. The index r, the event $\{S_r^- = j\}$ and $t_j = j + X_1^+ + \cdots + X_{r-1}^+$ are functions of the minus runs and of $X_1^+, \dots, X_{r-1}^+$. So X_r^+ is independent of them and has the law of X_+.

Put $c = j/(1-p)$, $\mathcal{S} = \{m : |m - c| > RB_N\}$ and $\mathcal{V} = \{m : |m - c| \leq RB_N/2\}$. If $t_j \in \mathcal{V}$ and $\xi_j < RB_N/2$, then the steps $t_j, \dots, t_j + \xi_j$ all lie outside $\mathcal{S}$. Hence, by Tonelli's theorem,

$$\sum_{m \in \mathcal{S}} \Pi_m^-(j) = \mathbb{E}\,\#\{m \in \mathcal{S} : C_m = j\} \leq \mathbb{E}\big[(1 + X_r^+)\mathbf{1}_{\{t_j \notin \mathcal{V}\}}\big] + \mathbb{E}\big[(1 + X_r^+)\mathbf{1}_{\{X_r^+ \geq RB_N/2\}}\big].$$

By the independence just noted, the first term is $(1 + \mu_+)\mathbb{P}(t_j \notin \mathcal{V})$ and the second is $\mathbb{E}[(1 + X_+)\mathbf{1}_{\{X_+ \geq RB_N/2\}}]$, which tends to zero as $N \to \infty$ because $\mu_+ < \infty$.

It remains to bound $\mathbb{P}(t_j \notin \mathcal{V})$. Let $m_1 = \lfloor c + RB_N/2 \rfloor$ and $m_2 = \lceil c - RB_N/2 \rceil$. If $t_j \notin \mathcal{V}$, then $t_j > m_1$ or $t_j \leq m_2$. Now $\{t_j > m_1\} = \{C_{m_1} < j\} = \{A_{m_1} > m_1 - j\}$, and $m_1 - j - pm_1 = (1-p)m_1 - j \geq (1-p)(RB_N/2 - 1) \geq (1-p)RB_N/4$ for large N. In the same way $\{t_j \leq m_2\} = \{A_{m_2} \leq m_2 - j\}$ and $(1-p)m_2 - j \leq -(1-p)RB_N/4$, and this event is empty if $m_2 < 1$. For $N \geq N_0$ we have $RB_N \leq N$, so $m_1, m_2 \leq c_9 N$ with $c_9 = 2 + 1/(1-p)$, and $B_{m_i} \leq B_{c_9 N} \leq c_{10} B_N$ for some c_{10} by Lemma 2.1(ii). Hence

$$\mathbb{P}(t_j \notin \mathcal{V}) \leq 2 \sup_{n \geq 1} \mathbb{P}\Big(|A_n - pn| > \frac{(1-p)R}{4c_{10}}\, B_n\Big),$$

which is small for large R by Lemma 5.2. □

Finally we record the fresh big-jump asymptotics at a general horizon. For a horizon n and a point $k \leq n$ with $L = L_k^{(n)} \geq 1$ let $\overline{G}_n^{(\sigma_0)}(k) = (n-L)f_+(\lfloor L \rfloor)/\mu_- + T_+(\lfloor L \rfloor)\kappa_+^{(\sigma_0)}(n-k)$ be the kernel (4.3) at the horizon n with the limit coefficient. Assume (RV) and (SPAN)

for both signs and (LR) for the plus sign. By the last clause of Theorem B(b), applied at the horizon n, for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there are K_0 and n_0 such that

$$\bigl|F_n^{\sigma_0}(k) - \overline{G}_n^{(\sigma_0)}(k)\bigr| \le \varepsilon\, \widehat{G}_n(k) \qquad (n \ge n_0,\ pn + K_0\lambda_n B_n \le k \le n) \tag{5.7}$$

for both starting signs, and by (4.14) both $\overline{G}_n^{(\sigma_0)}(k)$ and $G_n^{(\sigma_0)}(k)$ are at most $C_{\mathrm{G}}\widehat{G}_n(k)$ whenever $L_k^{(n)} \ge 1$.

5.3 The bulk, parts (a) and (b)

Proof of Theorem C(a). By the definition of Π_m^σ we have $F_{N-d}^-(k-d) = \Pi_{N-d}^-(N-k)$ and $F_{N-d}^+(k) = \Pi_{N-d}^+(k)$. Fix $J \ge 1$. By Proposition 2.4, for $N > 2J$,

$$B_N P_N(k) = B_N Q_+(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{k=N\}} + B_N Q_-(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{k=0\}} + E_1(k) + E_2(k) + E_3(k),$$

where E_1, E_2 and E_3 collect the first-run lengths $d \le J$, $J < d \le N/2$ and $N/2 < d < N$, each multiplied by B_N. In E_3 put $m = N - d$, so that $1 \le m < N/2$. By (5.1) this gives exactly $E_3(k) = \mathcal{D}_N^+(N-k) + \mathcal{D}_N^-(k)$.

For E_2 the horizon is $N - d \ge N/2$. By Theorem A(b) there is C_{10} with $B_n F_n^{\sigma_0}(k) \le C_{10}$ for all n, k and σ_0. By Lemma 2.1(v), $B_N/B_{N-d} \le B_N/B_{\lceil N/2\rceil} \le C$. Hence $0 \le E_2(k) \le CC_{10}\mathbb{P}(D > J)$ for all k.

For E_1 we claim that for each fixed $d \ge 1$

$$\sup_{k\in\mathbb{Z}}\bigl|B_N F_{N-d}^-(k-d) - h_N(x_{N,k})\bigr| \to 0, \qquad \sup_{k\in\mathbb{Z}}\bigl|B_N F_{N-d}^+(k) - h_N(x_{N,k})\bigr| \to 0. \tag{5.8}$$

We prove the first, and the second is the same with pd in place of $-(1-p)d$ below. Put $n = N - d$. By Theorem A(a), $B_n F_n^-(k-d) = h_n(y_k) + o(1)$ uniformly in k, with $y_k = (k - d - pn)/B_n = (k - pN - (1-p)d)/B_n$. Also $B_N/B_n \to 1$ and h_n is bounded. By Lemma 2.2(c), $\|h_n - h_N\|_\infty \to 0$. Fix R. If $|x_{N,k}| \le R$, then $|y_k - x_{N,k}| \le R|B_N/B_n - 1| + (1-p)d/B_n \to 0$, and the Lipschitz bound of Lemma 2.2(a) gives $|h_N(y_k) - h_N(x_{N,k})| \to 0$. If $|x_{N,k}| > R$, then $|y_k| \ge R/2$ for large N, and both values are at most $\varepsilon_h(R/2)$. Let $N \to \infty$ and then $R \to \infty$. This proves (5.8). Summing it over the finitely many $d \le J$ gives $\sup_k |E_1(k) - \mathbb{P}(D \le J)h_N(x_{N,k})| \to 0$.

Let $e_N(k)$ be the difference between $B_N P_N(k)$ and the right side of (a) without the term $o(1)$. Collecting the three parts, $\limsup_{N\to\infty}\sup_{0\le k\le N}|e_N(k)| \le (C_1 + CC_{10})\mathbb{P}(D > J)$, with C_1 the bound of Lemma 2.2(a). This tends to zero as $J \to \infty$, since D is finite almost surely. □

Proof of Theorem C(b). The two defects are nonnegative. If $\mathcal{D}_N^+(N-k) \ne 0$, then some $m < N/2$ has $\Pi_m^-(N-k) > 0$, so $N - k \le m < N/2$ and $k > N/2$. In the same way $\mathcal{D}_N^-(k) \ne 0$ forces $k < N/2$. So the two defects have disjoint supports in $1 \le k < N$, and as k runs over $1 \le k < N$ the arguments $N - k$ and k run over all b at which $\mathcal{D}_N^\sigma(b)$ can be positive. Hence $\sup_{1\le k<N}\bigl(\mathcal{D}_N^+(N-k) + \mathcal{D}_N^-(k)\bigr) = \max(\Delta_{+,N}, \Delta_{-,N})$. Part (a) and the inequality $|\sup|f+g| - \sup|f|| \le \sup|g|$ then give

$$\sup_{1\le k<N}\bigl|B_N P_N(k) - h_N(x_{N,k})\bigr| = \max(\Delta_{+,N}, \Delta_{-,N}) + o(1).$$

At $k = N$ part (a) gives $B_N P_N(N) = B_N Q_+(N) + h_N(x_{N,N}) + o(1)$, since $\mathcal{D}_N^+(0) = 0$ and $\mathcal{D}_N^-(N) = 0$. Here $x_{N,N} = (1-p)N/B_N \to \infty$, so $h_N(x_{N,N}) \to 0$ by Lemma 2.2(b). The same holds at $k = 0$ with Q_-. This proves the formula for the error over the whole range.

Now we compare the defects with the atoms. The term $m = 1$ of (5.1) at $b = 1$ is $B_N\nu_+(N-1)\Pi_1^-(1) = B_N\nu_+(N-1)$, since a fresh minus walk of one step has one minus

step. So $\Delta_{+,N} \ge B_N \nu_+(N-1)$. In the other direction, $\nu_+(N-m) \le \sup_{d>N/2} \nu_+(d)$ for $m < N/2$, and the Green identity, Lemma 2.5, together with $u_- \le 1$ gives

$$\Delta_{+,N} \le (1+\mu_+)\, B_N \sup_{d>N/2} \nu_+(d) \le (1+\mu_+)\, C \sup_{d>N/2} B_d\, \nu_+(d), \tag{5.9}$$

with C a bound for B_N/B_d on $d > N/2$. The same bounds hold for the minus sign. Since $B_N/B_{N-1} \to 1$ and $\mathbb{P}(D=n) = \nu_+(n) + \nu_-(n)$, the two bounds show that $\max(\Delta_{+,N}, \Delta_{-,N}) \to 0$ if and only if $B_n \mathbb{P}(D=n) \to 0$. This is the interior criterion. For the whole range we need in addition $B_N Q_\sigma(N) \to 0$ for both signs, and since $\nu_\sigma \le Q_\sigma$ this condition implies the interior one. This is the criterion $B_n \mathbb{P}(D \ge n) \to 0$.

Finally let $\varepsilon N \le k \le (1-\varepsilon)N$. A nonzero term of $\mathcal{D}^+_N(N-k)$ has $m \ge N-k \ge \varepsilon N$, and Theorem A(b) gives $\Pi^-_m(N-k) \le C_{10}/B_m \le C_{10}/B_{\lceil \varepsilon N \rceil}$. Hence $\mathcal{D}^+_N(N-k) \le C_{10}(B_N/B_{\lceil \varepsilon N \rceil})\, Q_+(\lceil N/2 \rceil) \to 0$, since D is finite almost surely. The minus defect is the same, and part (a) gives the approximation on this range. □

5.4 The boundary layer, part (d)

Proof of Theorem C(d). The proof uses only (RV) for the plus sign, through Theorem B(a) and the bound $T_+(\lceil N/2 \rceil) \le C T_+(N)$ of Lemma 2.1(ii). Fix $j \ge 0$ and let $N > 2j$. Proposition 2.4 at $k = N-j$ gives

$$P_N(N-j) = Q_+(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{j=0\}} + \sum_{d<N} \nu_-(d)\, F^+_{N-d}(N-j) + \sum_{d<N} \nu_+(d)\, F^-_{N-d}(N-d-j).$$

In the first sum the fresh plus walk on $N-d$ steps has $N-j$ plus steps, so $d \le j$, and it then has $j-d$ minus steps. For each such d, Theorem B(a) at the horizon $N-d$ and (2.11) give $F^+_{N-d}(N-j)/T_+(N-d) \to u_-(j-d)$, and $T_+(N-d)/T_+(N) \to 1$ by (RV). The sum has at most j terms. So the first sum equals $T_+(N)\big(\sum_{d=1}^{j} \nu_-(d) u_-(j-d) + o(1)\big)$.

Split the second sum at J and at $N/2$, with J fixed. For $d \le J$, Theorem B(a) for a fresh minus start and (2.11) give $F^-_{N-d}(N-d-j)/T_+(N-d) \to u_-(j)\mathbf{1}_{\{j\ge 1\}}$, so this part equals $T_+(N)\big(\mathbb{P}(\Sigma=+, D \le J) u_-(j)\mathbf{1}_{\{j\ge1\}} + o(1)\big)$. For $J < d \le N/2$ the horizon is $n = N-d \ge N/2$. The convergent sequence $F^-_n(n-j)/T_+(n)$ is bounded by some C_j for $n \ge N/2$ and large N, and $T_+(n) \le T_+(\lceil N/2 \rceil) \le C T_+(N)$. So this part is at most $C C_j Q_+(J+1) T_+(N)$. For $N/2 < d < N$ put $m = N-d$. Then $F^-_{N-d}(N-d-j) = \Pi^-_m(j)$, and by (5.1) this part equals $B_N^{-1}\mathcal{D}^+_N(j)$ exactly. Collecting terms and using (5.2),

$$\limsup_{N\to\infty} \frac{\big|P_N(N-j) - Q_+(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{j=0\}} - T_+(N)\kappa_+(j) - B_N^{-1}\mathcal{D}^+_N(j)\big|}{T_+(N)} \le (1 + CC_j)\, Q_+(J+1),$$

and the right side tends to zero as $J \to \infty$. This is the expansion.

Let $j \ge 1$. If $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$, then the Green identity, Lemma 2.5, and $u_- \le 1$ give $B_N^{-1}\mathcal{D}^+_N(j) \le (1+\mu_+)\sup_{d>N/2}\nu_+(d) = o(T_+(\lceil N/2 \rceil)) = o(T_+(N))$, so $P_N(N-j)/T_+(N) \to \kappa_+(j)$. Conversely, suppose this limit holds for one $j \ge 1$. By Lemma 2.5 the weights $\Pi^-_m(j)$, $m \ge 1$, add up to $1 + \mu_+ u_-(j) \ge 1$, so there is an $m_0 = m_0(j) \ge 1$ with $\Pi^-_{m_0}(j) > 0$, and it does not depend on N. (If $T_-(j) > 0$ one may take $m_0 = j$, with $\Pi^-_j(j) = T_-(j)$.) For $N > 2m_0$ the term $m = m_0$ of (5.1) gives $B_N^{-1}\mathcal{D}^+_N(j) \ge \nu_+(N-m_0)\Pi^-_{m_0}(j)$, and the expansion makes the left side $o(T_+(N))$. Since $T_+(N)/T_+(N-m_0) \to 1$, we get $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$.

Finally let ν_+ satisfy (Rν) and $j \ge 1$. For each fixed m, $\nu_+(N-m)/\nu_+(N) \to 1$, and $\nu_+(N-m) \le C_\nu \nu_+(N)$ for $m < N/2$. By Lemma 2.5 the weights $\Pi^-_m(j)$ have the finite sum $1 + \mu_+ u_-(j)$. Dominated convergence gives $B_N^{-1}\mathcal{D}^+_N(j)/\nu_+(N) = \sum_{m<N/2}(\nu_+(N-m)/\nu_+(N))\Pi^-_m(j) \to 1 + \mu_+ u_-(j)$. □

5.5 The big-jump zone, parts (c) and (e)

Proof of the decomposition in Theorem C(c). Fix $\varepsilon \in (0,1]$ and take K_0 and n_0 from (5.7). Let $K \ge 4K_0$ and $J \ge 1$. Let $pN + K\lambda_N B_N \le k \le N$, and write $L = L_k$ and $j = N - k$. Then $L \ge K\lambda_N B_N/(1-p) \ge KB_N/(1-p)$, since $\lambda_N \ge 1$, and $N - L = j/(1-p)$. Take N so large that $\min(p, \frac{1}{2})N \ge n_0$, that $J < L/2$, and that (5.6) holds with $c = \min(p, \frac{1}{2})$. By Proposition 2.4,

$$P_N(k) = Q_+(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{k=N\}} + E_1 + E_2 + E_3 + E_4 + \Psi_N(k),$$

where E_1 and E_2 collect $\nu_-(d)F^+_{N-d}(k)$ over $d \le \min(J, j)$ and over $J < d \le j$, and E_3 and E_4 collect $\nu_+(d)F^-_{N-d}(k-d)$ over $d \le J$ and over $J < d < L/2$. The terms $\nu_-(d)F^+_{N-d}(k)$ with $d > j$ vanish, since then $k > N - d$.

Step 1 (geometry). Let $d \le j$ and $n = N - d$. Then $n \ge k > pN$, so $n \ge n_0$, and $L^{(n)}_k = L + pd/(1-p) \ge L$. Also $k - pn \ge k - pN \ge K\lambda_N B_N \ge (K/2)\lambda_n B_n$, by (5.6) and since B is nondecreasing. So k lies in the zone of (5.7) at the horizon n, and $\widehat{G}_n(k) \le (N/L)T_+(\lfloor L \rfloor) = \widehat{G}_N(k)$ because T_+ is nonincreasing. Let $d < L/2$ and $n = N - d \ge N/2$. Then $L^{(n)}_{k-d} = L - d \ge L/2$, and $(k-d) - pn = (1-p)(L-d) \ge K\lambda_N B_N/2 \ge (K/4)\lambda_n B_n$, again by (5.6), so $k - d$ lies in that zone at the horizon n. By Lemma 2.1(ii), $\widehat{G}_n(k-d) \le (2N/L)T_+(\lfloor L/2 \rfloor) \le C_*\widehat{G}_N(k)$ for large N.

Step 2 (intermediate first-run lengths). By Step 1 and (5.7), every fresh probability in E_2 and E_4 is at most $(C_{\mathrm{G}} + 1)$ times the corresponding $\widehat{G}_n$, since $\varepsilon \le 1$. Hence $E_2 + E_4 \le (C_{\mathrm{G}} + 1)(1 + C_*)\mathbb{P}(D > J)\,\widehat{G}_N(k)$.

Step 3 (short first-run lengths). Let $d \le J$. By Step 1 and (5.7),

$$|F^+_{N-d}(k) - \overline{G}^{(+)}_{N-d}(k)| \le \varepsilon \widehat{G}_N(k), \qquad |F^-_{N-d}(k-d) - \overline{G}^{(-)}_{N-d}(k-d)| \le \varepsilon C_* \widehat{G}_N(k).$$

With $L' = L + pd/(1-p)$ and $(N-d) - L' = (j-d)/(1-p)$, and with (2.11), the kernels are

$$\overline{G}^{(+)}_{N-d}(k) = \frac{j-d}{(1-p)\mu_-} f_+(\lfloor L' \rfloor) + T_+(\lfloor L' \rfloor)\, u_-(j-d),$$
$$\overline{G}^{(-)}_{N-d}(k-d) = \frac{N-L}{\mu_-} f_+(\lfloor L - d \rfloor) + T_+(\lfloor L - d \rfloor)\, u_-(j)\mathbf{1}_{\{j \ge 1\}}.$$

By (LR) and (RV), $f_+(m+i)/f_+(m) \to 1$ and $T_+(m+i)/T_+(m) \to 1$ as $m \to \infty$, uniformly in $|i| \le 2J/(1-p)$. Let r_N be the largest deviation from one of these ratios over $m \ge KB_N/(2(1-p))$. Then $r_N \to 0$. Note that $(j-d)/(1-p) = (N-L) - d/(1-p)$ and that $f_+(\lfloor L' \rfloor) \le 2CT_+(\lfloor L \rfloor)/L$ for large N, by (LR). Hence

$$\Big|\overline{G}^{(+)}_{N-d}(k) - \frac{N-L}{\mu_-} f_+(\lfloor L \rfloor) - T_+(\lfloor L \rfloor) u_-(j-d)\Big| \le C\Big(r_N + \frac{J}{L}\Big)\widehat{G}_N(k),$$

and $\overline{G}^{(-)}_{N-d}(k-d)$ differs from $(N-L)f_+(\lfloor L \rfloor)/\mu_- + T_+(\lfloor L \rfloor)u_-(j)\mathbf{1}_{\{j\ge 1\}}$ by at most $Cr_N\widehat{G}_N(k)$. Here we used $(N-L)f_+(\lfloor L \rfloor) \le C\widehat{G}_N(k)$ and $T_+(\lfloor L \rfloor) \le \widehat{G}_N(k)$.

Now we sum over d. In E_3 the weights sum to $\mathbb{P}(\Sigma = +, D \le J)$, which differs from π_+ by at most $\mathbb{P}(D > J)$. In E_1 the weights of the interior term sum to $\mathbb{P}(\Sigma = -, D \le \min(J, j))$. If $j \ge J$ this differs from π_- by at most $\mathbb{P}(D > J)$. If $j < J$, then $N - L < J/(1-p)$ and the whole interior term is at most $CJ\,T_+(\lfloor L \rfloor)/L \le C(J/L)\widehat{G}_N(k)$. The boundary terms in E_1 sum to $T_+(\lfloor L \rfloor)\sum_{d \le \min(J,j)} \nu_-(d)u_-(j-d)$, which differs from $T_+(\lfloor L \rfloor)\sum_{d \le j} \nu_-(d)u_-(j-d)$ by at most $\mathbb{P}(D > J)\widehat{G}_N(k)$, since $u_- \le 1$. By (5.2) and (5.3),

$$|E_1 + E_3 - G^\nu_N(k)| \le C\Big(\varepsilon + r_N + \frac{J}{L} + \mathbb{P}(D > J)\Big)\widehat{G}_N(k).$$

Step 4 (conclusion). Steps 2 and 3 and $J/L \le (1-p)J/(KB_N)$ give, for $K \ge 4K_0$ and large N,

$$\sup_{pN+K\lambda_N B_N \le k \le N} \frac{|P_N(k) - Q_+(N)\mathbf{1}_{\{k=N\}} - G^\nu_N(k) - \Psi_N(k)|}{\widehat{G}_N(k)} \le C\Big(\varepsilon + r_N + \frac{(1-p)J}{KB_N} + \mathbb{P}(D > J)\Big).$$

Let $N \to \infty$, then $J \to \infty$. The bound becomes $C\varepsilon$ for every $K \ge 4K_0(\varepsilon)$, and ε is arbitrary. □

Proof of the criteria in Theorem C(c). The whole zone. By the decomposition, the statement without Ψ_N holds if and only if $\lim_K \limsup_N \sup_k \Psi_N(k)/\widehat{G}_N(k) = 0$, the supremum being over the zone. Suppose $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$. Every d in (5.4) has $d \ge L_k/2$, and Lemma 2.5 with $u_- \le 1$ gives, with $j = N-k$,

$$\Psi_N(k) \le \sup_{d \ge L_k/2} \nu_+(d) \sum_{m \ge 1} \Pi^-_m(j) \le (1+\mu_+) \sup_{d \ge L_k/2} \nu_+(d), \tag{5.10}$$

because $F^-_{N-d}(k-d) = \Pi^-_{N-d}(j)$ and distinct d give distinct $m = N-d$. The right side is $o(T_+(\lceil L_k/2 \rceil)) = o(T_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor))$ by Lemma 2.1(ii), and $T_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor) \le \widehat{G}_N(k)$. Conversely, for large N the point $k = N-1$ lies in the zone for every K, because $\lambda_N B_N = o(N)$, and it has $L = N - 1/(1-p) \ge N/2$. The term $d = N-1$ of (5.4) gives $\Psi_N(N-1) \ge \nu_+(N-1)F^-_1(0) = \nu_+(N-1)$, and $\widehat{G}_N(N-1) \le 2T_+(\lfloor N/2 \rfloor) \le CT_+(N)$. So the criterion forces $\nu_+(N-1) = o(T_+(N))$, that is, $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$.

The regular case. Let ν_+ satisfy (Rν). Fix $\varepsilon > 0$. Take R and N_0 from Lemma 5.3, and $\delta > 0$ with $|\nu_+(d)/\nu_+(n) - 1| \le \varepsilon$ for $|d-n| \le \delta n$ and large n. Let $K \ge R(1-p)/\delta + 1$ and let $k < N$ lie in the zone, so $j = N-k \ge 1$. Put $\mathcal{V} = \{d : |d - L_k| \le RB_N\}$. Since $m = N-d$ satisfies $|m - j/(1-p)| = |d - L_k|$, Lemma 5.3 gives $\sum_{d \notin \mathcal{V}} \Pi^-_{N-d}(j) \le \varepsilon$, the sum running over all d with $N - d \ge 1$. Every $d \in \mathcal{V}$ satisfies $|d - L_k| \le RB_N \le \delta L_k$, because $L_k \ge KB_N/(1-p)$, so $d \ge L_k/2$ and $\nu_+(d) = \nu_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)(1 + O(\varepsilon))$. Hence

$$\Psi_N(k) = \nu_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)\big(1 + O(\varepsilon)\big) \sum_{d \in \mathcal{V}} \Pi^-_{N-d}(j) + O\big(\varepsilon C_\nu \nu_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)\big).$$

By Lemma 2.5 and the choice of R, the last sum lies between $1 + \mu_+ u_-(j) - \varepsilon$ and $1 + \mu_+ u_-(j)$. So $|\Psi_N(k) - \nu_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)(1 + \mu_+ u_-(j))| \le C\varepsilon\, \nu_+(\lfloor L_k \rfloor)$, and the decomposition gives the stated form. At $k = N$ both Ψ_N and the replacement vanish. □

Proof of Theorem C(e). Reduction. Fix $\varepsilon \in (0, \frac{1}{2})$. For large N the set Z^ε_N lies in the zone of (c) for every K, because $\lambda_N B_N = o(N)$, and it contains no $k = N$. So the decomposition of (c) gives $\sup_{k \in Z^\varepsilon_N} |P_N(k) - G^\nu_N(k) - \Psi_N(k)|/\widehat{G}_N(k) \to 0$, and (5.5) holds if and only if $\Psi_N = o(\widehat{G}_N)$ uniformly on Z^ε_N for every ε. On Z^ε_N we have $T_+(N) \le \widehat{G}_N(k) \le \varepsilon^{-1} T_+(\lfloor \varepsilon N \rfloor) \le C_\varepsilon T_+(N)$. So the condition reads $\sup_{k \in Z^\varepsilon_N} \Psi_N(k) = o(T_+(N))$. Sufficiency of $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$ follows from (5.10).

For the necessity of the window condition, let n be large, put $N = 2n$ and choose k with $|L_k - n| \le 1/(1-p)$, which is possible because L_k moves in steps of $1/(1-p)$. Then $k \in Z^{1/4}_N$. For $|d-n| \le B_n$ put $m = N - d$. Then $m \in [N/4, 3N/4]$, and $(m-j) - pm = (1-p)(L_k - d)$ has absolute value at most $2(1-p)B_n \le c_{11}B_m$, with c_{11} depending only on the laws, by Lemma 2.1(ii). Theorem A(c) and Lemma 2.2(d) give $B_m \Pi^-_m(j) = B_m F^-_m(m-j) \ge c_{12} > 0$ for large n. Also $d \ge L_k/2$ and $B_m \le CB_n$. Hence $\Psi_N(k) \ge (c_{12}/C)W_n$. If (5.5) holds, then $\Psi_N = o(T_+(N))$ on $Z^{1/4}_N$ by the reduction, so $W_n = o(T_+(2n)) = o(T_+(n))$.

Sufficiency of the window condition under (LR) for both signs. Let $W_n = o(T_+(n))$ and $k \in Z_N^\varepsilon$, with $j = N - k \geq (1-p)\varepsilon N$. A nonzero term of (5.4) has $m = N - d \geq j$, so $m \in [(1-p)\varepsilon N, N]$ and $d \in [\varepsilon N/2, N]$. Hence $B_m \geq c_\varepsilon B_N$, and Theorem A(b) gives $\Pi_m^-(j) \leq C_\varepsilon / B_N$. Put $\overline{W}_N = \sup_{\varepsilon N/4 \leq n \leq N} W_n$, which is $o(T_+(N))$ by (RV). Split the d axis into the blocks $\mathcal{B}_i = \{d : iB_N \leq d - L_k < (i+1)B_N\}$, $i \in \mathbb{Z}$. Each block meets $[\varepsilon N/2, N]$ in a set covered by at most C_ε windows $[n - B_n, n + B_n]$ with $\varepsilon N/4 \leq n \leq N$, so $\nu_+(\mathcal{B}_i \cap [\varepsilon N/2, N]) \leq C_\varepsilon B_N \overline{W}_N$. The blocks with $|i| \leq R$ contribute at most $(2R+2)C_\varepsilon^2 \overline{W}_N$ to $\Psi_N(k)$.

For the blocks with $|i| > R$ we do not use (5.7), since its zone, and its analogue at the minus end, carry logarithmic factors that are unbounded when $\alpha_+ \neq \alpha_-$. We use a bound that needs only an excess of order B_m. Let m be a large horizon and $k' > pm$ a point, and put $L = L_{k'}^{(m)}$ and $g = \lceil L/32 \rceil$. We apply (4.10) at the horizon m for a fresh minus start and drop its last term. We bound its first term by Lemma 4.3 with $\eta = 1/32$ and $r = 2$, and Cen_g and Int_g by (4.11), with $\kappa_+^{(-)} \leq 1$ and $\gamma_+^{(-)}(m - k') \leq (1 + \mu_+)m$. By (LR) for the plus sign, $f_+^*(g) \leq C_{\mathrm{LR}} T_+(g)/g$, and $T_+(g) \leq C T_+(L)$ by Lemma 2.1(ii). Since $L \leq m$, this gives

$$F_m^-(k') \leq C \, \frac{(mT_+(L))^2}{b_{+,m}} + \frac{C}{b_{-,m}} \, e^{-cL/b_{-,m}} + Ce^{-m^c} + C \, \frac{m}{L} \, T_+(L) \qquad (L \geq C_9 B_m), \tag{5.11}$$

with C and c depending only on the laws and $C_9 \geq C_8$ the larger of the thresholds of Lemma 4.3 at the two ends. The minus-end forms of Lemmas 4.1 and 4.3, with (LR) for the minus sign, give the same bound for $k' < pm$ with the signs exchanged, with the same constants. There L is replaced by $L^- = (pm - k')/p$, T_+ by T_-, and $b_{+,m}$ and $b_{-,m}$ by $b_{-,m}$ and $b_{+,m}$.

Now let $|i| > R$ and $d \in \mathcal{B}_i$, so that $m = N - d \in [(1-p)\varepsilon N, N]$ and $\Pi_m^-(j) = F_m^-(k')$ with $k' = m - j$. Then $k' - pm = (1-p)(L_k - d)$. If $d < L_k$, then $k' > pm$ and $L = L_k - d > (|i| - 1)B_N$. If $d > L_k$, then $k' < pm$ and $L^- = (1-p)(d - L_k)/p \geq (1-p)|i|B_N/p$. Put $c_* = \min(1, (1-p)/p)$, so the excess is at least $y_i = c_*(|i| - 1)B_N$ in both cases. Choose R with $c_* R \geq \max(C_9, 1)$. Then $y_i \geq C_9 B_N \geq C_9 B_m$, so (5.11) or its minus-end form applies, and $y_i \geq B_N \geq b_{\sigma,N}$ for both signs. Each term of (5.11) decreases in L. For these m we have $mT_\sigma \leq NT_\sigma$ and $c_\varepsilon b_{\sigma,N} \leq b_{\sigma,m} \leq b_{\sigma,N}$. We treat the blocks with $i < 0$, and those with $i > 0$ are the same with the signs exchanged. We multiply the four terms of (5.11) at $L = y_i$ by the block mass $C_\varepsilon B_N \overline{W}_N$, sum over $i < -R$, and leave out the common factor $C_\varepsilon \overline{W}_N$ below. Put $t = |i| - 1 \geq 1$.

The first term. By (2.4), $(NT_+(y_i))^2 \leq 16 s^2 (y_i / b_{+,N})^{-\alpha_+ - 1}$, so the term is at most $C(B_N/b_{+,N})^{-\alpha_+} t^{-\alpha_+ - 1} \leq C t^{-\alpha_+ - 1}$. These sum to a constant.

The second term. Put $x = B_N / b_{-,N} \geq 1$. The term is at most $Cxe^{-cc_* tx}$, and $\sum_{t \geq 1} xe^{-cc_* tx} = x/(e^{cc_* x} - 1) \leq 1/(cc_*)$.

The third term. At most $N/B_N + 2$ blocks meet $[0, N]$, so these terms add up to at most $C(N + 2B_N)e^{-((1-p)\varepsilon N)^c}$, which tends to zero.

The fourth term. Fix $\delta' \in (0, \alpha_*)$. Since $c_* t \geq 1$, Lemma 2.1(ii) gives $T_+(y_i) \leq C t^{-\alpha_+ + \delta'} T_+(B_N)$. So the term is at most $CNT_+(y_i)/t \leq CNT_+(B_N) t^{-1-\alpha_+ + \delta'}$, and $NT_+(B_N) \leq NT_+(b_{+,N}) \to s$ by Lemma 2.1(v). These sum to a constant.

For $i > R$ the same four steps use (2.4) for the minus sign, $x = B_N / b_{+,N}$, and $NT_-(B_N) \leq NT_-(b_{-,N}) \to s$. So the blocks with $|i| > R$ contribute at most $C_\varepsilon \overline{W}_N$ to $\Psi_N(k)$. Hence $\sup_{k \in Z_N^\varepsilon} \Psi_N(k) \leq C_{\varepsilon,R} \overline{W}_N = o(T_+(N))$. □

The gap between the two interior conditions is real. If $\nu_+(n_i) = T_+(n_i)$ on a sparse sequence and $\nu_+ = 0$ near it, then $W_n = O(T_+(n)/B_n)$, so under (LR) for both signs the initial run is invisible on every interior zone, by the window criterion (the sufficiency just proved). It is visible at the point $N - 1$ for $N = n_i + 1$, where $P_N(N-1) \geq T_+(N-1)$,

and $\nu_+(n) \neq o(T_+(n))$. So the interior of the big-jump zone sees only window averages of the initial run, while the edge of the zone sees single atoms.

5.6 The stationary initial run

Corollary 5.4 (stationary initial run)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN), and let the initial run be stationary, $\nu_\sigma = T_\sigma/s$. Then the bulk criterion holds, and*

(a) the atoms are $Q_\sigma(N) = s^{-1}\sum_{d\geq N} T_\sigma(d) \sim NT_\sigma(N)/(s(\alpha_\sigma - 1))$.

(b) if (LR) holds for the plus sign, then, with λ_N as in (4.5)*,*

$$\lim_{K\to\infty} \limsup_{N\to\infty} \sup_{pN+K\lambda_N B_N \leq k < N} \Big| \frac{P_N(k)}{G^{\mathrm{st}}_N(k)} - 1 \Big| = 0,$$

where $G^{\mathrm{st}}_N(k) = (N-L_k)f_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor)/\mu_- + T_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor)\,\kappa^{\mathrm{st}}_+(N-k)$, and for fixed $v \in (p,1)$, with $\ell = (v-p)/(1-p)$, $P_N(\lfloor vN\rfloor)/T_+(N) \to I_+(v) + \ell^{-\alpha_+}/\mu_-$. So in the interior of the big-jump zone the kernel gains the term $T_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor)/\mu_-$, which is the complete initial plus run.

(c) the boundary kernel at the plus end is

$$\frac{P_N(N-j)}{T_+(N)} \to \kappa^{\mathrm{st}}_+(j) = \frac{2}{s}\big(1 + \mu_+ u_-(j)\big) \qquad (j \geq 1),$$

while $P_N(N)/T_+(N) \to \infty$. Moreover $\kappa^{\mathrm{st}}_+(j) \to 2/\mu_-$ as $j \to \infty$, which is the value of $I_+(v) + \ell^{-\alpha_+}/\mu_-$ at $v = 1$.

Proof. The bulk criterion holds because $B_n T_\sigma(n) \to 0$ by Lemma 2.1(v). Part (a) is Lemma 2.1(iv).

We first compute κ_+. Here $\pi_+ = \sum_d T_+(d)/s = \mu_+/s = p$, and $\sum_{d=1}^{j} T_-(d)u_-(j-d) = 1$ for $j \geq 1$ by (2.9). So (5.2) gives $\kappa_+(j) = pu_-(j) + 1/s$ for $j \geq 1$.

(c) The function $\nu_+ = T_+/s$ is regularly varying with index $-\alpha_+ < 0$, so it satisfies (Rν). Theorem C(d) gives, for $j \geq 1$,

$$\frac{P_N(N-j)}{T_+(N)} \to pu_-(j) + \frac{1}{s} + \frac{1}{s}\big(1 + \mu_+ u_-(j)\big) = \frac{2}{s} + \frac{2\mu_+}{s} u_-(j),$$

since $p = \mu_+/s$. Also $P_N(N) = Q_+(N)$, and $Q_+(N)/T_+(N) \to \infty$ by (a). By (2.10), $\kappa^{\mathrm{st}}_+(j) \to (2/s)(1 + \mu_+/\mu_-) = 2/\mu_-$.

(b) By the regular case of Theorem C(c), uniformly in the zone with $k < N$ and in the double limit,

$$P_N(k) = G^{\nu}_N(k) + \frac{T_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor)}{s}\big(1 + \mu_+ u_-(N-k)\big) + o\big(\widehat{G}_N(k)\big),$$

where we used $T_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor) \leq \widehat{G}_N(k)$. By the computation of κ_+ the right side is $G^{\mathrm{st}}_N(k) + o(\widehat{G}_N(k))$. For the ratio form we need $G^{\mathrm{st}}_N(k) \geq c\widehat{G}_N(k)$. Since $\kappa^{\mathrm{st}}_+ \geq 2/s$, this holds when $L_k > N/2$. When $L_k \leq N/2$, (LR) gives $(N-L_k)f_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor)/\mu_- \geq c(N/L_k)T_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor)$ for large N. Now fix $v \in (p,1)$ and let $k = \lfloor vN\rfloor$. Then k lies in the zone for every K when N is large, because $\lambda_N B_N = o(N)$. Also $L_k = \ell N + O(1)$ and $N - k \to \infty$. By (LR) and (RV), $(N-L_k)f_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor)/T_+(N) \to (1-\ell)\alpha_+\ell^{-\alpha_+-1}$ and $T_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor)/T_+(N) \to \ell^{-\alpha_+}$, and $\kappa^{\mathrm{st}}_+(N-k) \to 2/\mu_-$. This gives the limit $I_+(v) + \ell^{-\alpha_+}/\mu_-$, with I_+ as in Corollary 4.8. At $v = 1$ it equals $2/\mu_-$. □

In $\kappa_+^{\mathrm{st}}(j)$ the term $pu_-(j)$ comes from a short first plus run, the term $1/s$ from a short first minus run, and the term $(1+\mu_+u_-(j))/s$ from a first plus run that ends within $O(1)$ steps of the horizon. Section 7 reports a check of part (c) against the exact law. Wang, Vezzani, Burioni and Barkai [47, Eqs. (28), (46) and (47)] compared the equilibrated and the ordinary start formally, for a biased continuous-time random walk. The equilibrated start adds the term $\xi^{-\alpha}$ to their infinite density, where ξ is the fraction of the time taken by the longest trap, and an atom at the origin of order $t^{1-\alpha}$. They correspond to the term $\ell^{-\alpha_+}/\mu_-$ of (b) and to the atom of (a).

The same index comparisons place other initial runs. If $Q_\sigma \in \mathrm{RV}_{-\rho}$ with $\rho > 0$ and $\nu_\sigma(n) \sim \rho Q_\sigma(n)/n$, the bulk criterion holds, the criterion for the whole range holds for $\rho > 1/\alpha_*$ and fails for $\rho < 1/\alpha_*$, and since $\nu_+/T_+ \in \mathrm{RV}_{\alpha_+-1-\rho}$ the initial run is invisible in the boundary layer and, under (LR) for the plus sign, in the big-jump zone for $\rho > \alpha_+ - 1$ and visible for $\rho < \alpha_+ - 1$. The stationary initial run sits on the line $\rho = \alpha_\sigma - 1$ with $\nu_\sigma/T_\sigma = 1/s$, so it is visible there.

5.7 No universal trim and identification

Part (b) of Theorem C holds on every macroscopic interior with no condition. No sublinear trim of the range does the same.

Corollary 5.5 (no universal trim)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN). For every sequence of nonnegative integers $r_N = o(N)$ there is an initial run with a fixed deterministic sign for which the bulk approximation fails on $r_N \le k \le N - r_N$ along a subsequence.*

Proof. Put $R(n) = \max_{1\le i\le 2n} r_i$ and

$$m(n) = \left\lceil \max\left\{\sqrt{n},\ \frac{4(R(n)+1)}{1-p}\right\}\right\rceil.$$

Since $r_i = o(i)$, for every $\eta > 0$ we have $r_i \le \eta i$ for $i \ge i_\eta$, so $R(n) \le \max_{i<i_\eta} r_i + 2\eta n$ and $R(n) = o(n)$. Hence $m(n) \to \infty$ and $m(n) = o(n)$. Since B is regularly varying with the positive index $1/\alpha_*$, Lemma 2.1(ii) gives $B_{m(n)}/B_n \to 0$. Choose $n_1 < n_2 < \cdots$ so that $n_{i+1} > 2n_i$, $m(n_i) \le n_i$ and $\sum_i B_{m(n_i)}/B_{n_i} \le \frac{1}{2}$. Put $m_i = m(n_i)$, $N_i = n_i + m_i \le 2n_i$ and $v_i = B_{m_i}/B_{n_i}$. The initial run has $\Sigma = +$ almost surely, $\nu_+(n_i) = v_i$ for every i, and the remaining mass at $d = 1$. Then D is finite almost surely.

Fix i and let $k_i' = \lfloor pm_i \rfloor$. By Theorem A(c) and Lemma 2.2(d) there is $c > 0$ with $B_{m_i}F^-_{m_i}(k_i') \ge c$ for large i. Let $k_i = n_i + k_i'$. Proposition 2.4, keeping only the term $d = n_i$, gives

$$B_{N_i}P_{N_i}(k_i) \ge B_{N_i}\, v_i\, F^-_{m_i}(k_i') \ge c\,\frac{B_{N_i}}{B_{n_i}} \ge c,$$

because B is nondecreasing. On the other hand $k_i - pN_i = (1-p)n_i + (k_i' - pm_i) \ge (1-p)n_i - 1$, so $x_{N_i,k_i} \ge ((1-p)n_i - 1)/B_{2n_i} \to \infty$, and $h_{N_i}(x_{N_i,k_i}) \to 0$ by Lemma 2.2(b). So $|B_{N_i}P_{N_i}(k_i) - h_{N_i}(x_{N_i,k_i})| \ge c/2$ for large i.

It remains to check that k_i is retained. Since $N_i \le 2n_i$, we have $r_{N_i} \le R(n_i) = o(n_i)$, so $k_i \ge n_i \ge r_{N_i}$ for large i. Also $N_i - k_i = m_i - k_i' \ge (1-p)m_i \ge 4(R(n_i)+1) > r_{N_i}$. Hence $r_{N_i} \le k_i \le N_i - r_{N_i}$, and the approximation fails along N_i. □

The initial run violates the bulk criterion, since $B_{n_i}\nu_+(n_i) = B_{m_i} \to \infty$. Finally, the boundary layer is a renewal mass function, which determines its interarrival law, so the ends identify the run laws.

Remark 5.6 (identification from the ends)**.** Assume (RV) for both signs. (a) For a fresh plus start $P_N(N) = T_+(N)$ by Proposition 2.3, so the atoms determine f_+. By

Theorem B(a) and (2.11), $P_N(N-j)/P_N(N) \to u_-(j)$ for every fixed $j \geq 1$. Splitting the sum that defines $u_-(j)$ according to the length of the first run gives the renewal equation

$$f_-(j) = u_-(j) - \sum_{i=1}^{j-1} f_-(i)\, u_-(j-i), \qquad j \geq 1, \tag{5.12}$$

so u_- determines f_- by induction on j, and the family $(P_N)_{N\geq 1}$ determines both run laws. (b) Let the initial run satisfy $Q_+(N)/T_+(N) \to q \in (0,\infty)$. Then $\pi_+ = \mathbb{P}(\Sigma = +) > 0$ and $\nu_+(n) = Q_+(n) - Q_+(n+1) = o(T_+(n))$, since $T_+(n+1)/T_+(n) \to 1$. Theorem C(d) and $P_N(N) = Q_+(N)$ give $P_N(N-j)/P_N(N) \to \kappa_+(j)/q$. If the law of the initial run and q are known, then $\pi_+ u_-(j) = \kappa_+(j) - \sum_{d=1}^{j} \nu_-(d) u_-(j-d)$ determines u_- by induction, and (5.12) gives f_-. The stationary initial run fails the hypothesis, since its atom is of order $NT_+(N)$ by Corollary 5.4(a). (c) Ratios at the minus end cannot replace the atoms. For a fresh plus start Theorem B(a) with the signs exchanged gives $P_N(j)/T_-(N) \to u_+(j)$, so the ratios $P_N(j)/P_N(i)$ determine u_+ only up to a positive factor. For $0 < c \leq 1$ let X_+^c be the sum of a geometric number G of independent copies of X_+, with $\mathbb{P}(G = n) = c(1-c)^{n-1}$. With generating functions F of f_+ and $U = 1/(1-F)$, the law of X_+^c has $F_c = cF/(1-(1-c)F)$ and $1/(1-F_c) = 1 + c(U-1)$, so its renewal mass function is cu_+ on $j \geq 1$. Its support contains that of X_+, which gives (SPAN). Its tail is $\mathbb{P}(X_+^c \geq n) \sim T_+(n)/c$, by $\mathbb{P}(S_k^+ \geq n) \sim kT_+(n)$ for each k [3, Theorem 2.1], Kesten's bound [16, Lemma 1.3.5] and dominated convergence, which gives (RV). Replacing X_+ by X_+^c changes no ratio at either end. The atoms separate the laws f_+^c, and so does the bulk, since the mean μ_+/c changes p.

6 The shape of the law

This section reads three features of the shape off Theorems A to C. The first is the global mode, where the golden ratio enters, the second is the interior minimum between the bulk and the plus end, and the third is the local extrema near the ends.

6.1 The global mode

Let $P_N^{\max} = \max_{1\leq k<N} P_N(k)$ be the largest interior value and $H_N = \sup_x h_N(x)$ the height of the profile. By Proposition 2.4 the two endpoint atoms are $P_N(N) = Q_+(N)$ and $P_N(0) = Q_-(N)$.

Theorem D (the global mode)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN), and let the initial run satisfy the bulk criterion $B_n \mathbb{P}(D = n) \to 0$.*

(a) $P_N^{\max} = (H_N + o(1))/B_N$, every interior maximizer lies in $pN + O(B_N)$, and along any subsequence on which h_N converges uniformly the scaled maximizers $(k - pN)/B_N$ converge to the set of maximizers of the limit profile.

(b) If $\liminf_N B_N Q_\sigma(N)/H_N > 1$ for some sign σ, the endpoint atom of sign σ exceeds every interior value for all large N, so the global mode of P_N is an endpoint. If $\limsup_N B_N Q_\sigma(N)/H_N < 1$ for both signs, the global mode is interior for all large N.

(c) If $Q_\sigma \in \mathrm{RV}_{-\rho_\sigma}$, the endpoint of sign σ beats every interior value for all large N when $\rho_\sigma < 1/\alpha_*$, and loses to the largest interior value when $\rho_\sigma > 1/\alpha_*$.

(d) (The golden ratio.) For the stationary initial run, $\rho_\sigma = \alpha_\sigma - 1$. With equal indices $\alpha_+ = \alpha_- = \alpha$, the global mode is an endpoint for all large N when $\alpha < \varphi = (1+\sqrt{5})/2$ and is interior for all large N when $\alpha > \varphi$. For two equal laws $T_+(n) =$

$T_-(n) = n^{-\alpha}$ and the stationary initial run, $B_N Q_\sigma(N)/H_N \sim \mathcal{C}(\alpha) N^{1-\alpha+1/\alpha}$ for each sign, where

$$\mathcal{C}(\alpha) = \frac{\pi\big(K_\alpha|\cos\tfrac{\pi\alpha}{2}|\big)^{1/\alpha}}{4(\alpha-1)\,\Gamma(1+\tfrac{1}{\alpha})\,\zeta(\alpha)^{1+1/\alpha}}, \tag{6.1}$$

and at $\alpha = \varphi$ the ratio tends to $\mathcal{C}(\varphi) = 0.7761317\ldots < 1$, so the global mode is interior. For a fresh start of sign σ_0, $Q_{\sigma_0} = T_{\sigma_0}$, $Q_{\bar\sigma_0} = 0$ and $\rho_{\sigma_0} = \alpha_{\sigma_0} > 1 > 1/\alpha_*$, so the global mode is interior for all large N and every pair of indices.

Proof. (a) Put $h_* = \inf_N H_N$, which is positive by Lemma 2.2(d). By Theorem C(b) the bulk criterion gives

$$\varepsilon_N = \sup_{1\le k<N} \big|B_N P_N(k) - h_N(x_{N,k})\big| \to 0. \tag{6.2}$$

Hence $B_N P_N^{\max} = \max_{1\le k<N} h_N(x_{N,k}) + O(\varepsilon_N)$, and $\max_k h_N(x_{N,k}) \le H_N$. For the lower bound, Lemma 2.2(b) gives K with $\sup_{|x|>K} h_N(x) < h_*/2$ for all N, so H_N is the supremum of h_N over $[-K,K]$. For large N the points $x_{N,k}$ with $1 \le k < N$ cover $[-K,K]$ with mesh $1/B_N$, since $pN/B_N \to \infty$ and $(1-p)N/B_N \to \infty$. The common Lipschitz constant of Lemma 2.2(a) gives $\max_k h_N(x_{N,k}) \ge H_N - C_2/B_N$. Hence $B_N P_N^{\max} = H_N + o(1)$.

Let k_N be an interior maximizer. Then $h_N(x_{N,k_N}) \ge B_N P_N^{\max} - \varepsilon_N = H_N - o(1) > h_*/2$ for large N, so $|x_{N,k_N}| \le K$, which is the statement $k_N \in pN + O(B_N)$. Along a subsequence with $h_N \to h$ uniformly we have $H_N \to \sup h$ and $h(x_{N,k_N}) \ge H_N - o(1)$. Every limit point x of the bounded sequence x_{N,k_N} satisfies $h(x) = \sup h$ by continuity. So the distance from x_{N,k_N} to the set of maximizers of h tends to zero.

(b) If $B_N Q_\sigma(N) \ge (1+\eta) H_N$ for all large N, then by (a) $B_N Q_\sigma(N) - B_N P_N^{\max} \ge \eta H_N - o(1) \ge \eta h_* - o(1) > 0$, so the endpoint atom of sign σ exceeds every interior value. If $B_N Q_\sigma(N) \le (1-\eta) H_N$ for both signs and all large N, then (a) gives $B_N P_N^{\max} - B_N Q_\sigma(N) \ge \eta h_* - o(1) > 0$ for both signs.

(c) By Lemma 2.1(v), $B_N \in \mathrm{RV}_{1/\alpha_*}$. Hence $B_N Q_\sigma(N) \in \mathrm{RV}_{1/\alpha_* - \rho_\sigma}$. A regularly varying function with a positive index tends to infinity and one with a negative index tends to zero [5, Proposition 1.5.1]. Since H_N is bounded above and below by Lemma 2.2(a) and (d), part (b) applies.

(d) By Corollary 5.4(a) the stationary initial run satisfies the bulk criterion and $Q_\sigma(N) \sim N T_\sigma(N)/(s(\alpha_\sigma - 1))$, so $\rho_\sigma = \alpha_\sigma - 1$. With equal indices $\alpha_* = \alpha$, and $\alpha - 1 < 1/\alpha$ if and only if $\alpha^2 - \alpha - 1 < 0$, that is, $\alpha < \varphi$. Part (c) then shows that both endpoints beat the interior when $\alpha < \varphi$ and that both lose when $\alpha > \varphi$. For unequal indices part (c) shows that the endpoint of sign σ beats the interior if and only if $\alpha_\sigma - 1 < 1/\alpha_*$, away from equality.

Now let $T_+(n) = T_-(n) = n^{-\alpha}$. Then $\mu_\sigma = \sum_{n\ge1} n^{-\alpha} = \zeta(\alpha)$, $s = 2\zeta(\alpha)$, $p = 1/2$, $\theta_{+,N} = \theta_{-,N} = 1$, and we may take $a_\sigma(t) = t^{1/\alpha}$, so $B_N = (N/s)^{1/\alpha}$. The profile does not depend on N. It is the density h of $\frac12(Z_+ - Z_-)$ with Z_+ and Z_- independent copies of Z_α. Its characteristic function is

$$\exp\big(K_\alpha(-it/2)^\alpha + K_\alpha(it/2)^\alpha\big) = \exp\big(-c_\alpha|t|^\alpha\big), \qquad c_\alpha = 2^{1-\alpha} K_\alpha \big|\cos\tfrac{\pi\alpha}{2}\big|,$$

because $(-iy)^\alpha + (iy)^\alpha = 2y^\alpha \cos\frac{\pi\alpha}{2}$ for $y > 0$ and $\cos\frac{\pi\alpha}{2} < 0$. This function is positive and integrable, so by Fourier inversion $h(x) \le h(0)$ for every x, and

$$H_N = h(0) = \frac{1}{\pi}\int_0^\infty e^{-c_\alpha t^\alpha}\,dt = \frac{\Gamma(1+\frac1\alpha)}{\pi\, c_\alpha^{1/\alpha}}.$$

The stationary atom is $Q_\sigma(N) = s^{-1}\sum_{d\ge N} d^{-\alpha} \sim N^{1-\alpha}/(2(\alpha-1)\zeta(\alpha))$. Multiplying,

$$\frac{B_N Q_\sigma(N)}{H_N} \sim \frac{N^{1/\alpha+1-\alpha}}{(2\zeta(\alpha))^{1/\alpha}\cdot 2(\alpha-1)\zeta(\alpha)} \cdot \frac{\pi\, 2^{(1-\alpha)/\alpha}\big(K_\alpha|\cos\tfrac{\pi\alpha}{2}|\big)^{1/\alpha}}{\Gamma(1+\frac1\alpha)} = \mathcal{C}(\alpha)\, N^{1-\alpha+1/\alpha},$$

since $2^{(1-\alpha)/\alpha}2^{-1/\alpha}2^{-1} = 2^{-2}$. At $\alpha = \varphi$ the exponent vanishes, and $\alpha - 1 = 1/\varphi$, $1 + 1/\alpha = \varphi$ and $2 - \alpha = \varphi^{-2}$, so $K_\varphi = \varphi\,\Gamma(\varphi^{-2})$ and

$$\mathcal{C}(\varphi) = \frac{\pi\varphi\big(\varphi\,\Gamma(\varphi^{-2})|\cos\tfrac{\pi\varphi}{2}|\big)^{1/\varphi}}{4\,\Gamma(\varphi)\,\zeta(\varphi)^{\varphi}} = 0.7761317205\ldots.$$

That $\mathcal{C}(\varphi) < 1$ needs only four elementary bounds. Since $x^{-\varphi}$ is convex, the trapezoid rule gives $\zeta(\varphi) \ge \frac{1}{2} + 1/(\varphi - 1) = \varphi + \frac{1}{2}$. The minimum of Γ on $(0,\infty)$ exceeds 0.8856 [33, Section 5.4(iii)], so $\Gamma(\varphi) \ge 0.8856$. Since $\Gamma \le 1$ on $[1,2]$, $\Gamma(\varphi^{-2}) = \varphi^2\Gamma(1+\varphi^{-2}) \le \varphi^2$. Finally $\frac{\pi}{2} < \frac{\pi\varphi}{2} < \frac{5\pi}{6}$, so $|\cos\frac{\pi\varphi}{2}| \le \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$. Together these give $\mathcal{C}(\varphi) \le \pi\varphi(\sqrt{3}\varphi^3/2)^{1/\varphi}/(4\cdot 0.8856\,(\varphi+\frac{1}{2})^{\varphi}) = 0.9513\ldots < 1$, and (b) shows that the global mode is interior.

For a fresh start of sign σ_0 we have $\mathbb{P}(D = n) = f_{\sigma_0}(n) \le T_{\sigma_0}(n)$, and $B_nT_{\sigma_0}(n) \to 0$ by Lemma 2.1(v), so the bulk criterion holds. Moreover $Q_{\sigma_0} = T_{\sigma_0} \in \mathrm{RV}_{-\alpha_{\sigma_0}}$ with $\alpha_{\sigma_0} > 1 > 1/\alpha_*$, and the other atom vanishes. Part (c) concludes. □

For two equal laws $H_N = h(0)$, so $\mathcal{C}(\alpha)$ also compares the endpoint with the center point. On the line $\rho_\sigma = 1/\alpha_*$ the ratio $B_NQ_\sigma(N)/H_N$ is slowly varying, the comparison depends on the slowly varying factors, and we leave it open.

6.2 The boundary layer at second order

By Theorem B the law follows the renewal mass function u_- in the boundary layer, and $u_-(j) \to 1/\mu_-$ by (2.10). If u_- stays above its limit, the layer lies above the level $T_+(N)/\mu_-$ at which it meets the big-jump zone, while the big-jump kernel increases as k decreases from N. To locate the interior minimum between the two we need the boundary layer at second order, with an exact coefficient.

Theorem 6.1 (second order in the boundary layer)**.** *Assume (RV) and (LR) for the plus sign, and let the start be fresh with sign $+$. Put*

$$\begin{aligned} C(j) &= \alpha_+\Big[j\,u_-(j) + 2\mu_+v_-(j) + \sum_{i=0}^{j-1} u_-(i)\Big] \\ &= \alpha_+\Big[j\,u_-(j) + \mu_+v_-(j) + \sum_{i=0}^{j-1} u_-(i)\big(1 + \mu_+u_-(j-i)\big)\Big]. \end{aligned} \tag{6.3}$$

(a) For every fixed $j \ge 0$,

$$\frac{P_N(N-j)}{T_+(N)} = u_-(j) + \frac{C(j)}{N} + o\Big(\frac{1}{N}\Big).$$

(b) For every $\eta \in (0,1)$,

$$\sup_{1\le j\le N^{1-\eta}} \frac{N}{j}\,\Big|\frac{P_N(N-j)}{T_+(N)} - u_-(j) - \frac{C(j)}{N}\Big| \to 0.$$

If in addition (RV) and (SPAN) hold for the minus sign, then $C(j)/j \to 2\alpha_+s/\mu_-^2$ as $j \to \infty$.

In the second form of $C(j)$ the terms $j\,u_-(j) + \mu_+v_-(j)$ come from a giant run in progress at time N that starts after a steps, through $T_+(N-a)/T_+(N) = 1 + \alpha_+a/N + o(a/N)$, and the sum comes from a complete giant run followed by a fresh minus walk, through Lemma 2.5. We prove the first form. The convergence of $C(j)/j$ is slow, of the order of $jT_-(j)$ by (6.7) below. For the zeta law of Section 7 the limit is 3.0811, while $C(j)/j$ is 4.968, 3.762 and 3.323 at $j = 5$, 40 and 320.

The proof uses the final-run identity (2.14) and two renewal identities besides (2.9). Write $u = u_-$ and $v = v_-$. For $j \geq 1$,

$$\sum_{m=1}^{j} T_-(m)\, v(j-m) = \sum_{i=1}^{j-1} u(i), \tag{6.4}$$

$$\sum_{i=0}^{j-1} u(i)\, u(j-i) = v(j). \tag{6.5}$$

For (6.4), $v(j-m)T_-(m) = \sum_r r\mathbb{P}(S_r^- = j-m,\, X_{r+1}^- \geq m)$, so the sum is the expectation of the index r of the run that covers level j, minus one. That index minus one equals the number of $r \geq 1$ with $S_r^- \leq j-1$, whose expectation is $\sum_{i=1}^{j-1} u(i)$. For (6.5), $\sum_{i=0}^{j} u(i)u(j-i) = \sum_{a,b\geq 0} u_{a+b}^-(j) = \sum_n (n+1)u_n^-(j) = v(j) + u(j)$, and the term $i = j$ equals $u(j)$. By (6.5) the two forms of (6.3) agree.

We need two facts about sums of plus runs. Write $f = f_+$, $T = T_+$, $\alpha = \alpha_+$, $\mu = \mu_+$ and $S_r = S_r^+$ in Lemmas 6.2 and 6.3. Under (LR) the sequence f is regularly varying with index $-\alpha - 1$, and Lemma 2.1(i) gives, for every $c > 0$ and large n,

$$\sup_{m \geq cn} \frac{f(m)}{f(n)} \leq C_c, \qquad \sup_{0 \leq w \leq w_n} \Big| \frac{f(n-w)}{f(n)} - 1 \Big| \to 0 \quad \text{whenever } w_n = o(n). \tag{6.6}$$

By Lemma 2.1(iv), $\mathbb{E}[X_+^2; X_+ \leq y] \leq \sum_{n \leq y} (2n-1)T(n) \leq Cy^2 T(y)$ and $\mathbb{E}[X_+; X_+ > y] \to 0$. Finally $nT(n) \to 0$, since $nT(n) \in \mathrm{RV}_{1-\alpha}$.

Lemma 6.2 (uniform local big jump)**.** *Assume (RV) and (LR) for the plus sign, and fix $\eta \in (0,1)$. Then*

$$\sup_{1 \leq r \leq n^{1-\eta}} \Big| \frac{f^{*r}(n)}{r\, f(n)} - 1 \Big| \to 0 \qquad (n \to \infty).$$

Proof. For a fixed r this is the local subexponentiality of f. Indeed, for $r \geq 2$ split $f^{*r}(n) = \sum_m f^{*(r-1)}(m) f(n-m)$ at $m = n/2$. By (6.6) and dominated convergence the part $m \leq n/2$ is $f(n)(1 + o(1))$, and by induction on r the part $m > n/2$, which is $\sum_{i < n/2} f(i) f^{*(r-1)}(n-i)$ up to one term of order $f(n/2)^2 = o(f(n))$, is $(r-1)f(n)(1+o(1))$. For growing r we use the local big-jump theorem of Denisov, Dieker and Shneer [11, Theorem 9.1] for the centered step $\xi = X_+ - \mu$ and intervals of length $T = 1$. Its hypotheses, those of [11, Proposition 9.1], hold here. By Karamata's theorem $\mathbb{E}[\xi^2; |\xi| \leq x] \sim \frac{\alpha}{2-\alpha} x^2 T(x)$, which gives their (25), the left tail of ξ is bounded, which gives (26), and (27) follows from (25), $\mathbb{E}\xi = 0$ and the index $-\alpha < -1$ of the tail [11, Lemma 9.1]. The function $x \mapsto \mathbb{P}(x < \xi \leq x+1) = f(\lfloor x + \mu \rfloor + 1)$ is regularly varying with index $-\alpha - 1 < -1$, so it is intermediate regularly varying. The theorem then gives, for every $\varepsilon > 0$, an r_0 such that $|\mathbb{P}(S_r - r\mu \in (x, x+1])/(r\mathbb{P}(x < \xi \leq x+1)) - 1| \leq \varepsilon$ for all $r \geq r_0$ and all $x \geq x_r = \frac{1}{2} r^{1/(1-\eta)}$, because $rT(x_r) \to 0$ by Lemma 2.1(ii). Take $x = n - r\mu - \frac{1}{2}$. For $r \leq n^{1-\eta}$ and large n we have $x \geq n/2 \geq x_r$, the event is $\{S_r = n\}$, and $\mathbb{P}(x < \xi \leq x+1) = f(n')$ with $|n' - n| \leq r\mu + 1 = o(n)$, so $f(n') = f(n)(1 + o(1))$ by (6.6). Together with the finitely many $r < r_0$ this proves the lemma. □

Lemma 6.3 (sums of plus runs)**.** *Assume (RV) for the plus sign. There is a constant C such that, for all $r \geq 1$ and real $x > 0$,*

$$\mathbb{E}[S_r; S_r > x] \leq r\Big(\mathbb{E}[X_+; X_+ > x/2] + \frac{2r\mu^2}{x} \Big),$$

and, if in addition $x \geq 4r\mu$,

$$\mathbb{P}(S_r \geq x) \leq C\, rT(x).$$

Proof. If $S_r \geq x$, either some run is at least $x/2$, or the sum of the runs truncated at $x/2$ is at least x. The truncated sum has mean at most $r\mu \leq x/4$ and variance at most $r\,\mathbb{E}[X_+^2; X_+ < x/2] \leq Crx^2T(x)$. By Chebyshev's inequality the second event has probability at most $(4/(3x))^2 Crx^2T(x)$, and the first at most $rT(x/2) \leq CrT(x)$ by Lemma 2.1(ii), since $x \geq 4r\mu \geq 4$. For the other bound, which uses no condition on x, on $\{S_r > x\}$ either $X_i^+ > x/2$ or $S_r - X_i^+ > x/2$. Hence $\mathbb{E}[X_i^+; S_r > x] \leq \mathbb{E}[X_+; X_+ > x/2] + \mu\mathbb{P}(S_r - X_i^+ > x/2)$, and the last probability is at most $2r\mu/x$ by Markov's inequality. Sum over i. □

Proof of Theorem 6.1. We write $u = u_-$, $v = v_-$ and keep the notation of the two lemmas. By (LR), $Nf(N)/T(N) \to \alpha$. We use $v(j) \leq j\,u(j) \leq j$, which holds because $u_r^-(j) = 0$ for $r > j$.

(b) Fix $\eta \in (0,1)$, put $J_N = N^{1-\eta}$ and $x_N = N^{1-\eta/2}$, and let N be so large that $2J_N \leq x_N$, $4J_N\mu \leq N/2$ and $J_N \leq (N/2)^{1-\eta/2}$. Every $o(\cdot)$ below is uniform in $1 \leq r \leq j \leq J_N$. In (2.14) the first sum runs over $1 \leq r \leq j$, since $u_0^-(j) = 0$ for $j \geq 1$, and the second over $1 \leq m \leq j$ and $0 \leq r \leq j-m$.

The final plus run. Split the expectation in the first sum of (2.14) at $S_r = N/2$. For integers $0 \leq x \leq 3N/4$ put

$$\mathcal{T}_N(x) = \frac{N}{T(N)}\big(T(N-x) - T(N)\big) = \frac{N}{T(N)} \sum_{n=N-x}^{N-1} f(n).$$

By (6.6) and $Nf(N)/T(N) \to \alpha$, $\mathcal{T}_N(x) = \alpha x(1+o(1))$ uniformly in $x \leq x_N$, and $\mathcal{T}_N(x) \leq Cx$ for $x \leq 3N/4$, since $f(n) \leq C_{1/4} f(N)$ for $n \geq N/4$. Since $j \leq N/4$,

$$\mathbb{E}\big[T(N-j-S_r); S_r \leq N/2\big] = T(N)\Big(\mathbb{P}(S_r \leq N/2) + \frac{1}{N}\mathbb{E}\big[\mathcal{T}_N(j+S_r); S_r \leq N/2\big]\Big).$$

On $\{S_r \leq x_N/2\}$ we have $j + S_r \leq x_N$. With $\mathbb{E}[j+S_r] = j + r\mu$ this gives

$$\big|\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{T}_N(j+S_r); S_r \leq N/2] - \alpha(j+r\mu)\big| \leq o(j+r) + C\,\mathbb{E}[j+S_r; S_r > x_N/2].$$

By Markov's inequality and Lemma 6.3, $\mathbb{E}[j+S_r; S_r > x_N/2] \leq 2jr\mu/x_N + r\big(\mathbb{E}[X_+; X_+ > x_N/4] + 4r\mu^2/x_N\big) = o(j)$, since $r \leq j \leq J_N = o(x_N)$. By Lemma 6.3 and Lemma 2.1(ii), $\mathbb{P}(S_r > N/2) \leq CrT(N)$. On the other part,

$$\mathbb{E}\big[T(N-j-S_r); N/2 < S_r \leq N-j-1\big] = \sum_{1 \leq l < N/2-j} f^{*r}(N-j-l)\,T(l).$$

Here $N-j-l \geq N/2$ and $r \leq J_N \leq (N-j-l)^{1-\eta/2}$. So Lemma 6.2 with $\eta/2$ in place of η and (6.6) give $f^{*r}(N-j-l) = rf(N)(1+o(1))$ for $l \leq x_N$, since then $j + l = o(N)$, and $f^{*r}(N-j-l) \leq CrT(N)/N$ for all l in the range. Since $\sum_{l \leq x_N} T(l) \to \mu$ and $\sum_{l > x_N} T(l) \to 0$, the sum equals $r\alpha\mu T(N)N^{-1}(1+o(1))$. Together,

$$\mathbb{E}\big[T(N-j-S_r); S_r \leq N-j-1\big] = T(N)\Big(1 - O\big(rT(N)\big) + \frac{\alpha(j+2r\mu)}{N} + o\Big(\frac{j}{N}\Big)\Big).$$

Multiply by $u_r^-(j)$ and sum over r. Since $\sum_r u_r^-(j) = u(j) \leq 1$ and $\sum_r r u_r^-(j) = v(j)$, the first sum of (2.14) divided by $T(N)$ equals

$$u(j) - O\big(v(j)T(N)\big) + \frac{\alpha}{N}\big(j\,u(j) + 2\mu v(j)\big) + o\Big(\frac{j}{N}\Big).$$

Since $v(j)T(N) \leq jT(N) = (j/N)\,NT(N)$ and $NT(N) \to 0$, the second term is $o(j/N)$.

The final minus run. Since $r+1 \le j \le J_N \le (N-J_N)^{1-\eta/2}$, Lemma 6.2 with $\eta/2$ in place of η and (6.6) give $u_{r+1}^{+}(N-j) = f^{*(r+1)}(N-j) = (r+1)\alpha T(N) N^{-1}(1+o(1))$. So the second sum of (2.14) equals

$$\begin{aligned}&\frac{\alpha T(N)}{N}(1+o(1)) \sum_{m=1}^{j} T_-(m) \sum_{r} (r+1) u_r^-(j-m) \\ &\qquad = \frac{\alpha T(N)}{N}(1+o(1)) \sum_{m=1}^{j} T_-(m)\big(u(j-m)+v(j-m)\big),\end{aligned}$$

with $v(0)=0$. By (2.9) and (6.4) the last sum equals $1+\sum_{i=1}^{j-1} u(i) = \sum_{i=0}^{j-1} u(i)$, which is at most j. Adding the two contributions gives $u(j) + C(j)/N + o(j/N)$ with the first form of (6.3), uniformly in $1 \le j \le J_N$. This is (b).

(a) For $j=0$, (2.14) gives $P_N(N) = T(N)$ exactly, and $C(0)=0$. For fixed $j \ge 1$, part (b) gives an error $o(j/N) = o(1/N)$.

The limit. By (2.10) for the minus sign, $u(j) \to 1/\mu_-$. By (6.5) and Cesàro's theorem, $v(j)/j = j^{-1}\sum_{i<j} u(i)u(j-i) \to \mu_-^{-2}$, and $j^{-1}\sum_{i<j} u(i) \to 1/\mu_-$. Hence $C(j)/j \to \alpha_+(2/\mu_- + 2\mu_+/\mu_-^2) = 2\alpha_+ s/\mu_-^2$. □

6.3 The antimode

Two classical facts about the renewal mass function enter. The first is the second-order renewal theorem. Under (RV) and (SPAN) for the minus sign,

$$u_-(j) - \frac{1}{\mu_-} \sim \frac{j\,T_-(j)}{\mu_-^2(\alpha_- - 1)} \qquad (j \to \infty). \tag{6.7}$$

This is Lemma 4 of Frenk [19], stated there for an aperiodic recurrent event whose tail $\mathbb{P}(X > n) \sim T(n)$ is regularly varying with index $-\alpha$, $\alpha > 1$ (see also [38] and [15, Theorem 1]). The second fact gives a simple condition for the hypothesis of the next theorem.

Lemma 6.4 (log-convex run laws)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for the minus sign. If $f_-(n) > 0$ for all $n \ge 1$ and $f_-(n-1)f_-(n+1) > f_-(n)^2$ for all $n \ge 2$, then u_- is strictly decreasing and $u_-(j) > 1/\mu_-$ for every $j \ge 0$.*

Proof. By Theorem 1 of de Bruijn and Erdős [10], the renewal sequence of a strictly log-convex law is strictly log-convex, that is, $u_-(m-1)u_-(m+1) > u_-(m)^2$ for $m \ge 1$. Hence the ratios $u_-(m+1)/u_-(m)$ increase strictly in m. If one of them were at least 1, all later ones would exceed some $q > 1$, and u_- would grow geometrically, which is impossible since $u_- \le 1$. So every ratio is smaller than 1, u_- is strictly decreasing, and it decreases to its limit $1/\mu_-$ given by (2.10). □

Theorem E (the antimode)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for both signs and (LR) for the plus sign, and let the start be fresh with sign $+$. Let j_N^* be a minimizer of $j \mapsto P_N(N-j)$ over $0 \le j \le (1-p)N$.*

(a) If $u_-(j) > 1/\mu_-$ for every $j \ge 1$, then $j_N^* \to \infty$, $j_N^* = o(N)$, and

$$T_-(j_N^*) \sim \frac{2\alpha_+ s}{N}.$$

Moreover $j_N^*/i_N \to 1$ for every choice of minimizers i_N of $j \mapsto u_-(j) + C(j)/N$ over $j \ge 0$. So j_N^* is of the order of $b_{-,N}$, the stable scale of the minus runs, and $j_N^* \asymp N^{1/\alpha_-}$ up to a slowly varying factor.

(b) If $\inf_{j\ge1} u_-(j) < 1/\mu_-$, then j_N^* is bounded and every value that j_N^* takes infinitely often is a minimizer of u_-.

The borderline case, in which $u_- \ge 1/\mu_-$ with equality at some $j \ge 1$, is not covered. By Lemma 6.4 part (a) applies to every strictly log-convex law of the minus runs, for instance the zeta law $f(n) = n^{-\alpha-1}/\zeta(\alpha+1)$.

Proof. Write $R_N(j) = P_N(N-j)/T_+(N)$, $u = u_-$ and $c_{\mathrm{a}} = 2\alpha_+ s/\mu_-^2$. In this proof μ_- and μ_+ are always written with their signs. We first prove two lower bounds on R_N and then treat (a) and (b).

Lower bound in the layer. Let $1 \le j \le N/(8\mu_+)$. In the first sum of (2.14), $T_+(N-j-S_r^+) \ge T_+(N-j)$, and $\mathbb{P}(S_r^+ \le N-j-1) \ge 1 - \mathbb{P}(S_r^+ \ge N/2) \ge 1 - CrT_+(N)$ by Lemma 6.3, since $4r\mu_+ \le N/2$. Dropping the second sum,

$$R_N(j) \ge \frac{T_+(N-j)}{T_+(N)}\big(u(j) - C\,v(j)\,T_+(N)\big) \ge \frac{T_+(N-j)}{T_+(N)}\big(u(j) - C\,j\,T_+(N)\big). \tag{6.8}$$

By (LR), $f_+(n) \ge \frac34\alpha_+ T_+(n)/n \ge \frac34\alpha_+ T_+(N)/N$ for $N/2 \le n \le N$ and large N, because $T_+(n)/n$ is nonincreasing. Hence $T_+(N-j)/T_+(N) \ge 1 + \frac34\alpha_+ j/N$ for $j \le N/2$. We use (6.8) below only for $j \le \delta N$ with $\delta \le 1/(8\mu_+)$ and on ranges where $u(j)$ is bounded below by a positive constant. There $CjT_+(N) \le C\delta N T_+(N) \to 0$, so the second factor is positive for large N. Since the first factor is at least 1, we may then drop it or expand the product.

Lower bound far from the layer. Fix $\delta \in (0, 1-p)$. We claim that

$$\liminf_N \min_{\delta N \le j \le (1-p)N} R_N(j) \ge \frac{(1-\delta)^{-\alpha_+}}{\mu_-}. \tag{6.9}$$

Let $\varepsilon > 0$. By Corollary 4.7 there is K such that $P_N(k) \ge (1-\varepsilon)G_N^{(+)}(k)$ for $pN + KB_N \le k \le N$ and large N. For $k = N-j$ with $j \ge \delta N$ we have $L_k = N - j/(1-p) \le (1-\delta)N$, so $G_N^{(+)}(k) \ge T_+(\lfloor L_k\rfloor)u(j) \ge T_+(\lfloor(1-\delta)N\rfloor)u(j)$, and $T_+(\lfloor(1-\delta)N\rfloor)/T_+(N) \to (1-\delta)^{-\alpha_+}$ by (RV). For $pN \le k < pN + KB_N$, Theorem A(c) and Lemma 2.2(d) give $B_N P_N(k) \ge \frac12 \inf_N \inf_{[-K,K]} h_N > 0$ for large N, so $R_N(N-k) \ge c_K/(B_N T_+(N)) \to \infty$, since $B_N T_+(N) \to 0$ by Lemma 2.1(v). As ε is arbitrary and $u(j) \to 1/\mu_-$, the claim follows.

(b) Let $m_* = \min_j u(j) < 1/\mu_-$, which is attained on a finite set because $u(j) \to 1/\mu_-$, and let $\varepsilon_* = (1/\mu_- - m_*)/3$. Choose J with $u(j) \ge 1/\mu_- - \varepsilon_* > 0$ for $j \ge J$, and let $\delta = \min\{1/(8\mu_+), (1-p)/2\}$. For $J \le j \le \delta N$, (6.8) gives $R_N(j) \ge u(j) - CjT_+(N) \ge 1/\mu_- - \varepsilon_* - C\delta N T_+(N)$, which exceeds $m_* + \varepsilon_*$ for large N, since $NT_+(N) \to 0$. For $j \ge \delta N$, (6.9) gives $R_N(j) \ge m_* + \varepsilon_*$ for large N. For $j < J$, Theorem 6.1(a) gives $R_N(j) \to u(j)$. So for large N every minimizer is smaller than J, and a value j' taken infinitely often with $u(j') > m_*$ would give $R_N(j') > R_N(j_0)$ for large N, where $u(j_0) = m_*$.

(a) Let $\Lambda_N = a_-(N)$, so that $NT_-(\Lambda_N) \to 1$ and $\Lambda_N \in \mathrm{RV}_{1/\alpha_-}$. Put $w(j) = u(j) - 1/\mu_-$ and $c_{\mathrm{r}} = 1/(\mu_-^2(\alpha_- - 1))$, so $w(j) \sim c_{\mathrm{r}} j T_-(j)$ by (6.7), and $w(j) > 0$ for $j \ge 1$. Let

$$\Upsilon(x) = c_{\mathrm{r}} x^{1-\alpha_-} + c_{\mathrm{a}} x, \qquad x > 0.$$

The function Υ is strictly convex with a unique minimizer x_*, given by $c_{\mathrm{r}}(\alpha_- - 1)x_*^{-\alpha_-} = c_{\mathrm{a}}$, that is, $x_*^{-\alpha_-} = c_{\mathrm{a}}\mu_-^2 = 2\alpha_+ s$.

We fix the constants first. They depend only on c_{r}, c_{a}, $\alpha_\pm$ and $\mu_\pm$. Choose $\varepsilon \in (0, x_*)$ so small that $\frac{c_{\mathrm{r}}}{5}\varepsilon^{-(\alpha_- - 1)/2} > \Upsilon(x_*) + 2$, and choose $K > x_*$ so large that $\alpha_+ K/(2\mu_-) > \Upsilon(x_*) + 1$. So $\varepsilon < x_* < K$.

Step 1 (the window). By (6.7) and Lemma 2.1(i), $(N/\Lambda_N)\,w(j) = c_{\mathrm{r}}(j/\Lambda_N)^{1-\alpha_-}(1+o(1))$ uniformly in $\varepsilon\Lambda_N \le j \le K\Lambda_N$, because $NT_-(j) = NT_-(\Lambda_N)\cdot T_-(j)/T_-(\Lambda_N)$. By Theorem 6.1, $C(j) = c_{\mathrm{a}}j(1+o(1))$ as $j\to\infty$. Choose $\eta>0$ with $1-\eta > 1/\alpha_-$, so that $K\Lambda_N \le N^{1-\eta}$ for large N. Theorem 6.1(b) then gives

$$\frac{N}{\Lambda_N}\Big(R_N(j)-\frac{1}{\mu_-}\Big) = \Upsilon\Big(\frac{j}{\Lambda_N}\Big)+o(1) \quad\text{and}\quad \frac{N}{\Lambda_N}\Big(u(j)+\frac{C(j)}{N}-\frac{1}{\mu_-}\Big) = \Upsilon\Big(\frac{j}{\Lambda_N}\Big)+o(1), \tag{6.10}$$

uniformly in $\varepsilon\Lambda_N \le j \le K\Lambda_N$. Since $\varepsilon < x_* < K$, in particular the minimum of R_N is at most $1/\mu_- + (\Lambda_N/N)(\Upsilon(x_*)+o(1))$.

Step 2 (small j). We have $R_N(0)=1$, and $u(0)+C(0)/N = 1$ for the comparison function. Since $\mu_->1$ and $\Lambda_N/N\to 0$, both exceed $1/\mu_- + (\Lambda_N/N)(\Upsilon(x_*)+1)$ for large N. Let $1\le j\le \varepsilon\Lambda_N$. Then $u(j) > 1/\mu_-$, and (6.8) gives $R_N(j) \ge u(j) - C\varepsilon\Lambda_N T_+(N) = 1/\mu_- + w(j) - o(\Lambda_N/N)$. Choose j_0 with $w(j) \ge \frac{c_{\mathrm{r}}}{2} jT_-(j)$ for $j\ge j_0$. By Lemma 2.1(ii) applied to $jT_-(j)\in \mathrm{RV}_{1-\alpha_-}$, for $j_0\le j\le \varepsilon\Lambda_N$ and j_0 large,

$$\frac{jT_-(j)}{\Lambda_N T_-(\Lambda_N)} \ge \frac{1}{2}\Big(\frac{j}{\Lambda_N}\Big)^{-(\alpha_- -1)/2} \ge \frac{1}{2}\varepsilon^{-(\alpha_- -1)/2}.$$

Since $\Lambda_N T_-(\Lambda_N)\sim \Lambda_N/N$, we get $w(j)\ge \frac{c_{\mathrm{r}}}{5}\varepsilon^{-(\alpha_- -1)/2}\Lambda_N/N$ for large N. For $1\le j<j_0$, $w(j)\ge \min_{i<j_0} w(i) > 0$, which is much larger than Λ_N/N. By the choice of ε, $R_N(j) > 1/\mu_- + (\Lambda_N/N)(\Upsilon(x_*)+1)$ for $1\le j\le\varepsilon\Lambda_N$ and large N. The same bound holds for $u(j)+C(j)/N \ge 1/\mu_- + w(j)$.

Step 3 (intermediate j). Let $\delta = \min\{1/(8\mu_+),(1-p)/2\}$ and $K\Lambda_N \le j\le \delta N$. By (6.8) and $u(j)>1/\mu_-$,

$$R_N(j) \ge \Big(1+\frac{3\alpha_+ j}{4N}\Big)\Big(\frac{1}{\mu_-} - CjT_+(N)\Big) \ge \frac{1}{\mu_-} + \frac{\alpha_+ j}{2\mu_- N} \ge \frac{1}{\mu_-} + \frac{\alpha_+ K}{2\mu_-}\cdot\frac{\Lambda_N}{N}$$

for large N, since $NT_+(N)\to 0$. By the choice of K this exceeds $1/\mu_- + (\Lambda_N/N)(\Upsilon(x_*)+1)$. For the comparison function, $C(j)\ge \alpha_+ j\,u(j) \ge \alpha_+ j/\mu_-$, so $u(j)+C(j)/N \ge 1/\mu_- + \alpha_+ j/(\mu_- N)$ for every j, and the same bound holds for all $j\ge K\Lambda_N$.

Step 4 (large j). By (6.9), $R_N(j)\ge (1+\varepsilon_\delta)/\mu_-$ for $\delta N\le j\le (1-p)N$ and large N, with $\varepsilon_\delta = ((1-\delta)^{-\alpha_+}-1)/2 > 0$, while $\Lambda_N/N\to 0$.

Conclusion. By Steps 2 to 4 every minimizer of R_N, and every minimizer of $u(j)+C(j)/N$, lies in $[\varepsilon\Lambda_N, K\Lambda_N]$ for large N. Fix $\eta'>0$. Since Υ is continuous with a unique minimizer, $\Upsilon \ge \Upsilon(x_*)+\varepsilon'$ on $[\varepsilon,K]\setminus(x_*-\eta', x_*+\eta')$ for some $\varepsilon'>0$, and (6.10) shows that both minimizers lie in $((x_*-\eta')\Lambda_N, (x_*+\eta')\Lambda_N)$ for large N. Hence $j_N^*/\Lambda_N \to x_*$ and $i_N/\Lambda_N\to x_*$, so $j_N^*/i_N\to 1$. By (RV), $NT_-(j_N^*) = NT_-(\Lambda_N)\cdot T_-(j_N^*)/T_-(\Lambda_N) \to x_*^{-\alpha_-} = 2\alpha_+ s$. Finally $\Lambda_N = a_-(N)$ and $b_{-,N} = a_-(N/s)$ differ by a bounded factor, and $a_-\in \mathrm{RV}_{1/\alpha_-}$. □

The leading law $T_-(j_N^*)\sim 2\alpha_+ s/N$ is approached slowly, because $C(j)/j$ converges slowly, and the minimizer of $u_-(j)+C(j)/N$ is the better prediction at moderate N, as Table 1 shows.

6.4 Local extrema near the ends

Theorems D and E compare values of P_N in different zones. Here we compare neighbouring values. A *local maximum* of a finite or infinite sequence (y_i) is a maximal block $\{a,\dots,b\}$ of consecutive indices on which y is constant, such that $y_{a-1} < y_a$ unless a is the first index and $y_{b+1} < y_b$ unless b is the last. Local minima are defined in the same way, and a *mode* of P_N is a local maximum. So an endpoint is a mode when it beats its neighbour, and a plateau counts once.

N	observed j_N^*	refined i_N	leading	$NT_-(j_N^*)/(2\alpha_+ s)$
600	7	7	10	1.534
1200	11	12	15	1.498
2400	19	20	23	1.282
4000	27	28	32	1.247
8000	44	45	50	1.186

Table 1: The antimode for the zeta law $f_\sigma(n) = n^{-5/2}/\zeta(5/2)$ and a fresh plus start. The observed j_N^* minimizes $P_N(N-j)$ over $0 \le j \le N/2$. The refined i_N minimizes $u_-(j) + C(j)/N$, and the leading prediction is the smallest j with $T_-(j) < 2\alpha_+ s/N$.

Let the initial run satisfy $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$, and let $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(0) = \lim_N Q_+(N)/T_+(N)$ exist. The *end profile* is $\widetilde{\kappa}_+ = (\widetilde{\kappa}_+(0), \kappa_+(1), \kappa_+(2), \dots)$, with κ_+ as in (5.2). By Proposition 2.4 and Theorem C(d), under (RV) for the plus sign,

$$P_N(N-j)/T_+(N) \to \widetilde{\kappa}_+(j) \qquad \text{for every fixed } j \ge 0. \tag{6.11}$$

For a fresh plus start, a fresh minus start and the fair start, which is fresh with each sign with probability $\frac{1}{2}$, the profile is $(1, u_-(1), u_-(2), \dots)$, $(0, u_-(1), \dots)$ and $(\frac{1}{2}, u_-(1), \dots)$. The profile $\widetilde{\kappa}_-$ at the minus end is defined with the signs exchanged. We write $D_N(j) = P_N(N-j-1) - P_N(N-j)$ and $\Delta y(j) = y(j+1) - y(j)$.

Lemma 6.5 (difference renewal theorem)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for the minus sign, and put $d_n = u_-(n) - u_-(n-1)$ for $n \ge 0$, with $u_-(-1) = 0$. Then $\sum_n |d_n| < \infty$ and $d_n = -(1+o(1))T_-(n)/\mu_-^2$. In particular u_- is eventually strictly decreasing.*

Summing over $n > j$ and using Lemma 2.1(iv) gives back (6.7), so the lemma is a local form of Frenk's theorem. It also shows that if u_- is nonincreasing on $j \ge 1$, then $u_-(j) > 1/\mu_-$ for every $j \ge 1$, so Theorem E(a) applies, and the borderline case after Theorem E has a nonmonotone u_-.

Proof. Write $u = u_-$, $\mu = \mu_-$, $t_n = T_-(n+1)$ for $n \ge 0$, and $\hat{a}(z) = \sum_n a_n z^n$. Since $t_0 = 1$ and $t_{n-1} - t_n = f_-(n)$, we have $(1-z)\hat{t} = 1 - \hat{f}_-$, and $\hat{u} = 1/(1-\hat{f}_-)$, so $\hat{d} = (1-z)\hat{u} = 1/\hat{t}$. On $|z| \le 1$ the function $\hat{t}$ has no zero. At $z = 1$ it equals μ, and elsewhere a zero would give $\hat{f}_-(z) = 1$, which (SPAN) excludes. By Wiener's lemma [48] the function $1/\hat{t}$ on the unit circle has absolutely summable Fourier coefficients. They vanish at negative indices since $1/\hat{t}$ is continuous on the closed disk and analytic inside. So they are the d_n, and $d \in \ell^1$.

For sequences on $\mathbb{Z}_{\ge 0}$ put $\|a\|_1 = \sum_n |a_n|$ and $\|a\|_t = \sup_n |a_n|/t_n$. The sequence t is positive, nonincreasing and regularly varying, so $c_t = \sup_n t_{\lfloor n/2 \rfloor}/t_n < \infty$. Splitting a convolution at $n/2$ gives

$$\|a * b\|_t \le c_t\big(\|a\|_1 \|b\|_t + \|a\|_t \|b\|_1\big), \tag{6.12}$$

and the following product rule. If $a, b \in \ell^1$, $a_n/t_n \to \chi_a$ and $b_n/t_n \to \chi_b$, then

$$(a * b)_n/t_n \to \hat{a}(1)\chi_b + \hat{b}(1)\chi_a. \tag{6.13}$$

Indeed, in $\sum_{k \le n/2} a_k b_{n-k}/t_n$ each term tends to $a_k \chi_b$, since $t_{n-k}/t_n \to 1$, and the terms are dominated by $c_t \|b\|_t |a_k|$. The other half is the same.

Split $t = t' + t''$ with $t'_n = t_n \mathbf{1}_{\{n \le M\}}$, and take M so large that $2c_t \|d\|_1 \|t''\|_1 \le \frac{1}{4}$. Then $1 - \hat{t}''\hat{d}$ has the inverse $\sum_{k \ge 0} (\hat{t}''\hat{d})^k$ with summable coefficients, and $\hat{t}' = \hat{t}(1 - \hat{t}''\hat{d})$ has no zero on $|z| \le 1$. So the coefficients e of $1/\hat{t}' = \hat{d} \sum_k (\hat{t}''\hat{d})^k$ satisfy $\|e\|_1 \le 2\|d\|_1$. As $\hat{t}'$ is a polynomial without zeros in the closed disk, e_n decays geometrically, and

$e_n = o(t_n)$. Put $g = e * t''$. Since $t''_n = t_n$ for $n > M$, (6.13) gives $g_n/t_n \to \hat{e}(1)$, and $c_t\|g\|_1 \le \frac{1}{4}$. By (6.12), $x_k = \|g^{*k}\|_t$ satisfies $x_k \le \frac{1}{4}x_{k-1} + c_t\|g\|_t 4^{1-k}$, so $x_k \le Ck4^{-k}$. By induction with (6.13), $(g^{*k})_n/t_n \to k\hat{g}(1)^{k-1}\hat{e}(1)$. By dominated convergence over k, $h = \sum_{k\ge1}(-g)^{*k}$ satisfies $h_n/t_n \to -\hat{e}(1)/(1+\hat{g}(1))^2$. Finally $\hat{t} = \hat{t}'(1+\hat{g})$ gives $\hat{d} = \hat{e}(1+\hat{h})$, so $d = e + e*h$ and $d_n/t_n \to -\hat{e}(1)^2/(1+\hat{g}(1))^2$. Here $\hat{e}(1) = 1/\hat{t}'(1)$ and $1+\hat{g}(1) = (\hat{t}'(1)+\hat{t}''(1))/\hat{t}'(1) = \mu/\hat{t}'(1)$, so the limit is $-1/\mu^2$. Since $t_n \sim T_-(n)$, the lemma follows. □

Lemma 6.6 (the prepared profile)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for the minus sign, and let $\nu_-(d) = (c+o(1))T_-(d)$ for some $c \ge 0$. Then $\kappa_+(j) - \kappa_+(j-1) = \big((c\mu_- - 1)/\mu_-^2 + o(1)\big)T_-(j)$.*

Proof. The generating function of κ_+ is $\pi_+(\hat{u}_- - 1) + \hat{\nu}_-\hat{u}_-$, so $\kappa_+(n) - \kappa_+(n-1) = \pi_+ d_n + (\nu_- * d)_n$ for $n \ge 2$. Apply (6.13) with $a = \nu_-$, $\hat{a}(1) = \pi_-$, $\chi_a = c$, and $b = d$, $\hat{b}(1) = \lim_n u_-(n) = 1/\mu_-$, $\chi_b = -1/\mu_-^2$, and add $\pi_+ d_n$. □

So κ_+ is eventually strictly decreasing when $c < 1/\mu_-$, for instance when $\nu_- = o(T_-)$ or for the stationary initial run ($c = 1/s$), and eventually strictly increasing when $c > 1/\mu_-$. If $\nu_- = T_-/\mu_-$ exactly, then $\kappa_+ \equiv 1/\mu_-$ on $j \ge 1$ by (2.9).

Proposition 6.7 (copies of the profile)**.** *Assume (RV) for the plus sign, let $\nu_+(n) = o(T_+(n))$, and let $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(0)$ exist.*

(a) If $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(j+1) \ne \widetilde{\kappa}_+(j)$ for $0 \le j < J$, then for large N the sign of $D_N(j)$ is that of $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(j+1) - \widetilde{\kappa}_+(j)$ for every $0 \le j < J$.

(b) For every local maximum $\{a,\dots,b\}$ of $\widetilde{\kappa}_+$ and all large N, P_N has a local maximum inside $\{N-b,\dots,N-a\}$. The same holds for local minima.

Proof. (a) follows from (6.11), since $D_N(j) = T_+(N)(\Delta R_N)(j)$ with $R_N(j) = P_N(N-j)/T_+(N)$. For (b), let $\widetilde{\kappa}_+ = y$ on $\{a,\dots,b\}$, and let 3ε be the gap between y and the larger of $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(a-1)$ (absent if $a = 0$) and $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(b+1)$. For large N, (6.11) puts $R_N(i)$ within ε of $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(i)$ for $a-1 \le i \le b+1$. So the largest value of P_N on $\{N-b,\dots,N-a\}$ exceeds its values at $N-b-1$ and $N-a+1$, and the maximal block on which P_N takes this value and that meets an argmax lies inside $\{N-b,\dots,N-a\}$. It is a local maximum of P_N. Minima are the same. □

Theorem 6.8 (a lower bound for the number of modes)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for both signs, let $\nu_\sigma(n) = o(T_\sigma(n))$ for both signs, and let $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(0)$ and $\widetilde{\kappa}_-(0)$ exist. Then $\widetilde{\kappa}_+$ has finitely many local maxima, $M_+ \ge 1$ of them, and $\widetilde{\kappa}_-$ has $M_- \ge 1$. For all large N the law P_N has at least $M_+ + M_- + 1$ modes. In particular, if one end profile has two local maxima, then P_N has at least four modes for all large N.*

Proof. By Lemma 6.6 with $c = 0$, $\widetilde{\kappa}_+$ is strictly decreasing on some $[J,\infty)$, with the positive limit $1/\mu_-$. So its local maxima lie in $[0,J]$, and there is at least one, the block of a global maximizer. By Proposition 6.7(b) each of them gives a mode of P_N in $\{N-J,\dots,N\}$, and distinct local maxima give modes in disjoint blocks. The same holds at the minus end. The initial run satisfies the bulk criterion, since $B_n T_\sigma(n) \to 0$. By Theorem D(a) the interior maximizers lie in $pN + O(B_N)$, and the block of interior maximizers that contains one of them is a mode of P_N at distance of order N from both ends. □

For a fresh plus start $\widetilde{\kappa}_+ = (1, u_-(1), \dots)$ has exactly one local maximum if and only if u_- is nonincreasing on $j \ge 1$, by Lemma 6.5. The preparation can add a mode, already for a log-convex law.

Corollary 6.9 (a prepared start with four modes)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for both signs, and let f_- be strictly log-convex as in Lemma 6.4. Let the initial run be a fresh plus run with probability $\frac{1}{2}$ and a minus run of a fixed length $d_0 \geq 2$ with probability $\frac{1}{2}$. Then P_N has at least four modes for all large N, while for a fresh plus start $\widetilde{\kappa}_+$ is strictly decreasing.*

Proof. Here $\nu_+ = f_+/2 = o(T_+)$, ν_- is a point mass, $Q_+(N) = T_+(N)/2$ and $Q_-(N) = 0$ for $N > d_0$. So $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(0) = \frac{1}{2}$ and, by (5.2), $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(j) = \frac{1}{2}(u_-(j) + u_-(j - d_0))$ for $j \geq 1$, with $u_- = 0$ at negative arguments. Since $u_-(1) = f_-(1) < 1$, $\{0\}$ is a local maximum. By Lemma 6.4, $u_-(d_0) > 1/\mu_-$, so $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(d_0) = \frac{1}{2}(1 + u_-(d_0))$ exceeds both $\widetilde{\kappa}_+(1) = \frac{1}{2}u_-(1)$ and $1/\mu_- = \lim_j \widetilde{\kappa}_+(j)$. So the largest value of $\widetilde{\kappa}_+$ on $j \geq 1$ is attained, and only at points $j \geq 2$, and its block is a second local maximum. Theorem 6.8 gives at least $2 + 1 + 1$ modes. For a fresh plus start Lemma 6.4 makes $(1, u_-(1), \dots)$ strictly decreasing. □

To go further we need differences of the law itself. Theorem 6.1(b) gives $R_N(j) = u_-(j) + C(j)/N + o(j/N)$, but near $j \asymp b_{-,N}$ both $N\Delta u_-(j)$ and $\Delta C(j)$ are of order one, so the error $o(j/N)$ says nothing about ΔR_N. We take the difference inside the exact identities, and (LD) controls the one term that is a genuine difference of a convolution power.

Lemma 6.10 (plus runs at the level of differences)**.** *Assume (RV), (LR) and (LD) for the plus sign. Write $f = f_+$, $T = T_+$, $\mu = \mu_+$, $V_m = f^{*m}$ with $V_0 = \delta_0$, $\delta V_m = V_{m+1} - V_m$ and $q_m = q_m^+$, and fix $\eta \in (0, 1)$. As $n \to \infty$, uniformly in $0 \leq m \leq n^{1-\eta}$, the following hold.*

(i) $q_{m+1}(n) \leq CT(n)$.

(ii) $|V_m(n-1) - V_m(n)| \leq Cmf(n)/n$.

(iii) $\delta V_m(n) = f(n)(1 + o(1))$.

(iv) $q_{m+2}(n) - q_{m+1}(n) = 2\mu f(n)(1 + o(1))$.

Proof. We use Lemma 6.2 at arguments of order n, with $\eta/2$ in place of η, and (6.6). So $V_m(x) \leq Cmf(n)$ for $m \geq 1$ and $x \geq n/2$, and $mT(n) \to 0$, $mf(n) \leq C/n$ uniformly. Below we also apply (ii) and (iii) at arguments $n' \geq n/2$. For large n we have $n^{1-\eta} \leq (n/2)^{1-\eta/2} \leq (n')^{1-\eta/2}$, so there we use them with $\eta/2$ in place of η.

(i) In $q_{m+1}(n) = \sum_{x<n} V_m(x)T(n-x)$ the part $x \leq n/2$ is at most $T(n/2) \leq CT(n)$, and the part $x > n/2$ is at most $Cmf(n)\mu \leq CT(n)$.

(ii) Let $m \geq 1$, fix K_0 with $(K_0/4 - 1)(\alpha_+ - 1)/2 > \alpha_+ + 3$, and put $w = \lceil n/K_0 \rceil$. On the event that no summand reaches w, Lemma 4.2 with $z = n/2 - 1$ bounds $\mathbb{P}(S_m^+ = n')$ for $n' \in \{n-1, n\}$ by $C(mT(w))^{K_0/4-1} \leq Cn^{-\alpha_+-3} = o(f(n)/n)$, since $mT(w) \leq Cn^{-(\alpha_+-1)/2}$ by Lemma 2.1(ii). Otherwise let I be the first index with $X_I^+ \geq w$, and let $h_i(z)$ be the probability that $X_l^+ < w$ for $l < i$ and that the sum of the X_l^+ with $l \neq i$ equals z. Then $\mathbb{P}(S_m^+ = n', I = i) = \sum_{y \geq w} f(y)h_i(n' - y)$, and the difference at $n - 1$ and n is

$$\sum_{z \leq n-1-w} h_i(z)\big[f(n-1-z) - f(n-z)\big] - h_i(n-w)f(w).$$

In the first sum $n - 1 - z \geq n/K_0$, so (LD) and (6.6) bound the bracket by $Cf(n)/n$, and $\sum_z h_i(z) \leq 1$. In the second term $h_i(n-w) \leq V_{m-1}(n-w) \leq Cmf(n)$, and $mf(n)f(w) \leq Cf(n)/n$. Summing over $i \leq m$ gives (ii).

(iii) For $m = 0$ this is $\delta V_0(n) = f(n)$. Let $m \geq 1$. Then $\delta V_m(n) = \sum_{x \geq 1} f(x)[V_m(n-x) - V_m(n)]$. For $x \leq n/2$, (ii) at the arguments $n - x, \dots, n$ bounds the bracket by $Cmxf(n)/n$, so this part is at most $C\mu mf(n)/n = o(f(n))$. The part $x > n/2$ equals $\sum_{1 \leq y < n/2} f(n - y)V_m(y) - V_m(n)\sum_{x > n/2} f(x)$. The second term is at most $Cmf(n)T(n/2) = o(f(n))$.

In the first, $f(n-y)/f(n)$ is bounded and tends to one uniformly in $y \le \varepsilon n$, while $\mathbb{P}(S_m^+ < n/2) \to 1$ and $\mathbb{P}(S_m^+ > \varepsilon n) \le m\mu/(\varepsilon n) \to 0$. So it is $f(n)(1+o(1))$.

(iv) Putting one more run in front gives $q_{m+2}(n) = \sum_{x\ge 1} f(x) q_{m+1}(n-x)$, with $q_{m+1} = 0$ at nonpositive arguments. Comparing the events in (2.7) gives $q_{m+1}(l-1) - q_{m+1}(l) = \delta V_m(l-1)$ for $l \ge 1$. So $q_{m+2}(n) - q_{m+1}(n) = \sum_x f(x)[q_{m+1}(n-x) - q_{m+1}(n)]$. For $x \le n/2$ the bracket is $\sum_{i=1}^{x} \delta V_m(n-i)$, which is at most $Cxf(n)$ and is $xf(n)(1+o(1))$ for fixed x, by (iii). Since $\sum_x x f(x) = \mu$, this part is $\mu f(n)(1+o(1))$. The part $x > n/2$ equals $\sum_{1\le y<n/2} f(n-y) q_{m+1}(y) - q_{m+1}(n) \sum_{x>n/2} f(x)$. The second term is $O(T(n)^2) = o(f(n))$ by (i). In the first, $\sum_y q_{m+1}(y) = \mathbb{E}X_{m+1}^+ = \mu$, and $\sum_{y\ge \varepsilon n} q_{m+1}(y) \le \mathbb{E}[X_+; X_+ \ge \varepsilon n/2] + \mu \mathbb{P}(S_m^+ \ge \varepsilon n/2) \to 0$. So it is $\mu f(n)(1+o(1))$. □

Theorem 6.11 (first differences in the layer)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for the minus sign and (LR) and (LD) for the plus sign, and fix $\eta \in (0,1)$. Let the start be fresh, with sign $+$ with probability w_+ and sign $-$ with probability $w_- = 1 - w_+$. Put $R_N(j) = P_N(N-j)/T_+(N)$ and $C_w(j) = C(j) - 2\alpha_+\mu_+ w_- u_-(j)$, with C as in* (6.3)*. Then, uniformly in $1 \le j \le N^{1-\eta}$,*

$$N\,\Delta R_N(j) = N\,\Delta u_-(j) + \Delta C_w(j) + o(1),$$

and $\Delta C_w(j) \to c_{\mathrm{a}} = 2\alpha_+ s/\mu_-^2$ as $j \to \infty$.

Proof. By linearity it suffices to treat the two fresh starts. Write $u = u_-$, $v = v_-$, $a_m = u_m^-$, $V_m = u_m^+$ and $n = N - j$. By Proposition 2.3 and its minus form, $P_N(N-j) = \sum_{m\ge 1}[a_m(j) Q_m(n) + V_m(n) b_m(j)]$, with $Q_m = q_{m+1}^+$ and $b_m = q_m^-$ for a plus start, and $Q_m = q_m^+$ and $b_m = q_{m+1}^-$ for a minus start. Taking the difference, $D_N(j) = \mathrm{I} + \mathrm{II} + \mathrm{III} + \mathrm{IV}$ with

$$\mathrm{I} = \sum_m \Delta a_m(j)\, Q_m(n-1), \qquad \mathrm{II} = \sum_m a_m(j) \big[Q_m(n-1) - Q_m(n)\big],$$
$$\mathrm{III} = \sum_m V_m(n-1)\, \Delta b_m(j), \qquad \mathrm{IV} = \sum_m \big[V_m(n-1) - V_m(n)\big] b_m(j).$$

Only $m \le j+1$ occurs, by (K2), so Lemma 6.10 applies at $n-1 \ge N/2$ with $\eta/2$ in place of η. We use six facts on the minus side.

(1) $\sum_m a_m(j) = u(j)$ and $\sum_m m a_m(j) = v(j)$.

(2) The sum $\bar{A}_i(j) = \sum_{m>i} a_m(j)$ equals $\sum_{x<j} u_i^-(x) u(j-x)$. Hence

$$\Delta \bar{A}_i(j) = \sum_{x<j} u_i^-(x)\, d_{j+1-x} + u_i^-(j)\, u(1),$$

and $\sum_{i\ge 1} |\Delta \bar{A}_i(j)| \le 1 + \|d\|_1$, which is finite by Lemma 6.5.

(3) $(j+1)|\Delta u(j)| \le C$, by Lemma 6.5 and $jT_-(j) \to 0$.

(4) By (6.5), $v + u = u * u$, so $\Delta(v+u)(j) = \sum_{i\le j+1} d_i u(j+1-i)$ is the coefficient of z^{j+1} in $\hat{u}\hat{d}$, and $|\Delta v(j)| \le 1 + \|d\|_1$.

(5) $\bar{B}_i(j) = \sum_{m\ge i} b_m(j)$ equals $\mathbb{P}(S_i^- < j)$ for a plus start and $\mathbb{P}(S_{i+1}^- < j)$ for a minus start. So $\Delta \bar{B}_i(j)$ is $u_i^-(j)$, respectively $u_{i+1}^-(j)$, and $\sum_m \Delta b_m(j)$ is 0, respectively $f_-(j)$.

(6) $\sum_m m b_m(j) \le j$, since the index of the run that covers level j is at most j.

By Lemma 6.10 and (6.6), every $\delta V_i(n-1)$ below is $f_+(N)(1+o(1))$ and every $Q_{i+1}(n-1)-Q_i(n-1)$ is $2\mu_+ f_+(N)(1+o(1))$, uniformly in $i \le j+1$. Also $T_+(N-j-1) = T_+(N)+(j+1)f_+(N)(1+o(1))$.

II. Here $Q_m(n-1)-Q_m(n)$ is $\delta V_m(n-1)$, respectively $\delta V_{m-1}(n-1)$, so $\mathrm{II} = f_+(N)u(j)+o(f_+(N))$ by (1).

III. Write $V_m = V_1 + \sum_{i<m}\delta V_i$ and sum by parts. For a plus start $\mathrm{III} = \sum_{i\ge1}\delta V_i(n-1)u_i^-(j) = f_+(N)u(j)+o(f_+(N))$ by (5). For a minus start $\mathrm{III} = V_1(n-1)f_-(j) + \sum_{i\ge1}\delta V_i(n-1)u_{i+1}^-(j) = f_+(N)[f_-(j)+u(j)-u_1^-(j)]+o(f_+(N))$, which is the same since $u_1^- = f_-$.

IV. By Lemma 6.10(ii) and (6), $|\mathrm{IV}| \le C f_+(N) j/N = o(f_+(N))$.

I. Write $Q_m = Q_1 + \sum_{i<m}(Q_{i+1}-Q_i)$ and sum by parts. Then $\mathrm{I} = Q_1(n-1)\Delta u(j) + \sum_{i\ge1}(Q_{i+1}-Q_i)(n-1)\,\Delta\bar A_i(j)$. Since $\sum_{i\ge1}\bar A_i(j) = \sum_m (m-1)a_m(j) = v(j)-u(j)$, fact (2) makes the sum $2\mu_+ f_+(N)(\Delta v-\Delta u)(j)+o(f_+(N))$. For a plus start $Q_1(n-1) = q_2^+(N-j-1) = T_+(N)+(j+1+2\mu_+)f_+(N)+o((j+1)f_+(N))$ by Lemma 6.10(iv) with $m=0$, and for a minus start $Q_1(n-1) = T_+(N-j-1) = T_+(N)+(j+1)f_+(N)+o((j+1)f_+(N))$. By (3) the errors times $\Delta u(j)$ are $o(f_+(N))$.

Adding the four parts,

$$D_N(j) = T_+(N)\Delta u(j) + f_+(N)\big[(j+1)\Delta u + 2\mu_+\Delta v + 2u - 2\mu_+ w_-\Delta u\big](j) + o(f_+(N)),$$

with $w_- = 0$ for a plus start and $w_- = 1$ for a minus start. The bracket is bounded by (3) and (4), and $N f_+(N)/T_+(N) \to \alpha_+$ by (LR). Since $\Delta C(j) = \alpha_+[(j+1)\Delta u + 2\mu_+\Delta v + 2u](j)$ by (6.3), multiplying by $N/T_+(N)$ gives the claim. For the limit, $(j+1)\Delta u(j)\to 0$, $u(j)\to 1/\mu_-$, and $\Delta(v+u)(j)\to \hat d(1)/\mu_- = 1/\mu_-^2$ by (4) and dominated convergence, so $\Delta C_w(j)\to \alpha_+(2\mu_+/\mu_-^2 + 2/\mu_-) = c_{\mathrm a}$. □

Theorem 6.12 (the extrema up to distance $N^{1-\eta}$)**.** *Assume (RV), (SPAN), (LR) and (LD) for both signs, and let the start be fresh with either sign or the fair start. Let $J_+ \ge 1$ be such that u_- is strictly decreasing on $[J_+,\infty)$, and assume $\widetilde\kappa_+(j+1) \ne \widetilde\kappa_+(j)$ for $0 \le j < J_+$. Put $\Lambda_N = a_-(N)$ and $x_* = (2\alpha_+ s)^{-1/\alpha_-}$, and fix $\eta \in (0, 1-1/\alpha_*)$ and $\eta' \in (0, x_*)$. For all large N the following hold.*

- *(a) $D_N(j)$ has the sign of $\widetilde\kappa_+(j+1)-\widetilde\kappa_+(j)$ for $0 \le j < J_+$.*
- *(b) $D_N(j) < 0$ for $J_+ \le j \le (x_*-\eta')\Lambda_N$.*
- *(c) $D_N(j) > 0$ for $(x_*+\eta')\Lambda_N \le j \le N^{1-\eta}$.*
- *(d) On $(x_*-\eta')\Lambda_N < j < (x_*+\eta')\Lambda_N$ the sign of $D_N(j)$ changes an odd number of times, after the zeros of D_N are deleted.*

The closed window $[(x_*-\eta')\Lambda_N, (x_*+\eta')\Lambda_N]$ contains every minimizer of $P_N(N-j)$ over $J_+ \le j \le N^{1-\eta}$. For a fresh plus start with $u_-(j) > 1/\mu_-$ for all $j \ge 1$ it contains the minimizer j_N^* of Theorem E. The same holds at the minus end with the signs exchanged.

Proof. (a) and (b) on $J_+ \le j < J'$, for any fixed J', follow from Proposition 6.7(a), since $\widetilde\kappa_+ = u_-$ on $j \ge 1$ for these starts. By Theorem 6.11 and Lemma 6.5,

$$\frac{N\,D_N(j)}{T_+(N)} = -\frac{NT_-(j+2)}{\mu_-^2}(1+\epsilon_j) + \Delta C_w(j) + o(1)$$

uniformly in $1 \le j \le N^{1-\eta}$, with $\epsilon_j \to 0$ as $j\to\infty$. Here $NT_-(x\Lambda_N)\to x^{-\alpha_-}$ for $x>0$, and $x_*^{-\alpha_-} = c_{\mathrm a}\mu_-^2$. For (b) on $J' \le j \le (x_*-\eta')\Lambda_N$, the first term is at most $-(1-\epsilon)((x_*-\eta')^{-\alpha_-}+o(1))/\mu_-^2$ and $\Delta C_w(j) \le c_{\mathrm a}+\epsilon$ once J' is large, so the right side is negative for ϵ small. For (c), the first term is at least $-(1+\epsilon)((x_*+\eta')^{-\alpha_-}+o(1))/\mu_-^2$

and $\Delta C_w(j) \geq c_a - \epsilon$, so it is positive. The range of (c) is not empty, since $\Lambda_N \in \mathrm{RV}_{1/\alpha_-}$ and $1/\alpha_- \leq 1/\alpha_* < 1 - \eta$.

For (d) and the minimizers, (b) and (c) at η' are not enough, since they leave $D_N(j)$ open for the integers j in the open window nearest to its ends. We apply them with $\eta'/2$ in place of η'. Put $L = (x_* - \eta')\Lambda_N$ and $U = (x_* + \eta')\Lambda_N$, and let $j_L = \lfloor L \rfloor + 1$ and $j_U = \lceil U \rceil - 1$ be the first and last integers in (L, U). Since $\eta'\Lambda_N/2 \to \infty$, for large N we have $j_L + 1 \leq (x_* - \eta'/2)\Lambda_N$ and $j_U - 1 \geq (x_* + \eta'/2)\Lambda_N$. So $D_N(j_L) < 0$ and $D_N(j_U) > 0$, and the sign of D_N changes an odd number of times on $[j_L, j_U]$, which is (d). Write $g(j) = P_N(N - j)$, so $D_N(j) = g(j + 1) - g(j)$. By (b) at $\eta'/2$, g decreases strictly on $J_+ \leq j \leq j_L + 1$, so no minimizer is below $j_L + 1$. By (c) at $\eta'/2$, g increases strictly on $j_U - 1 \leq j \leq N^{1-\eta}$, so no minimizer is above $j_U - 1$. Hence every minimizer lies in the open window, and so in the closed one. For the fresh plus start, $j_N^*/\Lambda_N \to x_*$ by Theorem E(a) and its proof. At the minus end the same argument uses (LR) and (LD) for the minus sign. □

So within distance $N^{1-\eta}$ of the plus end the local extrema of P_N are the copies of those of $\widetilde{\kappa}_+$ and, inside the window of (d), alternating minima and maxima with one more minimum than maximum, plateaus counted once.

We expect the following criterion. Theorem 6.8 proves its "only if" half, since fresh and fair starts satisfy its hypotheses.

Conjecture 6.13. *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 6.12, P_N has exactly $M_+ + M_- + 1$ modes for all large N. In particular it has exactly three modes for all large N if each end profile has exactly one local maximum.*

The condition is not that the profiles be monotone. For the fair start and the zeta law of Section 7, $\widetilde{\kappa}_+ = (\frac{1}{2}, u_-(1), u_-(2), \dots)$ with $u_-(1) = 1/\zeta(5/2) = 0.745\ldots > \frac{1}{2}$. It is not monotone, it has one local maximum, and the exact law has three modes, at $k = 1$, $N/2$ and $N - 1$, for $N = 400$ and 1000. The conjecture would follow from three steps that we do not prove. The first is a single local minimum in the window of Theorem 6.12(d), which needs second differences of P_N and a difference form of Lemma 6.5. The second is monotonicity on the big-jump zone $N^{1-\eta} \leq j \leq (1-p)N - KB_N$, where the number of runs is of order N and Lemma 6.2 no longer applies. The third is a single change of sign of D_N on the bulk, which needs a local limit theorem for first differences.

7 Computations

No proof uses a computed number. The computations check the exact identities, produce Figure 1 and Table 1, and test the limit theorems at moderate N. Except for the identities they use the zeta law $f_\sigma(n) = n^{-5/2}/\zeta(5/2)$ for both signs, so $\alpha_\pm = 3/2$, $p = 1/2$ and $s = 3.894745$, with a fresh plus start unless we say otherwise.

For a fresh plus start let $a_t(k)$ and $b_t(k)$ be the probabilities that a plus run, respectively a minus run, starts at step $t+1$ and the first t steps contain exactly k plus steps. So $a_t(k) = \rho^{(+)}_{t-k}(k)$, $a_0(0) = 1$ and $b_0(0) = 0$. Since the runs alternate, with $a_t(k) = b_t(k) = 0$ for $k < 0$,

$$b_t(k) = \sum_{\ell=1}^{t} a_{t-\ell}(k-\ell)\, f_+(\ell), \qquad a_t(k) = \sum_{\ell=1}^{t} b_{t-\ell}(k)\, f_-(\ell) \qquad (t \geq 1), \tag{7.1}$$

and by (2.13) the identity (2.14) reads

$$P_N(N-j) = \sum_{t=j}^{N-1} a_t(t-j)\, T_+(N-t) + \sum_{m=1}^{j} b_{N-m}(N-j)\, T_-(m). \tag{7.2}$$

This gives the whole law in $O(N^3)$ operations. Every entry is a dot product with non-negative terms, so in double precision every computed value has relative error at most $(1+\gamma_{N+2})^{N+2}-1$ with $\gamma_n = nu/(1-nu)$ and $u = 2^{-53}$, which is $2.8 \cdot 10^{-9}$ at $N = 5000$. At $N = 600$ a run in ball arithmetic confirms the double-precision law. In Figure 1, with $B_N = 74$, the largest relative error of the bulk on $|k - pN| \le 3B_N$ is 0.071, that of the big-jump kernel where $|k - pN| \ge 4B_N$ and $\min(k, N-k) \ge 2B_N$ is 0.38, attained at the junction with the bulk, and that of the boundary kernel on $1 \le \min(k, N-k) \le B_N$ is 0.094. At $N = 1200$ and 3000 the ratio $P_N(k)/G_N(k)$ at $k = \lceil pN + KB_N \rceil$ is 0.354, 1.482, 1.036 and 0.337, 1.538, 1.059 for $K = 1$, 4, 16, against the limits 0.31, 1.68, 1.09 of Remark 4.9. The minimizers in Table 1 are certified against the rounding bound. For the stationary initial run the ratio of $P_N(N-j)/T_+(N)$ to $\kappa_+^{\mathrm{st}}(j)$ is 1.0007, 1.0031 and 1.0098 at $j = 1$, 2 and 5 for $N = 2400$, about half its deviation at $N = 1200$. For Section 6.4, the ratio $d_j \mu_-^2 / T_-(j)$ of Lemma 6.5 is -0.963, -0.996 and -0.9996 at $j = 10$, 100 and 1000. The error term of Theorem 6.11 for a fresh plus start at $j = 20$ is 0.73 at $N = 1000$ and 0.23 at $N = 3000$, so it decays like $1/N$. For the fair start the law has exactly three modes, at $k = 1$, $N/2$ and $N-1$, for $N = 400$ and 1000. For the start of Corollary 6.9 with $d_0 = 5$ it has exactly four modes at $N = 1000$, at $k = 1$, 499, 995 and 1000. These modes are certified, since every relative difference of neighbouring values exceeds twice the rounding bound. The exact identities of Section 2, the renewal identities of Section 6.2 and (5.12) are checked in exact rational arithmetic against a sum over all sign strings for $N \le 12$. The identities of Section 2.5, except the bound in Lemma 2.7, are also proved in the Lean library PaperF, whose file MAP.md maps the labels to the Lean names.

The scripts, their outputs with the hash of each script, and the Lean files are in the folder kagey-problems/problem131 of https://github.com/apemm/Kagey-Problems. In paperF the command `python -I verify_all.py` runs the checks, and README.md lists the software versions and what each script tests.

A Classical inputs

This appendix gives the proofs of Lemmas 2.1 and 2.2, four classical facts on sums of runs, and the bounds on the kernels of one sign that enter the proof of Theorem A.

A.1 Regular variation and the profile

Proof of Lemma 2.1. Parts (i) to (iii) are the cited theorems, and $T_\sigma(x/c) \le C_c T_\sigma(x)$ follows from (i) for large x and from positivity for the others. For (iv), $nT_\sigma(n)$ has index $1 - \alpha_\sigma > -1$ and T_σ has index $-\alpha_\sigma < -1$, so the cited propositions give the asymptotics, and positivity gives the bounds for all $w \ge 1$. For (v), B_N is nondecreasing since each a_σ is increasing. If $\alpha_+ \ne \alpha_-$, then $B_N = b_{\sigma,N}$ for the sign with the smaller index and all large N. If the indices are equal, B_{cN}/B_N lies between the two ratios $b_{\sigma,cN}/b_{\sigma,N}$, which tend to c^{1/α_*}. So $B_N T_\sigma(N)$ has the negative index $1/\alpha_* - \alpha_\sigma$ and tends to zero [5, Proposition 1.5.1], the definition of a_σ gives $NT_\sigma(b_{\sigma,N}) \to s$, and $B_N \log N = o(N)$ since $1/\alpha_* < 1$. For (vi), take $\delta = (\alpha_\sigma - 1)/2$ in (ii) and use $s/2 \le NT_\sigma(b_{\sigma,N}) \le 2s$ for large N. □

Proof of Lemma 2.2. Under (RV), $0 < p < 1$. For $1 < \alpha < 2$ the real parts of $(-it)^\alpha$ and $(it)^\alpha$ equal $|t|^\alpha \cos\frac{\pi\alpha}{2} < 0$, and $(-ict)^\alpha = c^\alpha (-it)^\alpha$ for $c \ge 0$. So W_θ has the characteristic function

$$\widehat{h}_\theta(t) = \exp\Big(K_{\alpha_+} \big((1-p)\theta_+\big)^{\alpha_+} (-it)^{\alpha_+} + K_{\alpha_-} \big(p\,\theta_-\big)^{\alpha_-} (it)^{\alpha_-} \Big),$$

continuous in θ. One coordinate of $\theta \in \Theta$ equals 1, so $|\widehat{h}_\theta| \le \Phi$ with $\Phi(t) = 1$ for $|t| < 1$ and $\Phi(t) = e^{-c|t|^{\alpha_*}}$ otherwise, where $c = \min_\sigma K_{\alpha_\sigma} |\cos\frac{\pi\alpha_\sigma}{2}| \min(p, 1-p)^{\alpha_\sigma} > 0$. Fourier inversion gives (a) with $C_1 = \frac{1}{2\pi}\int \Phi$ and $C_2 = \frac{1}{2\pi}\int |t|\Phi(t)\,dt$, and dominated convergence

gives the continuity in (c). If $N'/N \to 1$, then $\theta_{N'} - \theta_N \to 0$ by Lemma 2.1(i), and uniform continuity on the compact Θ gives the rest of (c).

For (b), the set $\{h_\theta : \theta \in \Theta\}$ is compact in the uniform norm and each h_θ vanishes at infinity, so a finite net gives $\varepsilon_h(R) \to 0$. If $\varepsilon'_h(R) \not\to 0$, there are $\varepsilon > 0$, $R_i \to \infty$ and N_i with $\int_{|x|>R_i} h_{N_i} \geq \varepsilon$ and, by compactness, $\theta_{N_i} \to \theta$. Then $h_{N_i} \to h_\theta$ in L^1 by Scheffé's lemma, which is a contradiction.

For (d), fix a sign and write $Z = Z_\sigma$, $g = g_\sigma$, $\alpha = \alpha_\sigma$. A sum of n independent copies of Z has the law of $n^{1/\alpha}Z$. If $Z \geq 0$ almost surely, then the strong law of large numbers applied to $\min(Z_i, 1)$ makes $n^{-1/\alpha}(Z_1 + \cdots + Z_n) \to \infty$, which contradicts tightness, and the same holds for $-Z$. So the open set $U = \{g > 0\}$ meets both half lines. The density g^{*n} is continuous, positive at $y_1 + \cdots + y_n$ when every $y_i \in U$, and equal to $n^{-1/\alpha} g(n^{-1/\alpha}\,\cdot)$. Hence $(a - \varepsilon, a + \varepsilon) \subset U$ with $0 < \varepsilon < a$ gives $c_n(a - \varepsilon, a + \varepsilon) \subset U$ with $c_n = n^{1-1/\alpha}$, and since $c_{n+1}/c_n \to 1$ these intervals cover a half line. The same holds on the other side, and the case $n = 2$ gives $U = \mathbb{R}$. If $\theta_\sigma = 1$, then $W_\theta = aZ_\sigma + Y$ with $a \neq 0$ and Y independent, so $h_\theta(x) = \mathbb{E}[|a|^{-1} g_\sigma((x - Y)/a)] > 0$. The two minima in (d) are minima of positive continuous functions on Θ.

For (e) with $\tau = +$, condition on $Z_- = y$ and use $1 - p = \mu_-/s$ and $p/(1-p) = \mu_+/\mu_-$. For $\tau = -$ condition on Z_+. □

A.2 Sums of runs

We write $\bar{T}_\sigma(x) = \mathbb{P}(X_\sigma > x) \sim T_\sigma(x)$.

Lemma A.1 (stable and local limits)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN) for the sign σ, and write $\alpha = \alpha_\sigma$, $\mu = \mu_\sigma$, $a = a_\sigma$, $g = g_\sigma$, $T = T_\sigma$ and $S_m = S^\sigma_m$. Parts (i), (iii) and (iv) need only (RV).*

(i) $Z_m = (S_m - m\mu)/a(m)$ converges in law to Z_σ, whose density g is bounded, uniformly continuous, and tends to zero at infinity. Moreover $m\big(\mathbb{E}e^{-(X_\sigma - \mu)/a(m)} - 1\big) \to K_\alpha$.

(ii) (Gnedenko's local limit theorem) $\sup_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \big| a(m)\mathbb{P}(S_m = k) - g\big((k - m\mu)/a(m)\big)\big| \to 0$ as $m \to \infty$, and $\bar{u}_\sigma = \sup_{m \geq 1} \sup_k a(m)\mathbb{P}(S_m = k) < \infty$.

(iii) (local large deviations) There is a constant $C_{\mathrm{LD}} = C_{\mathrm{LD}}(\sigma)$ such that $\mathbb{P}(S_m = j) \leq C_{\mathrm{LD}}\, m\, T(j - m\mu)/a(m)$ for all $m \geq 1$ and all integers j with $j - m\mu \geq 1$.

(iv) (left deviations) The constant $C_- = C_-(\sigma) = \sup_{m \geq 1} m \log \mathbb{E}e^{-(X_\sigma - \mu)/a(m)}$ is finite, and $\mathbb{P}(S_m \leq m\mu - y) \leq e^{C_-}\, e^{-y/a(m)}$ for all $m \geq 1$ and $y \geq 0$.

Proof. (i) The domain of attraction is classical [18, Section XVII.5], and we check the constant K_α. Let $X = X_\sigma$ and $\Lambda(\xi) = \mathbb{E}[e^{-\xi X} - 1 + \xi X]$ for $\operatorname{Re}\xi \geq 0$. Fubini's theorem gives, for $\xi = te^{i\vartheta}$ with $t > 0$ and $|\vartheta| \leq \pi/2$,

$$\Lambda(\xi) = \int_0^\infty \xi\big(1 - e^{-\xi y}\big)\bar{T}(y)\, dy = \int_0^\infty e^{i\vartheta}\big(1 - e^{-e^{i\vartheta} v}\big)\bar{T}(v/t)\, dv.$$

The integrand is at most $\min(2, v)\bar{T}(v/t)$ in modulus, and $\bar{T}(v/t)/\bar{T}(1/t) \to v^{-\alpha}$ as $t \to 0$, dominated by Lemma 2.1(ii) for $v \geq tx_\delta$ with $1 < \alpha \pm \delta < 2$, while $v < tx_\delta$ contributes $o(\bar{T}(1/t))$ since $\alpha < 2$. So, uniformly in ϑ, $\Lambda(te^{i\vartheta}) = \bar{T}(1/t)(F(e^{i\vartheta}) + o(1))$ with $F(\xi) = \int_0^\infty \xi(1 - e^{-\xi v})v^{-\alpha} dv$. The function F is continuous on $\operatorname{Re}\xi \geq 0$, analytic inside and homogeneous of degree α, and an integration by parts gives $F(1) = \Gamma(2-\alpha)/(\alpha - 1) = K_\alpha$, so $F(\xi) = K_\alpha \xi^\alpha$. With $\mathbb{E}e^{-\xi(X-\mu)} - 1 = \Lambda(\xi) + O(|\xi|^2)$, $\xi = -i\theta/a(m)$, $m\bar{T}(a(m)/|\theta|) \to |\theta|^\alpha$ and $m/a(m)^2 \to 0$ we get $m(\mathbb{E}e^{i\theta(X-\mu)/a(m)} - 1) \to K_\alpha(-i\theta)^\alpha$, and Lévy's continuity theorem gives $Z_m \to Z_\sigma$. The limit characteristic function is integrable, which gives the properties of g. With $\xi = 1/a(m)$ the same expansion gives the last claim.

(ii) By (SPAN) the maximal span of X_σ is 1, and Gnedenko's theorem [23, Theorem 4.2.1] (see also [5, Theorem 8.4.1]) gives the limit, with any norming $a_m \sim a(m)$. The bound $\bar{u}_\sigma$ follows.

(iii) This is [6, Theorem 1.1, bound (1.6)] for the centered variable $X_\sigma - \mu$, with $A = 1/\bar{T}$, the interval $(-1, 0]$ and $x = j - m\mu$. Its right tail is $\bar{T}(x)(1 + o(1))$ and its left tail vanishes for $x > \mu$. The bound needs no lattice assumption, its norming sequence is asymptotic to $a(m)$ [5, Theorem 1.5.12], and $\bar{T} \le T$.

(iv) By (i), $m(\mathbb{E}e^{-(X_\sigma-\mu)/a(m)} - 1)$ is bounded, and $\log(1 + z) \le z$ makes C_- finite. Markov's inequality for $e^{-(S_m-m\mu)/a(m)}$ gives the bound. □

A.3 Kernels of one sign

For each sign σ the fresh identities use the kernels u^σ_m, q^σ_m and q^σ_{m+1} ($m \ge 1$), with weights $c_{\mathsf{k}} = 1$, μ_σ and μ_σ. A kernel of sign σ is one of these sequences, written k_m. We use four facts.

(K1) $\sum_{m\ge1} u^\sigma_m(j) \le 1$, $\sum_{m\ge1} q^\sigma_m(j) = 1$ and $\sum_{m\ge1} q^\sigma_{m+1}(j) \le 1$ for $j \ge 1$, by (2.8).

(K2) $\mathsf{k}_m(j) = 0$ for $m > j$, because $S^\sigma_m \ge m$.

(K3) Let $J_\sigma(j) = \min\{m \ge 1 : S^\sigma_m \ge j\}$. Then $\mathbb{P}(J_\sigma(j) = m) = q^\sigma_m(j)$ by (2.7), and $u^\sigma_m(j) \le q^\sigma_m(j)$, since $\{S^\sigma_m = j\} \subset \{J_\sigma(j) = m\}$.

(K4) $\sum_j q^\sigma_m(j) = \mu_\sigma$ and $\sum_j u^\sigma_m(j) = 1$.

Lemma A.2 (kernel local limits)**.** *Assume (RV) and (SPAN). For each sign σ and each kernel k of sign σ,*

$$\delta_{\mathsf{k}}(m) = \sup_{j\in\mathbb{Z}} \big|a_\sigma(m)\mathsf{k}_m(j) - c_{\mathsf{k}}\, g_\sigma\big((j - m\mu_\sigma)/a_\sigma(m)\big)\big| \to 0 \qquad (m \to \infty),$$

and $\mathsf{k}_m(j) \le C_3/a_\sigma(m)$ for all $m \ge 1$ and j, where $C_3 = C_3(\sigma) = \max\big(a_\sigma(1),\, \mu_\sigma r_\sigma \bar{u}_\sigma\big)$ and $r_\sigma = \sup_{m\ge2} a_\sigma(m)/a_\sigma(m-1) < \infty$.

Proof. For u^σ_m this is Lemma A.1(ii). The kernel q^σ_m is a sum of shifts of u^σ_{m-1} by $v \ge 1$ with weights $T_\sigma(v)$ of total mass μ_σ, and q^σ_{m+1} is the same sum built on u^σ_m. This gives the bounds, with $q^\sigma_1 = T_\sigma \le 1$. For the limit of q^σ_m write $a = a_\sigma$, $g = g_\sigma$ and $z = (j - m\mu)/a(m)$, and fix v_0 and Z. The shifts $v > v_0$ contribute at most $(\bar{u}_\sigma + \|g\|_\infty)\sum_{v>v_0} T(v)$ to $|a(m-1)q_m(j) - \mu g(z)|$. For $v \le v_0$ the scaled point moves by at most $Z|a(m)/a(m-1) - 1| + (v_0 + \mu)/a(m-1)$ when $|z| \le Z$, and stays beyond $Z/2$ in modulus for large m when $|z| > Z$. So the uniform continuity of g, its decay and Lemma A.1(ii) give the limit as $m \to \infty$, then $v_0, Z \to \infty$. The kernel q^σ_{m+1} is the same. □

Lemma A.3 (small counts)**.** *Assume (RV). For each sign σ there is $C_4 = C_4(\sigma)$ such that every kernel of sign σ satisfies*

$$\mathsf{k}_m(j) \le C_4\big(1 + m/a_\sigma(m)\big)T_\sigma(j) \qquad \text{whenever } 8m\mu_\sigma \le j.$$

Consequently, for $0 < \beta \le 1$ there is $C_5 = C_5(\sigma, \beta)$ with

$$\mathsf{k}_m(j) \le C_5\, e_{\sigma,N}, \qquad e_{\sigma,N} = \big(1 + N/a_\sigma(N)\big)T_\sigma(N), \tag{A.1}$$

for all $N \ge 1$, all $\beta N \le j \le N$ and all m with $8m\mu_\sigma \le \beta N$. Moreover $B_N e_{\sigma,N} \to 0$.

Proof. Write $T = T_\sigma$, $a = a_\sigma$, $\mu = \mu_\sigma$, and let $T(x/2) \le C_T T(x)$. If $4m\mu \le i$, then $i - m\mu \ge i/2 \ge 1$, and Lemma A.1(iii) gives $u_m(i) \le C_{\mathrm{LD}} C_T\, m\, T(i)/a(m)$, which is the claim for u_m. Let $8m\mu \le j$ and $m \ge 2$, and split $q_m(j) = \sum_v T(v)u_{m-1}(j - v)$ at $v = j/2$.

For $v \le j/2$ the bound for u_{m-1} applies at $j - v \ge 4(m-1)\mu$, and the weights add up to at most μ. For $v > j/2$ we have $T(v) \le C_T T(j)$, and the values $u_{m-1}(j-v)$ add up to at most 1. This gives the claim with $C_4 = C_T + \mu C_{\mathrm{LD}} C_T^2 r_\sigma$, and q_{m+1} is the same. For (A.1), $m/a(m) \le C_P N/a(N)$ for $m \le N$ by Lemma 2.1(iii), and $T(j) \le C_{T,\beta} T(N)$. Finally $B_N N T_\sigma(N)/a_\sigma(N)$ has the index $1/\alpha_* - 1/\alpha_\sigma + 1 - \alpha_\sigma \le 1 - \alpha_* < 0$, since $1/\alpha_* - 1/\alpha_\sigma \le \alpha_\sigma - \alpha_*$, and $B_N T_\sigma(N) \to 0$. □

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